

The Sixty-Third Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action

2013
Final Report

Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York, NY - April 21-27, 2013

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475 Riverside Drive, New York, NY 10115

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

■ 63rd General Service Conference

April 21-27, 2013 members of the 63rd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada met at the Crowne Plaza Times Square Hotel in New York City; the theme was "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action."

The 131 Conference members consist of delegates from the 93 Conference areas of the U.S. and Canada; trustees of the General Service Board; A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Board directors; and General Service Office and Grapevine staff members.

The Conference was officially opened Sunday with the roll call by Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, followed by Greetings from delegate chair, Roger Schelling, Northwest Texas. The keynote was given by George Martin, general service trustee.

This year's Conference was chaired by Ward Ewing (nonalcoholic), chairman of the General Service Board; Phyllis Halliday; and Roger Schelling. Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference coordinator.

Sunday evening the Opening Dinner was followed by an open A.A. meeting, chaired by Lynda Rivers, Kentucky chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee; the leader was Dave Murray, Arizona. Speakers were: Joe Downey, A.A.W.S. director; Irene Donoso, Grapevine staff; Jeryl Thompson, Mid-Southern California; Doris Sullivan, Mississippi; and Andrew Ware, West Central regional trustee.

For those who liked to start their day with an A.A. meeting the 2013 G.S.C. Serenity Group met each morning at 7:30. Percy Graves, Western Ontario, was the chair; secretary/treasurer was Pamela Vollans-Matthews, Manitoba. A Seventh Tradition basket was passed each morning, and at the end of Conference \$457 was contributed to the General Service Office.

During the week, while Conference members were in meetings, local A.A. members accompanied Conference members' spouses and guests on sightseeing and shopping tours, to A.A. and Al-Anon meetings and to various New York City sites and museums. Some enjoyed a matinee of a Broadway play or musical. Tuesday afternoon Conference members, as well as their guests, traveled uptown to tour the General Service and Grapevine offices.

Wednesday afternoon at the trustees elections, Bill Farnsworth

of Marietta, Ohio was elected East Central regional trustee; Chet Parker, of Orlando, Florida will become the new Southeast regional trustee; and the next trustee-at-large/U.S. will be Bob Wilcox of Westfield, Massachusetts.

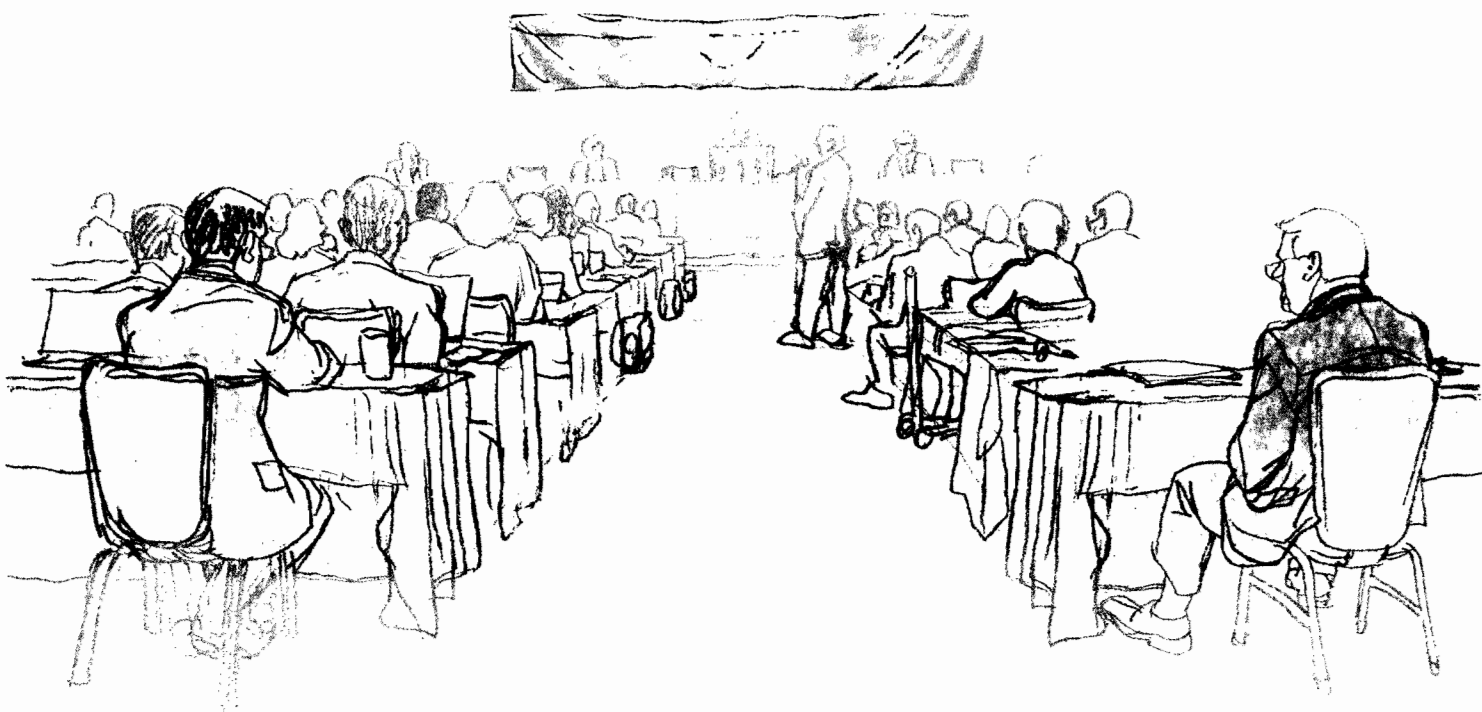
At the Delegates Only Dinner Tuesday evening Linda McGhee, SE New York, was elected delegate chair for the 64th Conference; Harold Casey, Oklahoma, will be the alternate chair.

The main focus of the Conference though, is on the deliberations of each of the thirteen Conference committees, and it is during the committee meetings that the major work of the Conference is done. After a joint meeting with each corresponding standing trustees' committee, the Conference committees review agenda items and material, weigh and discuss various issues and come up with recommendations which may result in Conference Advisory Actions.

This year presentation/discussion topics, under the banner of "Spiritual Principles for World Service," were: The Triangle — More Than a Shape, Jim MacDonald, New Brunswick/PEI; The General Service Conference Inventory — Why is it Necessary?, Lela Meinke, Northern Interior California; Self-Support — What Does It Mean to the Fellowship?, Rich Healless, N. Illinois; Primary Purpose — Carrying the A.A. Message, Patricia Moody, Rhode Island. There was also a Finance PowerPoint presentation by Terry Bedient, Class A trustee and chair of the trustees' Finance Committee. Barb Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada, gave a report on the 22nd World Service Meeting, held last October in Rye Brook, New York.

The 2013 Conference was the first year of a planned three-year Conference Inventory. In her presentation on "why is an inventory necessary?" Lela Meinke observed, "Our primary purpose hasn't changed, but there are things that are changing. Our self-support model has been shifting. The logistics of publishing, commerce, distribution and communication — these are changing. Significantly.

"We have choices that we need to make, to ensure that we use our precious resources prudently. Our inventory is an invitation to participate in a transparent, honest and loving dialogue about how we go about making these choices. It's an opportunity to review the logistics of leadership, while preserving our beautiful Concept."



Wednesday morning Conference members split into 15 groups to address the 2013 outlined inventory questions. Reportbacks were read by the reporter of each group on Friday morning.

Late Friday afternoon rotating delegates (Panel 62) lined up at the mikes for a two-minute farewell. After Ward Ewing's closing remarks the Conference was officially closed with the Serenity Prayers in three languages, lead by: English, Kenny Kaatz (Western Michigan); French, Gilles Flynn (NW Quebec) and Spanish, Oscar Rivera (Puerto Rico).

Conference members met once more at the Saturday morning closing brunch where the rotating trustees gave their farewell talks: Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees Ward Ewing and Rogelio Flores; George Martin, general service trustee; Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S.; Don Miller, general service trustee; El Nault, Southeast regional trustee and Pam Reising, East Central regional trustee. This program was chaired by Terry Bedient (nonalcoholic) who will become the new chairman of the General Service Board.



The historical significance of this Conference includes the selection of members here to find our solutions. The Third Legacy Procedure, which assures us of the best Conference delegates and trustees, and the right of participation to include our valuable staff members, has brought us all together here. Quoting from page 47 of A.A. *Comes of Age*, Bill W. reported in 1955: "The Conference, having completed the fifth year of its experimental period with a record of high success, was no longer an experiment. It was the instrument destined to become the heart of A.A.'s Third Legacy of Service and the whole of A.A.'s conscience, world-wide." Perhaps this was the first General Service Conference inventory. Seeing that after five years of experimentation this works.

The efficiency and organization by the Conference coordinator, Conference chairpersons, trustees and the staff members further enhances this great experience we are now taking part in. The week ahead of us is wonderfully formatted and we are thankful for the hospitality and consideration that goes into this Conference. We are all here together to weigh in with our informed opinions, which is what we do best anyway.

I especially want to mention the persons who will be chairing this Conference. A great Conference always has the best persons available to chair the event and we certainly are blessed to have that in Phyllis Halliday and Ward Ewing. We all have come to appreciate a good meeting, and we are sure to have that with the experience and enthusiasm of the chairpersons at this Conference. Oh, by the way, if you make any slips we will be sure to kindly help you get back on track.

In the week ahead we will be using and experiencing the committee process, as well as the inventory process, for our solutions. The inventory leads us to the solution in our recovery and also in our Third Legacy, which is service to the Fellowship, which we need and cherish. As we all welcome the opportunity to be a part of this let us look ahead with courage and willingness to arrive at a unanimous, or substantial, unanimity. We will greet the need for a full discussion and for the minority to be heard in order to conduct the business of A.A.

Ok, so there is the flowery greeting and expectations of this experience we are so blessed to a part of. We will not always agree on everything. We will passionately and wholeheartedly disagree at times. Consider this: "We do not have to agree on every topic to have unity in A.A."

Now, "Warm Greetings" for this opening of the 63rd General Service Conference. And I will end with this reading of the unity pledge.

Our Declaration of Unity

This we owe to A.A.'s future:
To place our common welfare first;
To keep our fellowship united.
For on A.A. unity depend our lives,
And the lives of those to come.

Roger Schelling, Northwest Texas

It has happened before, perhaps thousands of times. Outside a gathering of A.A.s, be it the meeting of a local A.A. group, a Regional Forum, an area assembly, or even at an International Convention, there will be a lone drunk, just hanging around. How he or she knows where we are will most likely remain a mystery forever.

So, as it happened on this particular Friday evening, when members of the 63rd General Service Conference were leaving the hotel for dinner, there he was, asking someone—anyone—to help him get into detox. Some A.A.s went back to the Conference workroom and enlisted a G.S.O. staff member, who took the man to a hospital unit to dry out.

We will probably never know what happened to this potential member. But one thing is a given; those who witnessed this Twelfth Step action will not likely forget him and might take another look at "Why We Need a Conference," in *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

Greetings

Hi, I am Roger and I am an alcoholic, Panel 62, Area 66, Northwest Texas. As the delegate chair with one Conference experience under my belt I am grateful to have the opportunity to present this welcome and greeting. I welcome and congratulate all of us who have just answered the roll call and are now voting members of this 63rd General Service Conference.

Through this process we find our solutions. We do this in particular with the inventory this year. "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action" is our theme. We are now urged into action. This is a great experience with historical significance, which is further enhanced by the work put into the organization of this Conference, as well as the committee process, which is used as our method of conducting business.

Keynote Address

I thank the organizers of the 63rd General Service Conference for according me the privilege of speaking to you today. I extend a special welcome to our Panel 63 delegates. I remember well my arrival here for my first Conference. People who we have met after our sobriety date find it hard to imagine what we were like when we were drinking; but all of us remember how it was, back in the day. So, after I had checked into the hotel, I came to this room to take a peek. The room had already been prepared, and the banner was up behind the dais. It was an emotional moment. Here I stood, about to become a part, albeit a very small part, of the history of Alcoholics Anonymous. I was overcome with a sense of gratitude for the Fellowship that had somehow managed to guide me on a journey from “completely untrustworthy” to “trusted servant.”

A.A. service is about communication. We are charged with carrying our lifesaving message to those who have not yet found us. When someone hears that message and arrives at one of our meetings, we simply talk to him or her. We share our stories and our program, and explain our Steps and Traditions. We tell them “You’re a member of A.A. if you say you are.” And when we’re done talking, it’s up to the newcomer to decide whether to take the plunge.

The primary service goal of our founding generation was to let people know that A.A. was available and offering a working solution to a seemingly intractable problem, an alcoholic’s inability to stop drinking. We were a voice crying in the wilderness. It seems hard to believe, but as recently as 2006 there were no iPhones, iPads, Kindle readers, Twitter, or YouTube, and Facebook was a little known service limited exclusively to college students. Today, anyone can, at the drop of a hat and at virtually no cost, post a message or a video on the Internet, and have it read or seen by potentially millions of people, all with a simple mouse click or a tap on a smart phone. Our mission today is no longer simply to deliver our message of hope; we must also make sure we are a clear, effective and authoritative voice which can be sorted out and heard in the midst of a cacophony of misinformation and uninformed personal opinion about A.A.

This new environment is also affecting the way that people consume information. We have, since the earliest days of A.A., relied on our publishing operations to supplement the financial support provided by our membership, allowing us to maintain our world services and to have a Reserve Fund adequate to assure our financial health and stability. Although we continue to sell many printed Big Books each year, and have entered the world of digital publishing, the hard reality appears to be that, going forward, we are going to be relying more and more on our Seventh Tradition contributions to meet our financial needs.

The challenge we face in adjusting to this changed environment is daunting. It is thus fitting that we begin at this Conference an inventory of the Conference to be completed in 2015. Bill Wilson, in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 231) said “Just as each A.A. must continue to take his moral inventory and act upon it, so must our whole society do if we are to survive and if we are to serve usefully and well.”

Self-assessment is a pervasive part of our A.A. program; fully half of our Steps are directly related to it. Inventory of the Conference and personal inventory in the Steps are not quite the same, however. At the Conference, the emphasis will be on effectiveness in carrying out the purposes of the Conference, not on “character defects.” In his introduction to the Concepts, Bill was quite clear about the importance of making changes in order to maintain an effective service structure. He said, “Concern has been expressed lest the detailed portrayal of our internal structure might not later harden down into such a firm tradition or gospel that necessary changes would be impossible to make. Nothing could stray further from the intent of these Concepts.”

Honesty, both with ourselves and with others, is a core value of A.A. Nonalcoholics can afford to entertain certain fantasies about themselves, and no harm is done. For us, our fantasies can kill us. We don’t take inventory simply because it is, in and of itself, a good thing (like kindness, or generosity), but rather because it is an important element of our continued sobriety. The same holds true for our service inventories, including the Conference inventory which we are now undertaking. We are not here to take pride in doing the responsible thing by taking an inventory. We are here to help assure the unity and effectiveness of A.A. in its mission to carry the great message of hope to anyone, anywhere, who has a desire to do something about his or her drinking problem. The vast majority of us in the room today will not be here when this inventory is completed. This week we will strive to make a strong start on the inventory, and trust that those who follow us will make the changes which the completed inventory reveals are needed.

The basic role of the Conference is to act as a group conscience for the entire Fellowship. Religions have dogma which describes what God’s will is; the faithful are expected to adhere to the dogma or face the consequences. In terms of A.A. service, we have no dogma; to determine God’s will for us in our service, we look to our Second Tradition. Our authority figure is “a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience.” If you want to know what God’s will is, you don’t call some exalted keeper of the truth; you have a group conscience meeting, talk about whatever the issue is, and then take a vote; the result of that vote is, by definition, the expression of God’s will. A group conscience of informed A.A. members, acting in good faith in what they believe to be in the best interest of A.A. and in accordance with our Traditions, never reaches a “wrong” result. It is by definition what is right at the time the vote is taken. We all know that different groups can reach different conclusions on the same issue, and the same group can reach different conclusions at different times. All of this is true of the Conference as well. I don’t think our inventory needs to worry much about whether past Conferences have been making “good” or “bad” decisions. They were all good decisions at the time they were made.

It is axiomatic in my profession that a good lawyer knows the right answers to the questions; what makes a great lawyer is knowing the right questions to ask. The same can be said of our service structure. A.A. does not have unlimited resources; the setting of priorities and deciding what needs to be talked about often involve difficult decisions; it is a critical part of our service at all levels. Our many inventory subjects will ultimately boil down to two — first, are the most important questions facing the Fellowship being given the emphasis and appropriate time they deserve at the Conference; and second, are Conference members given the ability, through background material and Conference sharing sessions, to reach a good faith informed decision on these important matters.

This week will be my eighth, and last, General Service Conference. It has been an honor to serve Alcoholics Anonymous at the world service level, and an eye-opener. Bill often spoke of the “vital world services” being performed by the General Service Office. I live in a small town in Michigan, and from that vantage point, where the principal reference to our world service is the copyright notice in the literature, the idea of “vital world services” is a hard one to grasp. As members of the General Service Conference, we have a wonderful opportunity to see first hand how our service structure plays an indispensable role in the carrying of our message, and in the continuance of A.A. worldwide as a unified whole. We all have a duty to the Fellowship, and especially to the still-suffering alcoholic, to work together this week to make sure that our world service remains strong and continues to reflect our A.A. values.

So, let’s have a productive Conference, and, of course, share a few laughs together along the way.

George Martin, general service trustee

■ Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2013 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The theme for the 2014 General Service Conference be: "Communicating Our Legacies — Vital in a Changing World."
- 2 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2014 General Service Conference:
Living in the Heart of A.A.
 - a) Recovery, Unity and Service — Our Responsibility
 - b) Passing It On Through Sponsorship
 - c) Participating in Our Common Welfare through Contributions
 - d) Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future

ARCHIVES¹

It was recommended that:

- 3 The Archives video *Markings on the Journey* be revised and updated with the proposed changes (estimated cost \$5,000) and brought back to the 2014 Conference Archives Committee.
- 4 A commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition of the first edition, first printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be published in April 2014.
- 5 The posting of freely accessible, anonymity-protected archival audio clips on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be done at the discretion of the trustees' Committee on Archives and G.S.O.'s Archivist.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 6 The statement in the section Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

"Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign or initial a slip that has been furnished by the court together with a self-addressed court envelope. The referred person supplies identification and mails the slip back to the court as proof of attendance."

Be revised as follows:

"Each group is autonomous. Some groups, at the request of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign, initial or stamp a slip that has been furnished by the court. The referred person provides the slip to the court as proof of attendance."

- 7 The statement in the section How to Make Referrals to A.A. in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

"Or, you can contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. Write:

P.O. Box 459
Grand Central Station
New York, NY 10163
Or phone: (212) 870-3400"

Be revised as follows:

"You can also contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information at:

P.O. Box 459
Grand Central Station
New York, NY 10163
(212) 870-3400
www.aa.org "

- 8 The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/ Special Needs-Accessibilities revise the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." taking into consideration suggested changes of the Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and bring back a report or draft pamphlet to the 2014 Conference Committee.

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 9 The revised pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" be approved.

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

- 10 The undernoted three cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2025:

Montreal, Quebec
St. Louis, Missouri
Vancouver, British Columbia

- 11 Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2015 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 12 The draft pamphlet "A.A.—Spiritual not Religious" be recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and brought back to the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 13 The 66th General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 2016, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.
- 14 The user responsibilities in the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the General Service Conference," which currently read:

"Users are responsible for insuring adequate battery strength prior to the start of sessions. No technical assistance will be provided by the organizers of the General Service Conference or Conference technical assistants."

be revised to read:

"Users are responsible for insuring adequate battery strength prior to the start of sessions. For safety reasons, extension cords will not be permitted between any seating rows or walking areas. Power outlets will be available in designated seating areas during General Sessions. No technical assistance will be provided by the organizers of the General Service Conference or Conference technical assistants."

- 15 The deadline for the submission of Conference Agenda Items be changed from January 15 to December 15, beginning in December 2014 for the 65th General Service Conference.
- 16 The timetable for the election of the delegate from Area 84, Northeastern Ontario, be revised to allow for two odd and two even panels in that province. The revised timetable for the election of the delegate from Area 84, Northeastern Ontario is to be accomplished by having the Panel 63 delegate elected for a one-year term with the understanding that this delegate would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following Panel 64 election.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 17 The 63rd General Service Conference affirm that the Internet, social media and all forms of public communications are implicit in the last phrase of the Short Form of Tradition Eleven, which reads: "...at the level of press, radio and films."
- 18 A.A. World Services be permitted to utilize digital channels and current (commissionable) support and distribution technologies, such as, but not limited to, smart phones, tablets, e-readers, applications and commissioned on-line stores for the sale and distribution of digital A.A. literature. The committee requested that the board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time. The committee requested that a status and financial report be submitted to the appropriate 2014 Conference Committee.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 19 A typographical error in the article "Leadership in A.A.: Ever a Vital Need," contained within the essay on Concept IX on page 37, fifth paragraph, third line: "...badly disturbed or **uniformed**..." be corrected to "...badly disturbed or **uninformed**..." in the next printing, noting that this typographical error has existed since the first printing of *Twelve Concepts for World Service*. (Change indicated in bold)
- 20 The following text describing the duties of the chairperson of the General Service Board be added to Chapter Nine in *The A.A. Service Manual* in a location to be determined by the Publishing Department.

"Duties of the A.A. General Service Board Chairperson

"The chairperson of the General Service Board of A.A. presides over the trustees' meetings, co-chairs the General Service Conference, and functions on behalf of the General Service Board between board meetings. The chairperson appoints members of the trustees' committees, subject to G.S.B. approval, and is an ex-officio member of all trustees' committees. In addition to board meetings and the Conference, the chairperson participates in all Regional Forums and may participate in a number of other events."

- 21 The following text be added to page S23 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, after the section entitled "Stimulating Interest in General Service":

"The Principle of Rotation

"Traditionally, rotation ensures that service positions, like nearly everything else in A.A., are passed around for all to share. Many positions have alternates who can step into the service positions if needed.

"To step out of an A.A. office we love can be hard. If we have been doing a good job, if we honestly don't see anyone else around willing, qualified, or with the time to do it, and if our friends agree, it's especially tough. But it can be a real step forward in growth—a step into the humility that is, for some people, the spiritual essence of anonymity.



"Among other things, anonymity in the Fellowship means that we forgo personal prestige for any A.A. work we do to help alcoholics. And, in the spirit of Tradition Twelve, it ever reminds us 'to place principles before personalities.'"

"Many outgoing service position holders find it rewarding to take time to share their experience with the incoming person. Rotation helps to bring us spiritual rewards far more enduring than any fame. With no A.A. 'status' at stake, we needn't compete for titles or praise—we have complete freedom to serve as we are needed."

- 22 The following text be added to Article 4 in the Current Conference Charter, on page S102 at the end of the final paragraph:

"The Conference recognizes the principles contained within the Twelve Concepts, particularly the Right of Participation, and the Rights of Petition and Appeal reflected in Concepts IV and V. In keeping with these principles, the Conference may agree to hear Concept V Appeals brought by members of the Conference structure below the Conference level on the inverted triangle."

- 23 The 2010 Advisory Action regarding Area Highlights be rescinded, so the entire *Final Report* may be professionally edited and published, while still reflecting the full substance of the General Service Conference.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 24 The following slate of trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in April 2013:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	Michele Grinberg, J.D.
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.	The Honorable
Corliss Burke, B.Ed	Ivan L.R. Lemelle
John Fromson, M.D.	David M. Morris, C.P.A.

Class B

Rod Betonney	William Noonan
Donald Cusson	Chet Parker
Bill Farnsworth	Clayton Vandivort
Nancy Haynes	Andrew Ware
Barbara Kelly	Marty Watters
Roberta Lindeman	Robert Wilcox
J. Gary Lutz	Albin Zezula

- 25 The appointment of the following officers be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2013:

Officers of the General Service Board

<i>Chairperson</i>	Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Michele Grinberg, J.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Roberta Lindeman
<i>Treasurer</i>	David M. Morris, C.P.A.
<i>Secretary</i>	Clayton Vandivort

- 26 The February 2013 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2013:

<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Rick Walker*

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

*Will be replaced at G.S.O. Staff Rotation in summer 2013.

- 27 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2013:

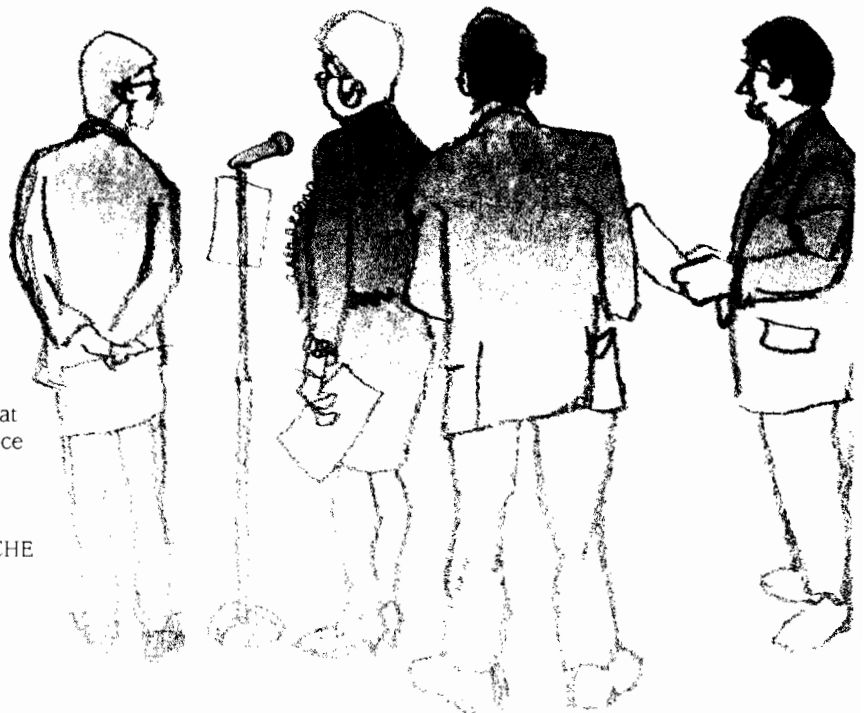
Carole Boerner	David Noll
Joe Downey	William Noonan
Phyllis A. Halliday	Rick Walker*
Roberta Lindeman	Marty Watters
J. Gary Lutz	

*Will be replaced at G.S.O. Staff Rotation in summer 2013.

- 28 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2013:

Lynda Bergeron	Clayton Vandivort
Ami Brophy	Andrew Ware
Michele Grinberg, J.D.	Albin Zezula
Nancy Haynes	[vacancy]
Ed Martin	

NOTE: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Bylaws state that its board shall be comprised of "no less than seven (7) and no more than ten (10) directors."



■ Presentations and Reports

SPIRITUAL PRINCIPLES FOR WORLD SERVICE

The Sunday afternoon Presentation/Discussion session was moderated by Jim Kath, Northern Minnesota.

A.A.'s Triangle: More Than a Shape

There are three sides to A.A.'s triangle: Recovery, Unity and Service. Three aspects to our lives as A.A. members.

Recovery: Drinking alcohol makes you think that you've found the answer to shyness, depression, and all the other emotions that made you feel different from everybody else. You think it's magic, but then it starts to get you in trouble: hospitals, jails, family troubles. So you stay sober awhile before trying it again — unfortunately, with the same results. Eventually, there's no more pleasure in alcohol, only pain. You're ready to do anything to stay sober. I remember comparing myself with a cancer victim: if I had cancer, I would do anything to get better. My only hope was a spiritual experience. If there is a God, please help me! So, I joined A.A.: one alcoholic carrying the good news to the next.

Unity: We need each other to recover and the Twelve Traditions are to the A.A. group what the Twelve Steps are to each member's sobriety. Our common welfare comes first, as personal recovery depends on A.A. unity. Going it alone was the way I tried to live my life before A.A. Who needs help? Not me. But that approach left me helpless, hopeless, and alone. The Twelve Traditions provide me with a life raft — a raft big enough for all of us to fit into.

Service: Carrying the message is the basic service our Fellowship gives. It is our aim and the main reason for our existence. A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of recovered alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves may fall into decay and those who have not yet been given the truth may die. It is the most important thing that I can do with my precious sobriety: share it with another. This is why so often we say that action is the magic word. Action is the heart of A.A.

Three sides to the triangle; three aspects of life.

I would like to close with the following excerpt from a presentation that Bill W. gave at the 1955 International Convention regarding the circle and triangle:

"The Conference is now assembled in its final experimental session on the stage of this auditorium. Delegates are seated in a circle — the Trustees, Headquarters Directors and Staff members in a triangle within the circle. The circle and triangle has become the symbol of Alcoholics Anonymous. The circle stands for the groups and the Group Conscience. At the base, the triangle stands for recovery, and the sides for unity and for service. These are the Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous. Circle and triangle is an ancient symbol by priests and magicians alike to ward off evil spirits!

"That this circle and triangle of the Conference, representing the Three Legacies of World Service will do likewise in perpetuity for Alcoholics Anonymous, I cannot have the slightest doubt.

"Alcoholics Anonymous is at least saved — even from me!"

Jim MacDonald, New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island

The General Service Conference Inventory — Why Is It Necessary?

My name is Lela Meinke, and I'm an alcoholic. It's my honor to serve California Northern Interior Area (CNIA 07) as Panel 62 delegate on the Literature Committee. I love Alcoholics Anonymous! I've been asked to share about "The General Service Conference

Inventory — Why Is It Necessary?" while keeping in mind the Conference theme "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action."

In both 1981 and 1993, the theme of the General Service Conference related to A.A. taking its inventory. The theme for the 2013 Conference has a different emphasis, specifically that the General Service Conference takes its inventory. This historic event will span three years, 2013-2015, in which we'll look extensively at such topics as our overall effectiveness and yearlong process effectiveness; our composition; our committee system; preparation, scheduling and logistics; the General Service Board and corporate boards; and leadership in A.A.

From the 1993 *Final Report*: "The Conference reminds Gene Benson, delegate from the state of Oklahoma, of an old Indian legend: A group of Indians sat in a circle with an eagle feather, representing the Truth, in the center. Each Indian was asked to describe the feather, and each saw it a different way and from an individual point of view — but the Truth never changes."

Later this week, we'll be gathering in small discussion circles sharing about five of the 15 questions. For some of us our perspective comes with many years of Conference experience while others will be asked to share about the Conference without having yet fully experienced it even once. We have terms and concepts with complicated layers. One Panel 63 delegate said she anticipates that it will feel a little like a newcomer going to her first A.A. group business meeting which is taking its inventory.

Through our principles of inclusion, unity, right of participation, and right of minority opinion, we'll experience all the different perspectives around the circle. Personally, I will be praying to watch my motive that I am keeping our primary purpose first and foremost in my mind and heart. To remember that universal respect is the key to my usefulness. That I am sharing based on principles before personalities. That there is no us and them, there is only we. I'll be asking for help in seeking first to understand, then to be understood.

Why is an inventory necessary? I asked a few people why we need an inventory. One past delegate shared emphatically, "I need one." A current D.C.M. responded that we need "to make sure Alcoholics Anonymous is still relevant."

Page 64 of the fourth edition Big Book reads: "A business which takes no regular inventory usually goes broke. Taking a commercial inventory is a fact-finding and fact-facing process. It is an effort to discover the truth about the stock-in-trade. One object is to disclose damaged or unsalable goods, to get rid of them promptly and without regret."

Why now? Alcoholics Anonymous is on the precipice of change. In the new Grapevine title, *Happy, Joyous & Free*, there is a great quote. "There are just two things an alcoholic doesn't like — the way things are, and change."

Our primary purpose hasn't changed, but there are things that are changing. Our self-support model has been shifting. The logistics of publishing, commerce, distribution and communication — these are changing. Significantly.

We have choices that we need to make to ensure that we use our precious resources prudently. Our inventory is an invitation to participate in a transparent, honest and loving dialogue about how we go about making these choices. It's an opportunity to review the logistics of leadership, while preserving our beautiful Concepts.

Logistics are changing, but our primary purpose has remained the same. Our whole purpose is so that one alcoholic can work with another, showing that there is a way out of the darkness.

I trust that our reflection and conversations will evolve us to the next place of understanding. On an individual level, each of us will be different for having had the experience, and we will each

carry that with us. Collectively, we will have a new view of the truth. Inventory group reports will be presented, suggestions may turn into future agenda items, and the cycle will continue.

I will close with a quote that a past delegate recently shared with me, attributing it to a past archivist. I think it's a beautiful invitation for us all as we begin our week. "Begin where you are. Step out in faith. Do what you can gracefully. Expect God to help."

Lela Meinke, California Northern Interior

Self-Support — What Does it Mean to the Fellowship?

First, I want to thank our Conference coordinator for this loving invitation, to present in front of this group, at my last General Service Conference. I knew immediately after seeing my topic, "Self-Support — What Does it Mean to the Fellowship?" that I was not going to talk about the mechanics of the Seventh Tradition, or the principle of money. Rather, I knew I needed to talk about the spirituality inherent in being self-supporting.

Just where did the principle of self-support begin? How about in 1937 when, with the effort to stand tall on our own principles, the New York groups parted company from the Oxford Groups? As explained in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, (p. 74), "Naturally enough, they did not think too highly of our objective, limited as

it was to alcoholics. From our point of view, we felt very sure we couldn't do much about helping the Oxford Groups to save the whole world. But we were becoming more certain every day that we might be able to sober up many alcoholics." This may have also been one of our first looks at an unknown Tradition Five.

Or what about in 1939, with the publication of *Alcoholics Anonymous*? Of course the book would surely generate money, but more importantly, it was the written word of our unique message, that we could get and stay sober, and precisely how to do so. Now that book exists all over the world, and is translated into 68 languages insuring that everybody who suffers as we have has a chance to recover from this disease.

Or maybe we became self-supportive during the most noted series of events, which started in 1937 with our early members meeting some friends of John D. Rockefeller, Jr. Rockefeller even then had told us that money would spoil this thing. Then, at a dinner in 1940, where once again we were convinced that these men of wealth and power would satisfy our financial needs, we were given the knowledge that we could and should stand on our own.

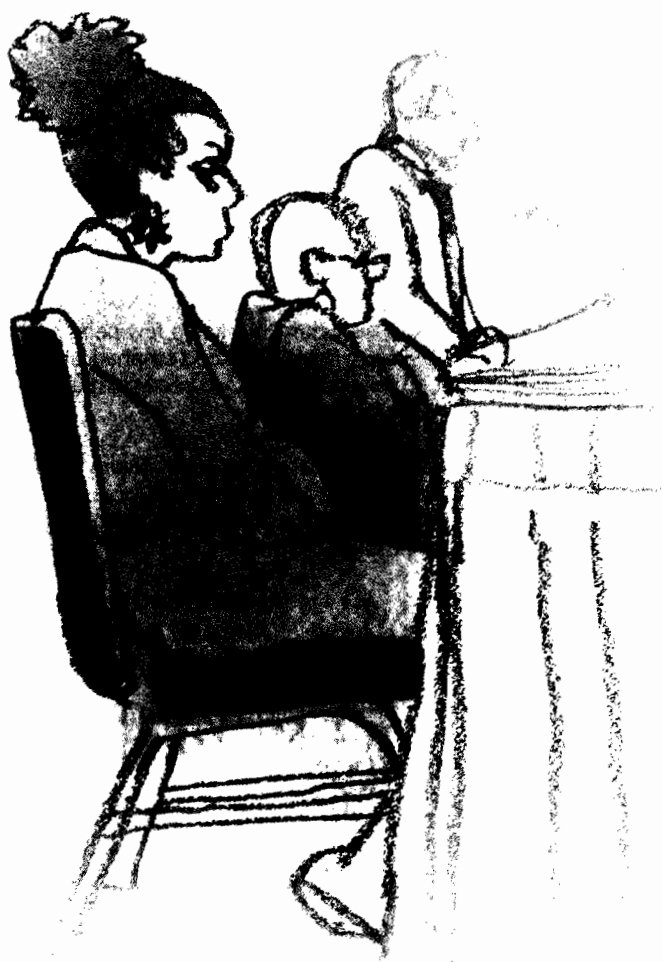
And then there is the undated decline of a \$10,000 donation. I'll read a portion of a paragraph from *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, (p. 114). "When the newspapers got hold of these facts, there was a profound reaction. To people familiar with endless drives for charitable funds, A.A. presented a strange and refreshing spectacle. Approving editorials, both here and abroad, generated a great new wave of confidence in the integrity of Alcoholics Anonymous. They pointed out that the irresponsible had become responsible, and that by making financial independence part of its tradition, Alcoholics Anonymous had revived an ideal that this era had almost forgotten."

Self-support is much more than being financially stable, it begins with our selfless desire to get sober and then in turn to help others in the same way. It also means to insure that today, and in the future, those who suffer from this disease have a safe place to go, and to receive our consistent message of recovery.

Consider the following August 1987 story from the Grapevine Digital Archives, "More Than Just Money." "I've been wondering whether self-support means more than just money. Does it also mean donation of my time and talents? Does my local intergroup have enough money to carry the message, but not enough man-power to put these funds to use? How about the district and the area? Do I owe A.A. a debt of gratitude worth much more than the dollar or two I put in the basket when it comes around?...In the final analysis, while money is essential in carrying our message, it is useless if I'm not willing to give of myself to put that money to effective use."

My home group is a young peoples group. Sometimes the parents of our young members show up to celebrate the anniversaries of their sons and daughters. One night I was sitting next to a dad and as the basket came around he started to stick his hand in his pocket. I silently told him to please not, that we got this. After the meeting I explained a little about self-support and said that we had been takers our whole lives, and it was now that we have to stand on our own. I then thanked him for trusting us with the care of his son. That moment between two dads was priceless, and I made a new friend.

And all of this ends with our spiritual connection to A.A. as our hand touches the basket as it passes by when we drop in an unknown, to others, anonymous contribution. When we help our own





groups, and then below in the triangle, continue to carry our message of recovery. Hoping that everyday, in some group, in some city that I will never visit, some individual that I will never meet, is given the same opportunity that I was freely given years ago.

Today we have to ask ourselves if we truly believe we are self-supporting if we rely on others to carry our message, such as non-members in the fields of medicine, law and education. We do need these people for the knowledge they possess, in the name of co-operation. But as we know, it says in our Big Book, Forward to Second Edition pages xvi and xvii of the Fourth Edition, "This seemed to prove that one alcoholic could affect another as no nonalcoholic could. It also indicated that strenuous work, one alcoholic with another, was vital to permanent sobriety."

Also importantly today, do we believe we are self-supporting through our own voluntary contributions if we are reliant on the sale of our literature to stay afloat? Especially when we consider that a large portion of those sales are to entities that are not A.A. And what does the future hold for us in the world of hard-copy literature? All important questions.

From *The Language of the Heart*, (p.221), "Our spiritual way of life is safe for future generations if, as a Society, we resist the temptation to receive money from the outside world. But this leaves us with a responsibility—one that every member ought to understand. We cannot skimp when the treasurer of our group passes the hat. Our groups, our areas, and A.A. as a whole will not function unless our services are sufficient and their bills are paid."

But we must remember, that if we let money become a priority, thus giving in to letting money, property and authority divert us from our spiritual aim, it will surely lead us away from our Primary Purpose, our only purpose, to help others achieve sobriety.

Rich Healless, Northern Illinois

Primary Purpose — Carrying the A.A. Message

My name is Pat Moody and I am an alcoholic. First, I want to thank Eva for her loving invitation to give a presentation on "Primary Purpose — Carrying the A.A. Message." This topic scared me enormously. Is our primary purpose our only purpose? Are we carrying the message?

I have always found the Traditions to be the most spiritual part of the program and that is where I began doing research on my topic. Tradition Five states, "Each group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." The Twelve and Twelve opens the discussion of this Tradition with the quote "Shoemaker, stick to thy last." What does this mean? A quick Google search indicates that this is actually a commonly used Dutch expression. A "last" is a shoemaker's or cobbler's tool used as a form for making shoes. The expression generally means to stick with what you know and makes much more sense, at least to me, when the word "last" is defined in this context. As Bill Wilson continues in his writings in Tradition Five, it is better to do one thing supremely well than many things badly. This Tradition explains the value of singleness of purpose.

As stated in the April/May 2004 *Box 4-5-9*, on the face of it, our singleness of purpose is simplicity itself. Tradition Three, "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking," and Tradition Five seem to have it pretty much covered. But while Tradition Four states that any two or three alcoholics gathered together for the purpose of sobriety can call themselves an A.A. group, provided they have no other affiliation, I think those same two or three alcoholics can come up with an infinite number of interpretations of these two Traditions. No one or two Traditions can adequately guide our Fellowship any more than one or two Steps can fully guide an individual's recovery.

The Long Form of Tradition One states: "Each member of Alcoholics Anonymous is but a small part of a great whole. A.A. must continue to live or most of us will surely die. Hence our common welfare must come first. But individual welfare follows close afterward." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 189). We are then given eleven other Traditions that show us what we must do in order to accomplish the goal of unity that allows recovery. Whether it is a Tradition on unity, authority, membership, autonomy, purpose, affiliation, finance, professionalism, organization, controversy, public relations or anonymity, don't they all provide direction on how we can maintain our focus on carrying the message? The message, of course, is that there is a solution to our alcoholism.

Having the experience of the Washingtonians to draw from, Bill Wilson knew that success in one area did not necessarily translate to success in all areas. The Washingtonians preceded



and, at first blush, seemed to have an active dislike of one another. I fit in perfectly. I joined the group and became active in that group. It took a while, but I eventually came to realize that I was an alcoholic and that when I took a drink I had no control over what I was going to do and that there was a solution if I was willing. I learned all this because I heard the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, one alcoholic talking to another. I learned that if I didn't take a drink and worked the Steps of A.A., my life would get better. It didn't promise me a good job, a license, freedom from depression, a second chance at a great childhood, popularity, or the ability to fit into size 6 jeans. Instead, as I remained sober, worked the Steps and took responsibility, I was able to fix what I could and accept the rest. My life is better than I ever could have imagined because Alcoholics Anonymous was there for me.

In a letter written by Bill Wilson in 1966 and printed in *As Bill Sees It* (p. 79), "An A.A. group, as such, cannot take on all the personal problems of its members, let alone those of nonalcoholics in the world around us. The A.A. group is not, for example, a mediator of domestic relations, nor does it furnish personal financial aid to anyone. Though a member may sometimes be helped in such matters by his friends in A.A., the primary responsibility for the solutions of all his problems of living and growing rests squarely upon the individual himself. Should all A.A. groups attempt this sort of help, its effectiveness and energies would be hopelessly dissipated.

This is why sobriety—freedom from alcohol—through the teaching and practice of A.A.'s Twelve Steps, is the sole purpose of the group. If we don't stick to this cardinal principle, we shall almost certainly collapse. And if we collapse we cannot help anyone."

I came to Alcoholics Anonymous out of desperation, but I stayed because of the message I heard here. I stayed because the people here had a problem with alcohol, just like me. I could not deny I was an alcoholic because the stories I heard, the feelings I heard, and the recovery I heard were so similar to my own. From my experiences with my rather personally incompatible group members, I realized that this was a program that put the welfare of a group of alcoholics above the individual personalities of the members.

I love this program and want it to be here for my relatives, friends and all alcoholics born and unborn to have the opportunity to recover if that is the path they choose. I do fear that if the message gets diluted it may get lost. I am here because I am responsible, as we all are, to maintain the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Bill W. often said that one of A.A.'s greatest strengths is its single-minded focus on one thing and one thing only. By limiting its primary purpose to carrying the message to alcoholics, and avoiding all other activities, A.A. is able to do that one thing supremely well. The atmosphere of identification is preserved by that purity of focus, and alcoholics get help.

I want this program to remain viable for generations yet to come. If we are to find anything through our inventory, I hope that we identify and strengthen what we do well as a Conference, bringing together the conscience of the groups we all represent to best carry the message to the next sick and suffering alcoholic.

Patricia Moody, Rhode Island

A.A. by nearly 100 years and were successful in the treatment of alcoholics until they began to branch out into other social welfare issues. Early A.A.s saw that we had a successful formula for some to recover from alcoholism. This did not mean that this formula could eradicate all self-destructive traits. When you think about it, wouldn't it be presumptuous of any of us to think that just because we have found a way of life to help ourselves, that our way of life can solve everybody's problems? As Bill Wilson wrote in *A.A. Comes of Age*, (p. 232), "There are those who predict that A.A. may well become a new spearhead for a spiritual awakening throughout the world. When our friends say these things they are both generous and sincere. But we of A.A. must reflect that such a tribute and such a prophecy could well prove to be a heady drink for most of us — that is, if we really came to believe this to be the real purpose of A.A., and if we commenced to behave accordingly. Our society, therefore, will prudently cleave to its single purpose: the carrying of the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Let us resist the proud assumption that since God has enabled us to do well in one area we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody."

When I came to Alcoholics Anonymous fourteen years ago, I had a lot of problems. Quite a few of them were as a direct result of my use and abuse of alcohol, but I could not see that. At the time I would have told you that I drank because of my problems. I was willing to consider that just maybe I had taken my coping strategy to a level that was having a negative impact on my life and that I was unable to simply drink in moderation. In fact, I required hospitalization to safely sober up. I wasn't convinced I had to stop drinking forever, but maybe A.A. could help me with a "time-out."

Fortunately for me, because I had no car, license, or friends with cars, there was an A.A. meeting down the hill from my house. The group was a motley crew who not only wouldn't normally mix

FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Terry Bedient, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. Slides referenced in this report are not included in this publication. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Terry Bedient and I am a very grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the treasurer's report to the 63rd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor will be included in the *Final Conference Report* and auditor partner Kevin Sunkel was here yesterday for the joint meeting. Available throughout the week are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, Grapevine controller. Our goal is to help you become familiar with our financial condition so that you can communicate clearly to your area. Enhancing our understanding of finance is one sure way to improve the service structure. Your area will be listening carefully to what you report after the Conference, so let us know what we can do to enhance the communication.

To begin our review of the financial position of our General Service Office, A.A. World Services Publishing activities, La Viña, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the Reserve Fund, we will review 2012 results, 2013 budget, and discuss thoughts for 2014 and 2015.

"Around the Picnic Table" is a phrase coined at the 59th Conference. It means that much of the finance discussion during Conference is "preaching to the choir." But what we really need to do is plan for better communication as members talk around the picnic table.

Our conversations this week will emphasize the importance of self-support and Slide 1 lists a few things to consider in communicating with the Fellowship about finance. Focus on the spiritual value of contributing with examples of how contributions get used. Yes, we are facing some financial challenges, but our service structure is designed to foster responsibility and stability. Members can be confident that trusted servants are accountable, based on the checks and balances that have been built into the financial structure of staff, accountants, auditors and officers. Humanize the numbers. If a \$9 million G.S.O. Services budget seems intimidating, we can talk in terms of \$6 per member or \$139 per group (shown on Slide 4).

Corporate Poverty is more a state of mind than the size of our bank account. How much is enough to ensure our financial stability? I'm told that this question comes up from time to time. One must remember that even Bill W. recognized that needs change over time.

If you look at the text of the Seventh Tradition worked out in the early '50s, Bill wrote of a financial policy that stated "Bare running expense plus a prudent reserve would henceforth be the Foundation's financial policy."

Fast forward a decade to when the Concepts were adopted and you see the text of Warranty Two: "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve, should be its prudent financial principle."

Hmmm ----- in ten years Bill went from *bare* expenses and a *prudent* reserve to *Sufficient* operating funds and an *ample* Reserve.

From a 1994 sharing session at a General Service Board weekend, a past trustee offered that Bill felt the Reserve and money as a balancing act. "Too much and we argue over perilous wealth and power and lose sight of our primary purpose of carrying the message. Too little, and we risk losing the ability to carry the message at all. So he (Bill) spoke for both sides in different places." He

also offered that "A strong Reserve Fund is one of the prices we have to pay to assure that no one but the Fellowship sets our financial policies."

Slide 2 summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office. I am sure we are familiar with the functions listed, with the possible exception of the last line, entitled Supporting Services. This includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of G.S.O. functions for 2012 was \$8,933,347, which is 2.1% more than in 2011. Most of the Functional cost centers showed slight increases, but I will highlight a few differences. In 2012 the General Service Conference was held at Rye Brook, New York, a more economical property than in midtown New York City. In 2012 we had the World Service Meeting (also at Rye Brook, New York), and the net cost, which falls to G.S.O., was \$212,500 for which there is no comparative cost in 2011. There was a reduction of approximately 12% in the Overseas services category. Included in this category is the cost of Foreign Literature Assistance we provide to start up structures around the world. In 2012 there were fewer requests than in the past.

Slide 3 is similar, except that Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. Group and member statistics are shown at the bottom of the slide.

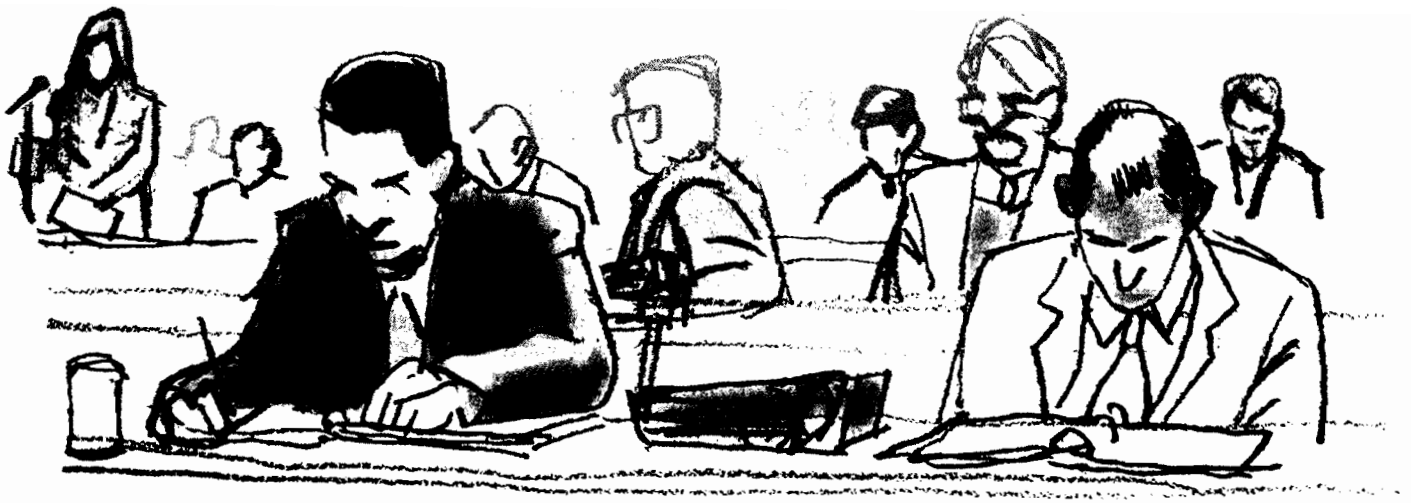
Slide 4. Here, we have displayed a few member statistics. We see that an annual contribution of only \$6.43 per member or \$138.69 per group in 2012 would have allowed the Service side to be fully self-supporting from contributions. How do we arrive at these numbers? It is just a simple calculation of costs shown on financial statements divided by the number of members or groups shown on the Contribution statistical report. And remember, those numbers are only as good as the data we can capture in an Anonymous Fellowship.

Slide 5 gives a partial view of Group Service activities. This is intended to give a broader understanding of the extraordinary range of services performed by your G.S.O. on behalf of each group. A complete list of activities is available on the aa.org Web site and as a handout at Forums.

In 2012 (Slide 6), the General Service Board received contributions of \$6,557,608, which was an increase of approximately \$293,000, or 4.6% greater than last year. —Thank You!! — The year 2012 marked an increase in Contributions received from both A.A. members and groups.

Self-Support Efforts—The trustees' Finance Subcommittee on Self-Support has worked diligently throughout the year with a goal toward ensuring sustainable self-support initiatives. With print media declining, it is vital that our Fellowship will need to look at our practice of the Seventh Tradition to carry us through the coming years. Delegates, other trusted servants, and G.S.O. have contributed many creative and practical ways to communicate the message of self-support, and we are thankful for everyone's participation. One of the most popular has been the restoration of our November Gratitude Month and sharing on the use of our Birthday Envelopes. In fact, all this sharing has produced great results. Birthday envelopes have been "flying out the door" to groups, areas and members! The secret to self-support may very well be in sustained communication — and it is here where we need your continued help.

I am sure I speak for everyone when I say how deeply grateful we are for this support from across the Fellowship. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help ensure that G.S.O. can continue to provide services for your members and groups, as well as translations and assistance to countries around



the globe. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. And I hope information from this Conference will help to assist in your communication about self-support around the picnic table.

Slide 7: summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2012 amounted to \$12,620,075, which was about 1.2% less than 2011, or \$148,770. After deducting the cost of goods sold, shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$7,878,316, or 63.7% of net sales. We then deduct Program expenses of \$2,914,348 and Supporting expenses of \$2,115,073. A.A.W.S. had an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$2,848,895. Prior reports have noted the importance of maintaining a realistic Gross Profit percentage, which A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. continue to monitor.

La Viña (Slide 8), our Spanish-language magazine, reported a loss greater than budget, due in part to additional costs resulting from a prior Conference Action and allocation of benefits. Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items equaled \$65,465, a decrease of about \$5,300 from 2011. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$181,285, the result is a loss for 2012 of \$115,820. This compares to a loss in 2011 of \$69,723 and a loss of \$75,480 in 2010. A loss of \$127,179 has been budgeted for 2013. Please remember that La Viña's direct expenses are paid from the General Fund, which houses all contributions. (Benefit costs of employees working on La Viña have been allocated to La Viña.)

A.A. Grapevine (Slide 9) turned a significant profit in 2012 of \$257,003. Over the year, you have heard of extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,342,913 in 2012. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,525,250. Gross profit from related items was approximately \$423,667, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,948,917. Total Costs and expenses of \$1,706,714 are deducted and then Interest Income of \$14,800 is recorded. The result was a profit of \$257,003, as compared to a budgeted profit of \$34,284. You may recall that during 2012 the Grapevine moved to smaller quarters to reduce expenses. The Grapevine budget for 2013 anticipates a profit of \$11,954.

Slide 10 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2012. The G.S.O. shows contributions, interest, and literature profits totaling \$9,406,577. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$9,254,132, which leaves a positive result for 2012 of \$152,445. To this we add the \$257,003 operating profit of Grapevine and the La Viña loss of (\$115,820). This results in a 2012 bottom line from operations of \$293,628. This positive bottom line assists in keep-

ing the Reserve Fund on an even keel.

Slide 11 is similar to the information shown on slide 10 but with a little bit more information on the expense side.

Slide 12 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, G.S.O. and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, the General Service Office has only two sources of money: contributions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund. Historically, G.S.O. has relied on literature sales to help balance the budget. As mentioned in previous slides, we will be looking to contributions for greater, long-term assistance with this obligation.

Slide 13 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, Grapevine and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, Grapevine has only two sources of money: subscriptions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than is necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund.

Slide 14 covers the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2012 with an adjusted balance of \$15,261,452, equal to approximately 11.3 months of operating expenses. At the end of 2011, the Reserve Fund balance was the equivalent of 11.9 months of operating expenses. Many of you know that a 1977 Conference Advisory Action asked our Auditor to comment annually on the adequacy of the Reserve Fund. Our understanding of *The A.A. Service Manual* is that the Reserve Fund is for infrastructure investments or extraordinary circumstances, but not to fund long-term obligations. For 2012, our Auditor has stated that without reference to long-term obligations, "the question of adequacy is answered in the affirmative."

Slide 15. Over the past decade, a number of actions have been taken to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. Big Book prices were reduced \$1 with publication of the 4th Edition, then restored in 2004; selected book prices and handling charges were raised in 2005; G.S.O. accomplished a major cost reduction program in 2007 and 2008; in 2009, both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine implemented price increases. 2014 will be an interesting year with some price adjustments anticipated.

Slide 16. This chart shows the value of the dollar from the early days of A.A. up to modern times. If some supported services with a dollar in 1945 they would need to contribute \$12.90 today just to support those same services. Think about this, what was the price of a drink when you stopped drinking and what is it today?

Slide 17. Our Auditor continues to remind us of long-term obligations for post employment commitments to current employees and retirees, for both pension and medical benefits. These obligations are funded out of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine operations. With

regard to Pension, A.A. has for its employees a Defined Benefit Pension Program, which was established in 1965. By law, Column A must nearly equal Column B in about 5 years. The unfunded Pension Liability on the balance sheet is about \$10.3 million. A.A.W.S. and Grapevine have included paying down this liability into their budgets. We will need to sustain an annual level of fund payments of approximately averaging \$1,900,000 for the next several years. Our Pension and postretirement health obligations now account for about 12% of the G.S.O. budget. Our benefit plans should be periodically reviewed, but remember that as long as G.S.O. remains in business, pension benefits, which have already accrued cannot be changed.

Pension review — Last year we reported that a subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011. Their objective is to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. Plan implementation was targeted for January 2013. This has been accomplished with a new DC plan being established for new employees hired 1/1/2013 and after.

Slide 18. Based on future projections from both G.S.O. and Grapevine, we may well be relying more on contributions in the coming years. So remember, "A dollar ain't what it used to be." Self-Support efforts seem to be taking hold.

Next is an overview of what G.S.O. and Grapevine think may occur. The trustees, Finance Committee and your General Service Board will continue to monitor financial Budgets, estimates and projections with an eye toward fiscal prudence.

I am pleased to acknowledge the extraordinary talent and dedication that I am privileged to observe as treasurer. Thank you to members of all the finance committees who sort through enormous detail throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Ami Brophy for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers. 2013 will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the continuing hard economic times. But there will be new groups and more members and unlimited opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper.

And remember, Finance has no importance in and of itself. Finance is simply a way to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

*Terry Bedient, treasurer,
General Service Board*

WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Wednesday afternoon Conference members heard a report on the 22nd WSM, held last October.

A.A. Around the World

My name is Barb, I am alcoholic and have the privilege of serving Alcoholics Anonymous as trustee-at-large/Canada. I share this position with Don Massey, trustee-at-large/US.

The purpose of the World Service Meeting (WSM) is to carry the message of recovery, unity and service to alcoholics who still suffer, wherever in the world they may be, and whatever language they may speak.

The World Service Meeting is held in alternate years to the REDELA, which is a Spanish acronym meaning the Meeting of the

Americas. The theme for the 22nd World Service Meeting was "Rotation — The Heartbeat of A.A." Our General Service Board was host to the 22nd WSM, which was held in Rye Brook, NY, October 21-25, 2012. A total delegation of 61 members attended, representing 34 countries and time zones. The procedure and recommendation used for countries to be able to attend the WSM is that a country have an operating General Service Board, and/or a literature distribution center and, in addition, have had a delegate attend zonal meetings.

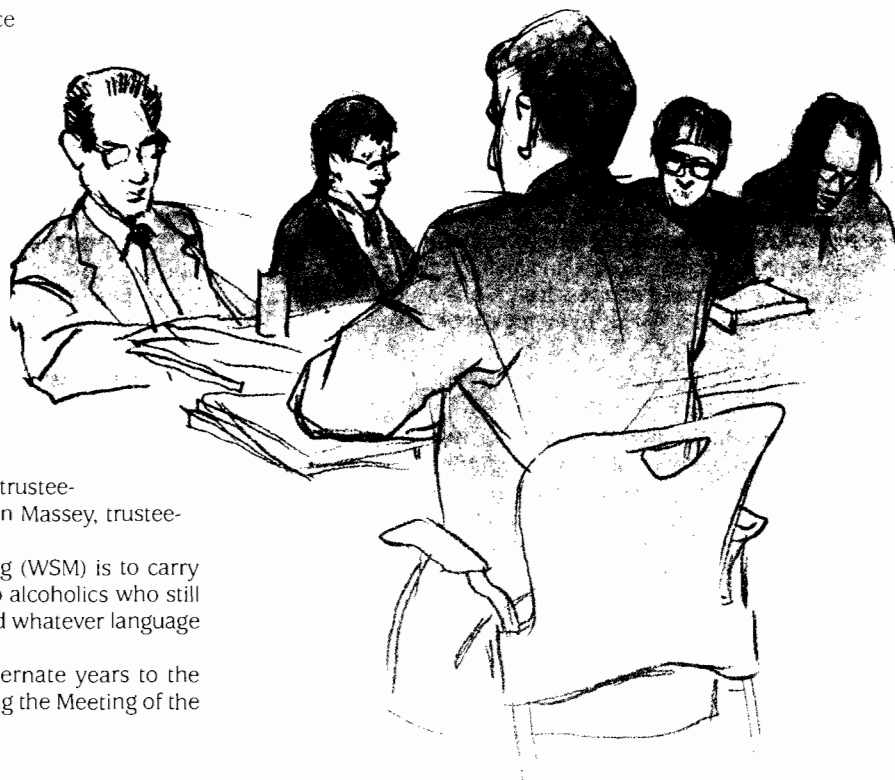
Ward Ewing, chair of US/Canada GSB opened the meeting on Sunday with a warm welcome to all. The Roll was called and orientation was presented by Phyllis Halliday, general manager of G.S.O., US/Canada. The keynote address, "Rotation — The Heartbeat of A.A.," was given by Tomasz Lysiak, the delegate from Poland. Following the keynote address each country presented their country highlights.

Through the week of fellowship there were numerous presentations and workshops. The WSM has four working committees: Agenda, Literature & Publishing, Policy/Admissions/Finance and Working with Others. The site-selection committee met and the result was that Warsaw will host the 2014 WSM, October 12-16, 2014.

I sensed a warm, wonderful and heart-felt message from each of the second-term delegates as they gave their closing remarks. The WSM closed on Thursday, October 25th, with Ward B. Ewing, GSB chair, giving a closing talk. This was followed by the Serenity Prayer, said in all languages represented at the 22nd WSM.

Later that evening our guests attended the banquet with some wonderful entertainment; we also heard two young A.A. members share their stories of recovery. Some of our guests were staying to observe our General Service Board's board weekend, when Hurricane Sandy struck, airports closed and many of us were stranded. However, this gave us time to get to know each other even more. I look forward to seeing some of these wonderful delegates again in Poland for the 23rd World Service Meeting.

Barbara Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada



■ Report of the 2013 General Service Conference Inventory

“The General Service Conference Takes its Inventory — Our Solution in Action”

As suggested by the 2013 General Service Conference theme, taking inventory, in the best sense of the word, is a fundamental aspect of A.A.'s program of recovery. As cofounder Bill W. reflected in *A.A. Comes of Age* (page 231), “Just as each A.A. must continue to take his moral inventory and act upon it, so must our whole society if we are to survive and if we are to serve usefully and well.”

An inventory, then, at the level of general service is a natural outgrowth of that which is done to maintain individual sobriety throughout the A.A. Fellowship. However, when applied to A.A.'s general services and for the purposes of the General Service Conference inventory, the “Twelve Concepts for World Service,” not the Twelve Steps for recovery, provide the lens through which to evaluate current Conference practices and procedures, to determine how they relate to the original plan, purpose and structure of the General Service Conference, now in its 64th year.

As noted in the Keynote Address at the opening of the 2013 General Service Conference, “Self-assessment is a pervasive part of our A.A. program; fully half of our Steps are directly related to it. Inventory of the Conference and personal inventory in the Steps are not quite the same, however. At the Conference, the emphasis will be on effectiveness in carrying out the purposes of the Conference, not on ‘character defects.’”

“Honesty, both with ourselves and with others, is a core value of A.A.... We don't take inventory simply because it is, in and of itself, a good thing (like kindness, or generosity), but rather because it is an important element of our continued sobriety. The same holds true for our service inventories, including the Conference inventory which we are now undertaking. We are not here to take pride in doing the responsible thing by taking an inventory. We are here to help assure the unity and effectiveness of A.A. in its mission to carry the great message of hope to anyone, anywhere, who has a desire to do something about his or her drinking problem.”

In terms of the General Service Conference inventory, the question could be asked: why now? In response, one delegate wrote in a 2013 Conference presentation titled “The General Service Conference Inventory — Why Is It Necessary?” “Alcoholics Anonymous is on the precipice of change. In the new Grapevine title, *Happy, Joyous & Free*, there is a great quote. ‘There are just two things an alcoholic doesn't like — the way things are, and change.’”

“Our primary purpose hasn't changed, but there are things that are changing. Our self-support model has been shifting. The logistics of publishing, commerce, distribution and communication — these are changing. Significantly.

“We have choices that we need to make to ensure that we use our precious resources prudently. Our inventory is an invitation to participate in a transparent, honest and loving dialogue about how we go about making these choices. It's an opportunity to review the logistics of leadership, while preserving our beautiful Concepts.”

History

In his introduction to the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, Bill W. wrote about the importance of the Concepts as an interpretation of A.A.'s world service structure. “They reveal the evolution by which it has arrived in its present form, and they detail the experience and reasoning on which our operation stands today,” he said. “These Concepts therefore aim to record the ‘why’ of our service structure in such a fashion that the highly valuable experience of the past, and the lessons we have drawn from that experience, can never be forgotten or lost.”

In that spirit, in 2005 the General Service Board began the process of taking an inventory of itself, including its two operating

corporations, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. As the inventories continued throughout 2006, the chairperson of the General Service Board appointed an Ad Hoc Committee on Inventories to review the three Board inventories (A.A. Grapevine, A.A.W.S., and the GSB) and to prioritize suggestions for Board consideration. As this process was nearing completion, in April 2008, a sitting regional trustee suggested to the General Service Board that the inventory process might also expand to cover the General Service Conference itself, examining its structure, processes and procedures.

Some of the possible items that could be given thorough study, it was suggested, were: the effectiveness of the current committee system, the impact of new technologies on A.A.'s group conscience process, a creeping politicization of the Conference process versus the policy of delegation and trust, and the role of the trustees in the Conference process — as principal planners and administrators or mere order takers?

A General Service Board subcommittee was formed in August 2008 to discuss this proposal for a General Service Conference Inventory and presented a final report to the GSB in February 2009. After reviewing the history of other Conference inventories, the conclusion of the subcommittee was that while presentations and workshops had been held at the 1963, 1981 and 1993 Conferences, where the theme of each Conference was “A.A. Takes Its Inventory,” an actual inventory of the General Service Conference itself had never been conducted, and the subcommittee agreed that it seemed reasonable to conclude that “a thorough and soul-searching examination” of the GSC was warranted.

The Idea Moves to the Conference

The subcommittee recommended that the General Service Board forward a recommendation to the 2009 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions proposing that a comprehensive inventory of the GSC be undertaken. The GSB accepted the subcommittee's recommendation and forwarded such a proposal to the 2009 Conference. Provided as background were the full report of the subcommittee, including some detailed suggestions for conducting a GSC inventory, and the original proposal for a Conference Inventory.

The 2009 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee reviewed the material and recommended to the full Conference that: “The General Service Board develop a plan for the General Service Conference to conduct an inventory of itself that includes a planning committee consisting of representatives of delegates, trustees, directors, nontrustee directors, and staff, and that a progress report be presented to the 2010 Policy/Admissions Committee.”

The recommendation was passed as a Conference Advisory Action, and in August 2009 the GSB established a subcommittee to fulfill the charge of putting together a process or procedure by which a Planning Committee with representation from all membership segments of the General Service Conference could be established. The subcommittee determined that representation should be proportional, as representation is at the GSC, and that participants be selected by lot, with consideration given to other responsibilities and ability to serve. These conclusions were accepted by the GSB, along with some additional suggestions regarding the establishment of a Conference Inventory Planning Committee, and were referred back to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee in 2010.

After evaluation and discussion by the 2010 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and deliberation by the entire Conference, a detailed Advisory Action was passed recommending that “The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself and that a Conference Planning Committee be established to

develop a comprehensive inventory plan to bring forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for consideration, along with an estimated cost for conducting the inventory.” The Advisory Action also included directions articulating the specific composition of the proposed planning committee.

Planning Committee Takes Shape

Once constituted following the 2010 GSC, the Conference Inventory Planning Committee (made up of 17 individuals: 11 Panel 60 delegates, one Class B regional trustee, one Class B general service trustee, one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, one nontrustee director, one G.S.O. staff person and one Grapevine staff person, along with a nonvoting G.S.O. staff member to serve as secretary to the committee) began to conduct its business in early June 2010, breaking the work up into a series of subcommittees whose task, collectively, was to answer the “Who, What, Where, When and How” of conducting an inventory of the Conference.

Four subcommittees were charged with looking into the mechanics of doing an inventory (Participation, Logistics, Reporting and Finance) and four additional subcommittees were charged with developing proposed inventory questions (Structure, Concepts, Communications and Leadership). All subcommittee recommendations were discussed and voted on by the full committee during monthly conference calls and eventually, after several months of deliberation and reporting, the committee had a set of approved recommendations from which to begin drafting the overall inventory plan.

At this time, the eight subcommittees were pooled together and two larger subcommittees were appointed to develop the overall specifics of “mechanics” and “content” for the proposed inventory. Similarly, these two subcommittees presented their conclusions for discussion and approval by the Planning Committee as a whole, ultimately creating a consensus document — the Conference Inventory Plan — which was forwarded to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for review.

The 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions reviewed the inventory plan and proposed to the full Conference “that the General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself in accordance with the Comprehensive Plan formulated by the Conference Inventory Planning Committee.” The areas covered by the inventory plan were:

- I. **Logistics** (suggesting that the inventory be conducted at three consecutive Conferences: 2013, 2014 and 2015);
- II. **Participation** (outlining the categories and terms of rotation of Conference members to serve on the Planning Committee);
- III. **Reporting** (detailing a methodology for reporting the Conference inventory, including publication of a thorough report in the *Final Conference Report* of each year of the inventory, along with summaries of each year’s inventory for publication in the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and Box 4-5-9, and a separate comprehensive report of all three years’ input to be prepared after the inventory process is completed);
- IV. **Finance** (developing a cost structure for conducting and reporting the inventory);
- V. **Inventory Questions** (covering the overall effectiveness of the Conference and the Conference process; the composition of the Conference; the committee system; the effectiveness of the yearlong process; Conference preparation, in terms of background, content, delivery, etc.; the Conference week schedule; the General Service Board and corporate boards; and the question of leadership and what might be

the most desirable qualities considered for leaders in A.A.)

The recommendation was accepted by the full Conference and passed as an Advisory Action of the 2011 General Service Conference.

With the process and procedures for the inventory finally set, the 2012 Conference Agenda Committee made a series of recommendations, accepted as Advisory Actions, suggesting that the theme of the 2013 GSC be “The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action”; selecting presentation/discussion topics for the 2013 GSC; and presenting the specific inventory questions to be taken up by the 2013, 2014 and 2015 Conferences.

2013 General Service Conference

To address the 15 inventory questions proposed for the 2013 GSC and to allow for an equitable and representative cross-section of Conference members, three different groupings were created to address questions 1-5, 6-10, and 11-15, with each segment further broken down into 5 subgroups for each set of questions. Conference members were then assigned to one of the 15 different workshop groups, each with a moderator and reporter, and each containing 9 total participants. Meeting for two-and-a-half hours during the Conference on Wednesday, April 24, the full range of inventory questions was covered by Conference members, with reports prepared from each workshop group.

Subsequently, each group reported directly to the full Conference on Friday, April 26, with additional discussion held after each grouping of workshop reports.

Summary of 2013 Inventory

Question 1:

Reflecting on Concept I, how well does the Conference ensure that it is the conscience of A.A. as a whole?

The Conference, as designed, is highly effective in ensuring the conscience of A.A. as a whole, taking the place of Bill W. and Dr. Bob; communication has to travel in both directions — from trustees/delegates to the groups, and back; as the Conference becomes more transparent it allows delegates to better collect the area’s voice and ensure that the groups can weigh in on topics they feel are important.

Under the guidance of the Concepts, the collective conscience of A.A. is achieved through full and open debate, minority opinions, right of decision, floor actions, right of participation and other similar practices; however, we could do better at reaching out to our membership regarding the Conference process; the Conference meets to “take A.A.’s temperature,” but there are concerns about how informed the Fellowship actually is due to inadequate background material, arbitrary agenda deadlines and language barriers; there is not sufficient delegate participation in development of Conference agenda items and the year-long Conference process concept needs to be highlighted to better serve the needs of the local A.A. communities.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Encourage groups to participate more fully in the Conference process.*
- *Feedback from the areas is very important to delegates and the current schedule for distributing background material and the agenda makes it difficult to have area membership discussions; reevaluate timing of current schedule for developing, selecting and submitting agenda items.*

- *All Conference members should have information in their mother tongue; Conference communications with the Hispanic community need to be more inclusive; if it is too unwieldy to do it beforehand, consider translating agenda items and background material after the agenda is distributed.*

Question 2:

How well is the use of floor actions serving us?

Floor actions can provide a failsafe mechanism to get an issue back on track or provide an opportunity for an issue to be heard; floor actions emphasize that everyone has a place to express their opinion; they are a protection for the minority voice; however, there are very few emergencies in A.A. and the Conference has the power to decide whether or not to hear a floor action.

Not being on the agenda, floor actions bypass the committee system and often need time for thought, consideration, input from the Fellowship and pertinent background information; floor actions should generally be discouraged, but in certain instances are needed.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Provide background information to delegates on floor actions and the process by which they are handled at the Conference.*

Question 3:

Reflecting on Concept X, how well is the authority of the Conference defined?

Overall, the Conference Charter and the scope of Conference authority are clear, with checks and balances defined by tradition and spiritual principles; sometimes, though, there is a difference between definition and application, with a fine balance between too little definition of the Conference's authority and too much; the Conference and the General Service Board are interdependent and need to work closely together to avoid creating given responsibility without commensurate authority.

The Conference is the place where business and spirituality mix, and the current composition of the Conference continues to provide an adequate balance of authority and responsibility.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Delegates should stay better plugged into board activities throughout the year.*
- *Concerns exist regarding the unequal authority of the GSB to set the Conference agenda; review how agenda items are developed and consider greater inclusion of delegates in this process.*

Question 4:

How well does the Conference fulfill the General Warranties of Concept XII?

The Conference is excellent at encompassing a wide variety of abilities, shows impartial restraint and is an honest and open process — ever evolving, ever changing — and the Conference structure itself provides an adequate safeguard to protect A.A. from any misuse of authority, whether actual or perceived; the Warranties provide us with a dock of safe return, teaching us how to treat one another, guiding us away from “us” and “them” and tying us together as one.

Rotation helps to avoid accumulation of power; democracy, fairness and equality ensure that all levels of service are the same; substantial unanimity and insistence on the minority opinion are highly valued principles; the Conference exercises stewardship, not governance; however, politics can enter into the picture and there is room for improvement in reducing the influence of past trusted servants on current Conference members.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *In response to an expressed concern about the disenfranchise-*

ment of groups and A.A. as a whole from the general service structure, consider holding the Conference at a less expensive location, perhaps rotating it around the US and Canada to reduce costs and increase participation.

Question 5:

Should delegate areas be more consistently based on actual membership numbers?

Conference composition should not rely on rigid proportional representation by population alone; a variety of factors should be considered, all with the collective goal of good communication within the area.

Small areas and large areas face different challenges; large areas may want to consider the value of breaking down into smaller pieces to spread out necessary service work, while some smaller areas, perhaps, might want to consider merging.

There is a cost in time and money to unity that is different for each area; high and low population density, geography, cultural differences and diversity must all be considered by areas evaluating a change.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Further discussion is needed on the question of whether or not our largest member centers should consider resizing.*
- *When evaluating the possible resizing of areas, the “domino effect” that changing areas would have on groups, districts, regions, boards, committees and the Conference should be considered.*
- *The redistricting of delegate areas is not thought to be feasible or necessary at this time and if it is to be considered in the future a clear census and rationale should be provided.*

Question 6:

What improvements could be considered to make sure the agenda selection is more effective?

Agenda selection is a year-long process which could be enhanced by more education at the group level regarding the ability of groups to participate in the formulation of items; agenda items need to be for the good of the whole Fellowship.

The Fellowship could be better informed about trustee discussions — some trustees supply minutes from their meetings, though this is not universal and the G.S.O. reporting is seen as too general; the role of the regional trustee is vital in developing awareness of agenda items that may be coming up throughout the year.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Increased communication throughout the Fellowship is necessary for an informed Conference; create/distribute a simple “how to” description or FAQ outlining the process of getting agenda items submitted.*
- *Agenda selection should be emphasized as a year-long process, with more involvement from the Conference Agenda Committee.*

Question 7:

How well do all Conference members communicate to the Fellowship about why we have a Conference and how the committee system works? How could we improve in this communication?

Most Conference members are informed about the committee system and how it works; the difficulty is in reaching those who are “not part of the choir.”

Increasing participation in the Conference process throughout the Fellowship is a primary concern, with some areas having great success and others finding it more difficult to engage and educate

members; areas with mock-Conferences, mini-committees, or pre-Conference assemblies find this an effective way to educate the Fellowship about the Conference; the use of technology could be helpful in reaching out to D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, especially through videos.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *While we encourage areas to come up with agenda items, if they're not "selected" it can be very discouraging for those at the local level. Perhaps agenda items that don't make it to the Conference should go to the appropriate Conference Committee anyway, for discussion at a time outside the week-long duration of the Conference.*
- *Make Conference agenda information and background material available to the Fellowship and continually update throughout the year.*
- *Develop/distribute guidelines that explain exactly how a Conference committee operates and what their options are when they meet.*

Question 8:

How well do the delegates balance their preparation for the Conference, especially in keeping with Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter? How could we improve in the practice of our rights and responsibilities under Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter?

Delegates sometimes feel overwhelmed with the amount of information that must be gone through and so must prioritize; Concept III acts as a reminder that the job of the Conference is to set policy, not set practice.

Right of Decision is a great responsibility, carrying with it the importance of providing reasons why a decision was made; explaining the "reasoning" behind conclusions reached at the Conference is helpful throughout the Fellowship.

Importance of Concept III in making distinction between sharing experience and lobbying; put Conference decision-making experience in personal terms when sharing with the Fellowship.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Use technology to develop a secure electronic location where delegates could share and store pertinent Conference information online, clustering information more effectively.*
- *Have a brief delegate orientation at the start of the Conference, similar to the new trustees orientation; might be helpful in generating a more even level of preparedness for delegates (delegate luncheons do not necessarily fulfill this purpose, as they are not uniform and may each cover different topics).*

Question 9:

How can we improve the way time is allotted during the Conference for reports, presentation/discussion/workshop topics, and thorough discussion of agenda items?

Committee time is precious and there may be too many other Conference activities that draw away from the primary business at hand; it may be helpful to dispose of routine information throughout the year rather than taking actual Conference time.

Conference week is laid out well, has evolved and been improved upon by the process of natural selection; however, Conference could be more dynamic, with presentations eliminated or shortened on the basis of the Conference workload at the time.

Conference is amazingly efficient at cramming a lot of stuff in, but there is a delicate balance between moving the Conference along and ensuring thoughtful, deliberative and inclusive discussion; Conference members need to be concise and respectful of

the limited time the Conference has to do its work; stick to the topic, don't repeat sharing; having a clear understanding of time allotted and work to be covered helps committees reach an informed conscience with all voices heard from.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *If a floor action doesn't pass, wait at least one year to resubmit.*
- *Reevaluate the comparative value of area service highlights and consider fewer presentation/discussions or regional lunches, which would allow for more Conference business; perhaps have area highlights recorded throughout the year and made available electronically, or have them available in a separate room at the Conference or presented at the Delegates Only Meeting.*
- *Set aside time at each Conference to look at future agenda items so that post-Conference reports could be forward-looking to generate year-long sharing.*
- *Consider distributing minutes of all trustee meetings to all delegates.*
- *Consider moving the first "sharing session/what's on your mind?" slot to later in the week, where it might be more valuable.*
- *Utilize technology for electronic voting/tabulation at the Conference.*
- *Consider moving the 2014 and 2015 inventory to a time slot after the Conference to allow for full discussion of current agenda items.*
- *Regional trustees might consider ways to standardize their reports to allow for equally informed delegates, perhaps holding more Q&A sessions at the regional level throughout the year.*

Question 10:

How are leadership and participation affected by late night work sessions?

Late night work sessions may create a negative "badge of honor" that belies the reality that cognitive processes regress and personality conflicts increase as sessions go late, decreasing ability to make informed decisions.

The pace of the Conference should be even, not rushed at the end of the week; Conference members are here to conduct A.A.'s business and while that may take additional time on occasion, we need to reduce repetition: "Is the comment serving me or is the comment serving the body?"

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Implement a time limit for different sessions and close them when the time is up.*

Question 11:

Could the committee process be improved to more effectively introduce change in the Fellowship, and if so, how?

Change should come from the Fellowship and be introduced in a measured way, keeping the flow of information positive; flexibility is a key ingredient in change, and not everything has to be in black and white.

Good communication with the Fellowship is key to dispelling the perception that something is "hidden"; better communication following the Conference and before the July board meeting between the Conference committees and their corresponding trustees' committees could help in the development of appropriate agenda items and background material; cross-pollination between committees could help to alleviate workloads; more involvement from delegates in the development of the agendas would be beneficial; Conference materials need to be made available in other languages to accommodate diversity and facilitate change.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Review the scope of all Conference committees — new committees may be needed.*
- *Sharing between committees throughout the year can help facilitate better understanding of the issues and help introduce change; cross-pollination between committees could ease workloads.*

Question 12:

Is the current makeup of the board (numbers and proportions) still the most effective? If not, what changes should we consider?

The current ratio of board members (Class A/Class B) is adequate, and the continuity of the “pathway” from appointed committee member to nontrustee director to general service trustee is beneficial, especially for those with professional backgrounds; Class A trustees could benefit from more training on the Concepts and Traditions, and service sponsorship for board members, including Class A trustees, can be helpful.

Professional expertise is an important qualification for trustees, though it can also be beneficial to lean on Conference committees for input and suggestions.

Some feel the corporate boards are still not effective and that the numbers and proportions could be revised.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Trustees need to focus on bigger issues and concerns for the Fellowship and not get caught up in administrative details better handled by staff.*
- *Consider increasing the role of nontrustee directors and better describe their purpose to the Fellowship.*
- *Are there still too many Grapevine board members?*

Question 13:

How could we improve the methods used to solicit trustees and directors to get the most appropriate people interested in the positions?

C.P.C. committees can be helpful in recruiting new Class A (non-alcoholic) trustee candidates, and broadly advertising board openings is necessary to cast a wide net; International Conventions can provide good “auditions” for potential Class A positions; Forums are also extremely helpful.

Balance needs to be struck between vision/leadership skills versus professional background when soliciting trustees.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *When soliciting for new trustees and directors, send a mailing to all GSRs regarding openings, don't just rely on delegates.*
- *Focus on the social sciences, technology, finance, publishing, journalism and media worlds for new Class A candidates, with lesser emphasis on the medical and religious fields.*
- *Consider the trustee-at-large positions for inclusion on the corporate boards.*
- *More nonalcoholics could serve as appointed committee members to increase the pool of Class A candidates.*
- *Seek younger candidates for trustee positions, and focus on language/cultural diversity.*
- *Consider shorter terms of service for trustees.*

Question 14:

What more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship?

Good communication is the key to transparency at the board level — let the Fellowship know what's really going on, keep the at-large A.A. member in mind when transmitting information; recording the reasoning behind board decisions helps keep the GSB transparent; transparency brings trust.

Regional trustees need to be more consistent in passing on information to their delegates — an uneven flow of information to delegates can create ill will and lack of trust toward the GSB; continuity in reporting will help the Fellowship better understand what goes on at the board and Conference level.

Communication needs to flow both ways and members need to recognize that all information cannot always be made available due to business concerns, privacy, matters of confidentiality and such, and sometimes information must be held until discussion has been completed on a particular topic; in such cases, patience and trust must be relied upon.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Create continuity on how and what board minutes and reports are distributed to delegates.*
- *A graphic presentation on how the GSB does its work could be prepared/distributed to help the Fellowship better understand what goes on at the GSB level of service.*
- *More articles by trustees in the Grapevine to help familiarize the Fellowship with the board's vision.*
- *Consider regional teleconferences with delegates/regional trustees after board meetings to increase communication and help with transparency issues.*
- *Utilize technology to disseminate information through the G.S.O. Web site or perhaps provide an interactive live webinar to connect members with G.S.O. staff or trustees.*

Question 15:

Reflecting on Concept IX, are the qualities of leadership, as identified in the leadership essay in *The A.A. Service Manual*, still the qualities that we should try to encourage in Conference members? If so, how successful are we in encouraging those qualities? If not, what changes should we consider?

Leadership, integrity, conviction — we need these qualities now more than ever; sponsorship is a key ingredient; humility and working with others.

“Leadership” is not a bad word in A.A. — there must be some for A.A. to function effectively at all levels; we should encourage each other to lead and be willing to follow as well.

Leadership in A.A. should not be a competition; passion and desire are as important as professional background; we should not fear challenging authority; leadership must listen to criticism.

The Conference needs more of the vision quality and a continued willingness to look at what is good overall, not just what may be good for one particular area or segment of the Fellowship.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *To avoid “reading between the lines” by members, it would be helpful for trustees' committees to include more of the motivation behind their proposals, the reasons why they might make a particular suggestion or recommendation.*
- *More awareness of the Concepts throughout the Fellowship will benefit individuals, groups, districts, areas, regions, the Conference and our boards. Consider ways to make these principles more widely understood and available.*

■ Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Greetings and welcome to the 63rd General Service Conference, especially to those who are attending their first Conference. I know we are here to do the "business" of A.A., but I have always viewed the General Service Conference as a spiritual adventure — a lot of hard work, but also exciting and uplifting as we seek to reach an informed group conscience for A.A. in the U.S. and Canada. I believe that a higher power will be present as we address the business that comes before us.

As I'm sure you know, the General Service Board (G.S.B.) did its inventory in 2011 resulting in the action approved in last year's Conference, which led to this year's work on structure and functioning of the board and the two service corporations. I am pleased that Conference is beginning its inventory this year under the theme "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory—Our Solution in Action." This will be a challenging process over the three-year period. I look forward to following the process and to seeing the results.

Before I get into my report I want to note what a fabulous board of trustees you have serving this Fellowship. These are dedicated, intelligent, wise, and at times humorous men and women who give generously of their time and energy for you and for all the members of Alcoholics Anonymous. I am truly humbled to have the privilege of working with them.

The General Service Board has met four times since our last Conference. Aside from the meeting of the members of the General Service Board at the conclusion of Conference last year, the trustees held two of their quarterly meetings here at the Crowne Plaza in New York and the October meeting at the Hilton Rye Town Hotel in Rye Brook, New York. In particular, this year they have given an amazing amount of time — extra days, a retreat, and an incredible number of committee conference calls. In addition to the regular quarterly meeting weekends, the board added an additional day in July, carved out extra time in October and held a retreat in Dallas in January 2013, to provide time for planning regarding the structure and operations of our corporations.

This past year our General Service Board welcomed some new members. We were joined by two new Class B trustees, West Central regional trustee Andrew Ware and Western Canada regional trustee Marty Watters. J. Gary Lutz, Class B trustee, joined the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board as a director and Clayton Vandivort, Class B trustee, joined the Grapevine Corporate Board as a director.

There have also been substantial changes at G.S.O. this past year. Longtime A.A. staff members Gayle Solheim Riese and Warren Stafford retired, and two new staff members started, Clay Ritzenhouse and Steve Smith. In addition, at the end of the year, Valerie O'Neill retired. Before becoming G.S.O.'s Publications director in 2009, Valerie had served many years as a staff member.

Greg Tobin, a past general service trustee and Grapevine director, began as the new Publishing director at the beginning of the year. Clay, Steve and Greg will be here with us throughout the week, and I hope you will take a moment to introduce yourselves and welcome them.

Since the 62nd General Service Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Edmonton, Alberta; St. Catharines, Ontario; Mount Vernon, Illinois; Fairbanks, Alaska; and Boca Raton, Florida. Also, there was a Local Forum with the theme "Recovery, Unity and Service" held in San Francisco in Area 06, California Northern Coastal Area, that included participation from Spanish- and English-speaking districts with simultaneous translation for attendees. All of the Forums were attended by enthusiastic members interested in participation in all of A.A.'s Three Legacies.

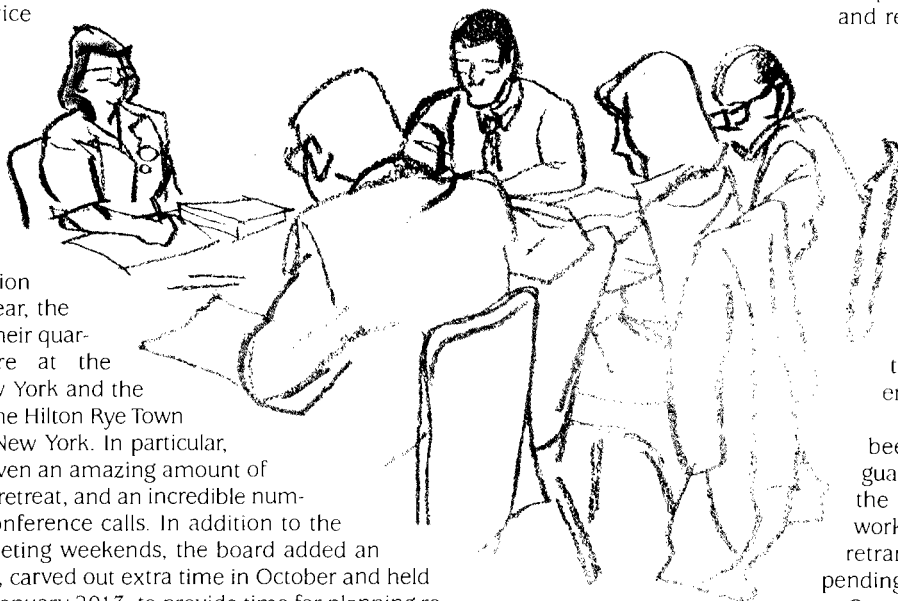
The 22nd World Service Meeting was held this past October 2012 in Rye Brook, New York. Sixty-one delegates from 34 countries and zones shared the experience, strength and hope of their countries with each other for a week. Don Massey and Barbara Kelly, our trustees-at-large, were our delegates to this gathering. If you have not done so already, I would encourage you to read the Final Report of this World Service Meeting. You will see that A.A. is truly an international community, that we all share the same principles and encounter many of the same challenges.

In addition to the World Service Meeting, our trustees and staff traveled abroad to share our experience with other countries

and regional structures: trustee-at-large/U.S. Don Massey and Valerie O'Neill traveled to Russia, and Don and Mary Clare Lynch attended the Middle East Region Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous in Dubai. At their invitation, Phyllis Halliday observed the General Service Conference in Mexico in March.

Currently, the Big Book has been translated into 68 languages, with an oral version of the Big Book in Navajo in the works. Eighteen translations (or retranslations) of the text are pending.

One of the most significant projects undertaken this year has been the planning regarding the structure and operations of our service corporations. You have received my report and the trustees' plans and proposal, so I will not repeat what is in those documents. I do, however, have a few thoughts I wish to share regarding it. The process began with the board inventory in 2011. The primary concern that arose from the inventory revolved around the board's use of time. It was felt that too much time was spent on what could be termed as "management" issues and not enough time was spent on larger, strategic issues that the Fellowship and the board face. I summarized those issues in my earlier report to you. These are chronic problems and need to be addressed. The recommendation presented to Conference last year came from the discussions regarding the service corporations, and frankly last year's G.S.B. expected a more dra-



matic outcome than the one that is being proposed this year.

We were assisted in the inventory and in the discussions this past year by Gregg Talley, a consultant whose name you may recognize, as his firm, Talley Management Group, has served the Fellowship as our International Conventions' consultant since 1990. Following Conference last year, I appointed an ad hoc committee to begin working on the process for our discussions. We took extra time at the July Board weekend as well as in October when we agreed to hold another retreat to have time to discuss the issues and proposals fully. On January 18, 19, and 20, we met in Dallas and crafted the present proposal, which was approved by the G.S.B. unanimously at the January Board meeting. While it is easy to get involved in discussing the details, I would remind you that the primary purpose is to provide a place for resolving the service corporation concerns and conflicts to allow the G.S.B. to focus on the larger strategic issues that the Fellowship and the board face.

I think I speak for all the trustees when I say we believe most of the problems can be addressed by improved communication. As we examined the problems, we came to the conclusion that merging the two corporations may be overkill, and adding another committee would add another level of bureaucracy. Developing an interlocking directorate provides a pathway to development of the improved communication needed. We are clear that adjustments will be made to the fully interlocking boards; this is simply where the process can begin. Part of what I personally like about this proposal is that it does not change the present corporate structure; the two corporations remain as distinct, independent corporate operations. This means it can easily be changed back to the current structure if it does not serve us well. As this experiment moves forward, I am sure the G.S.B. will report back regularly to the Conference.

The upcoming week will be a rich and full one, I am certain. There are many important and exciting agenda items that you will be considering. As trusted servants, delegated to act on behalf of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, your informed group conscience will not only guide and direct the boards and the offices in their work during the next year, but will set an example of leadership in service that will be a power of example to all members. May a loving God bless you in your endeavors.

Ward Ewing, D.D., chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect the nine directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards in other countries.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; and G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential non-voting support personnel attend each board meeting: director of staff services, G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publishing director, human resources manager, archivist, and board secretary.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by G.S.O., and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors. The purpose

of the publishing activities and group services provided by A.A.W.S. and G.S.O., as requested from the Fellowship, is to support members' and groups' Twelfth Step efforts to reach the still-suffering alcoholic. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 62nd Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity, track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., review financial reports, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters.

The board utilizes the committee system to address extensive agendas, to gather background material, and to thoroughly consider requests. The board, in turn, discusses committee reports and votes on any recommendations presented by a board committee in these reports. In addition, the board conducts long-range and strategic planning. Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (addresses the needs of service assignments, reviews G.S.O. communications with the Fellowship, and oversees G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (recommends candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

Group Services — A net total of 903 new A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada were listed at G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact receives A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step activities.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site is the responsibility of the A.A.W.S. Board of Directors, acting through its Services Committee and in accordance with the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

- *Web Site Redesign:* The Web site redesign project has been placed under the purview of G.S.O.'s Publishing director and is moving forward.
- *Directory:* A country-by-country list of international G.S.O.s, local intergroup/central offices, and answering services is now available under the "How to Find Meetings" tab on the aa.org Web site.
- *Archival Recordings:* After consideration of a request from the trustees' Archives Committee, the board approved the concept of posting selected archival audio recordings on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- *Online Catalog:* The board approved the posting of the current literature catalog (with prices) and order forms on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site as part of the effort to clarify how to order A.A. literature.
- *Activity Reports:* The board approved the 2012 Quarterly and Annual Web site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. These reports detail requests for changes and additions to the Web site and how they are addressed. The annual report is provided to the Conference Committee on Public Information from the trustees' Committee on Public Information.
- *Fair Use Policy:* The board approved a revised Fair Use Policy for A.A. literature that provides for printing of single copies of pamphlets from G.S.O.'s Web site.

Forums and Other Events — Throughout the year, G.S.O. staff members are invited to attend and participate in many local and

area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips help provide information about G.S.O. to A.A. gatherings and help staff to gather local experience to add to other collected experience available from G.S.O.

Regional and Additional Forums — Since the 62nd General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in five Regional Forums in 2012: Western Canada Regional Forum in Edmonton, Alberta in June; the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in St. Catharines, Ontario in July; the “Additional” East Central Regional Forum in Mt. Vernon, IL in August; the Pacific Regional Forum in Fairbanks, AK in September; and the Southeast Regional Forum in Boca Raton, FL in November.

Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar — The 27th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A.G.V. Seminar was held in Washington, D.C., September 28-30, 2012. Members of the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. Boards, as well as management and staff from both offices attended, including the G.S.O. staff member serving as liaison to intergroup/central offices. Seminar participants included 134 attendees from approximately 65 local offices, with 53 members attending their first Seminar.

National A.A. Archives Workshop — G.S.O. Archivist Michelle Mirza attended the 16th Annual National A.A. Archives Workshop, in Cocoa Beach, Florida, October 3-7. There were 259 participants, including archivists serving at the area and district levels, archives committee chairs and a few past delegates.

International — Trustees, G.S.O. management and the International desk staff member receive invitations from A.A. in other countries to share information regarding licensing and translations and experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures. Highlights include: *World Service Meeting*: The 22nd World Service Meeting (WSM) was held in October 2012, in Rye Brook, New York. Sixty-one delegates representing 34 countries and zones participated — including four countries who attended their first W.S.M.: Chile, Ecuador, Hungary and Slovenia. *Middle Eastern Regional Committee of Alcoholics Anonymous (MERCAA)*: The International desk coordinator and trustee-at-large/U.S. participated in the 11th annual meeting of MERCAA which met in Kuwait in November 2012. Prior to going to Kuwait, the International desk coordinator spent a week visiting A.A. groups in the United Arab Emirates (UAE). After MERCAA, the International desk coordinator visited the Dublin General Service Office of A.A. in Ireland.

Financial — Complete audited financial details for 2012 are included in the Conference Manual and *Conference Final Report*. Here is an overview: Total contributions for the year ended December 31, 2012, were \$6,557,608, .45% more than budget and 4.7% greater than 2011 as well. Net sales for the year 2012 were \$12,364,758, 2.75% less than budget and \$141,377 less than the year 2011. For the year 2012, net revenues were 0.08% less than budget, and operating expenses were 0.4% less than budget as well. For the year 2012, total operating expenses of \$14,283,552 were approximately \$56,788 less than budget but \$875,065, or 6.5%, greater than the prior year. Total personnel costs were approximately \$4,000 greater than budgeted and \$326,000 greater than 2011. Gross profit from literature sales was \$7,878,000, approximately \$42,000 less than budget and \$83,000 less than 2011. For the year a profit of \$152,445 was realized, compared with \$107,893 budgeted and last year's result of \$817,947.

The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee has been focused on self-support through member contributions over the last couple of years. Response from the Fellowship has been apparent, as indicated by increased requests for self-support literature and contribution envelopes, and as evidenced by the 4.7% increase in contributions in 2012. We want to give a special thanks to dele-

gates and trustees who have carried the self-support message and its spiritual meaning throughout the Fellowship.

2013 Budget — The A.A.W.S. Board approved the 2013 budget of the General Service Office with a net loss of \$611,240; after review by the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee, the budget was approved by the General Service Board.

Publishing — Sales Unit Distribution: Gross sales distribution from G.S.O. of all books in English, excluding “no charge,” totaled 1,738,857 units for 2012. A.A. purchases totaled 1,411,021 units (81% of total units). Purchases of items by non-A.A. individuals/entities in 2012 totaled 327,836 units (19% of total units).

- **E-books**: A motion was passed to forward the following Agenda Item to the 2013 General Service Conference: “Consider the request from A.A.W.S. for permission to use commissioned online stores to sell and distribute digital A.A. literature.” Last year, 2012, was our first full year offering the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in English, French and Spanish, in e-book format for use with the A.A. e-reader. From December 12, 2011 through December 31, 2012, digital distribution for the Big Book totaled 4,244 units and 3,755 units for the Twelve and Twelve.

- **Commemorative First Edition Big Book**: The board approved forwarding a proposal to the 2013 General Service Conference that in April 2014, coinciding with the anniversary of its publication, A.A.W.S. publish a commemorative edition of the First Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* (the Big Book) that is faithful in production specifications to the original First Edition — and clearly marked as the “75th Anniversary Edition” of the 1939 book on the facsimile dust jacket. The book would be offered for sale for a limited period of time, from April 2014 through the 2015 International Convention Period.

- **Navajo Big Book**: The oral translation of the Navajo Big Book is due for completion in 2013.

- **International Translations**: There are 68 current Big Book translations, with 18 new translations pending. In addition, newly revised translations are now available in Dutch/Flemish, Indonesian, Thai and Vietnamese. A.A.W.S. has published 243 titles (books, booklets, pamphlets, service pieces) in 46 languages; and 45 countries are licensed to print 1,543 publications in 45 languages

- **Honorary Mention**: *Alcoholics Anonymous* (the Big Book) received the honor of being recognized by the Library of Congress as among the “88 Books that Shaped America.”

G.S.O. and Staff Operations — At year-end 2012, G.S.O. had 74 full-time employees, four part-time employees, and five temporary employees. The service piece, “Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S.,” describes in detail the services provided by the A.A. staff assignments and other employees at G.S.O.

G.S.O. Visitors — In 2012, G.S.O. welcomed 1,584 visitors, including several groups ranging from 10 to 75 members. Many A.A. members traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their gratitude, in many languages, for their sobriety. One of the main highlights for members is a visit to the G.S.O. Archives where the welcoming Archives staff provides information and answers questions.

Archives — Archives responded to approximately 1,555 requests for information and research during 2012.

Reprint Requests — During 2012, A.A.W.S. granted permission/did not object to 121 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and denied permission (including lack of authority to grant permission) to 67 requests.

Roberta Lindeman, chairperson

■ Literature Distributed — 2012

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	424,938
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	330,945
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	43,451
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	147,467
Daily Reflections	136,427
Daily Reflections (large print)	11,672
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	144,139
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	5,779
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	145,951
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	20,975
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	50,047
A.A. Comes of Age	8,104
As Bill Sees It	26,752
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	24,648
As Bill Sees It (large print)	5,966
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	8,172
"Pass It On"	6,723
Experience, Strength & Hope	10,190
Total	1,552,346

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	23,170
Living Sober	120,466
Living Sober (large print)	7,549
Came to Believe	44,213
Came to Believe (large print)	3,630
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	15,314
Total	214,342

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	15,198
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	25,823
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	26,309
A.A. for the Native North American	16,587
A.A. for the Woman	80,113
The A.A. Group	80,377
A.A. in Your Community	37,484
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	15,716
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	17,954
The A.A. Membership Survey	46,864
The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs	84,704
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	24,044
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	10,103
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	110,159
Circles of Love and Service	35,948
Bridging the Gap	23,778
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	13,535
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	11,140
Do You Think You're Different?	94,208
Frequently Asked Questions	183,453
Frequently Asked Questions (large print)	6,430
G.S.R.	36,755
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	15,136
How A.A. Members Cooperate	13,313
How It Works	65,004
If You Are a Professional	27,289
Inside A.A.	36,689
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	26,580
Is A.A. for You?	316,947
Is A.A. for Me?	96,094

Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	12,422
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	59,503
It Happened to Alice	28,092
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	37,437
The Jack Alexander Article	17,872
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	8,215
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	39,730
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	27,840
A Message to Correctional Professionals	9,268
A Newcomer Asks	287,571
Problems Other Than Alcohol	97,764
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	272,858
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	12,676
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	28,591
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	56,482
Twelve Tradition Flyer	5,535
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	44,440
This Is A.A.	247,685
This Is A.A. (large print)	4,556
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	13,174
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	40,522
Too Young?	50,559
Understanding Anonymity	52,532
What Happened to Joe	31,416
Young People and A.A.	81,430
A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs	13,960
Total	3,175,864

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	238,295
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	44,363
Wallet cards-Anonymity	31,643
Anonymity Display Card	1,315
Parchment-scrolls	1,619
Placards	435
C.P.C. Workbook	1,049
Archives Workbook	793
Corrections Workbook	1,016
P.I. Workbook	1,319
Treatment Committee Workbook	1,158
Treatment Committee Kit	309
Special Needs Workbook	378
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	3
A.A. Guidelines	75,878
Group Handbook	2,262
Wire Racks	1,529
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	10
Audio CDs	624
DVD's	3,790
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	55
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	9
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cd album)	2,484
A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)	343
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	33
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)	1,112
TV Public Service Announcement	307
Radio Public Service Announcements	190
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,332
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,238
Fact File	1,502
Table Top Display 12 & 12	393
Pioneers of A.A. (cassette album)	2
Pioneers of A.A. (cd album)	41
Living Sober (cassette album)	7
Living Sober (cd album)	307
Total	417,143
Grand Total	5,359,695

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	12,270
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	8,223
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	6,208
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous Large Print)	3,328
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	3,942
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,737
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	1,795
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	2,618
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,619
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	11,077
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./D doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,703
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	14,767
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,024
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,064
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	3,649
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	4,208
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	3,604
Total	101,836

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,348
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	24,344
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	14,235
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	51,623
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	6,680
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	2,295
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	1,605
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	1,470
Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos (Let's be Friendly with our Friends)	825
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,465
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	6,958
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	3,516
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	6,392
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,257
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	7,480
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	7,850
El Miembro de A.A. — Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs)	1,751
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	3,727
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	841
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	9,092
La Tradición de A.A. — ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition — How It Developed)	1,592
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	12,234
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales	

(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	864
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	4,385
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	3,474
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,106
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,766
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,416
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,618
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,020
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	4,994
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	5,389
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. (Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings)	1,108
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	6,525
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	3,683
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,006
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	7,338
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	4,284
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,235
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	2,824
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,213
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,293
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,308
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)	768
Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional...)	2,889
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine...Our Meeting in Print)	1,424
¿Demasiado Joven? (Too Young?)	3,039
Alcohólico Necesidades Especiales (A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs)	973
Total	253,522

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	5,935
Parchments, Spanish	536
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	9,485
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	11
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cd album) (Big Book on cd)	641
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	10
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)	879
Total	17,497
Grand Total	372,855

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format relie)	3,972
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format souple)	1,158

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format poche)	416
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — format relie)	1,358
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — format souple)	821
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — format poche)	1,009
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	355
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,742
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,450
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	289
(Expérience, Strength and Hope) (Experience, Strength and Hope)	333
Transmets-Le (Pass It On)	378
Total	15,281

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus à croire (Came to Believe)	1,427
Vivre ...sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,095
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	906
Total	5,428

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	9,360
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	3,775
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	8,657
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	2,044
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	782
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,080
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue (The A.A. Member — Medications & Other Drugs)	2,012
Les A.A. — Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	121
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	173
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,622
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,383
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	668
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	262
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	910
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	227
Jean face à son problème d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	361
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,152
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	1,690
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	497
Les Douze Traditions illustrées (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,170
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	368
Ça vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	756
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	2,640

Les membres du clergé se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	370
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	623
Message à l'intention d'un détenu (Memo to an Inmate)	563
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	121
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,471
Les Douze Concepts illustrés (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,314
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,872
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,044
Y a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	2,546
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,704
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	193
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	2,482
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,151
L'Héritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	265
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,252
Vous croyez-vous différent? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,095
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,930
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	906
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	939
A.A. pour l'alcoolique plus âgé (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	1,458
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	4,595
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,173
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	581
Les Douze Etapes Illustrées (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	2,534
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	494
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amérique du Nord (A.A. for the Native North American)	408
Pour L'alcoolique Besoins Spéciaux (A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs)	248
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	1,478
Total	80,520

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	2
12 & 12 (cd album)	458
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (cd album)	544
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,061
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	1,060
Carte Je Suis Responsable (I am responsible wallet card)	901
Video Cassettes	2
DVDS	41
Notre Méthode (How It Works)	13,437
Manuel de Groupe	18
Pochette de l'Information Publique	24
Pochette des Centres de Detention	3
Pochette de la CMP	27
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	44
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	5
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	374
Total	19,001
Grand Total	120,230

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is one of two operating corporations of the General Service Board and the multimedia publisher of Grapevine magazine content, available on various platforms and in a variety of formats. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes Spanish-language content in La Viña magazine and its related book, CD and audio formats.

By charter, the A.A. Grapevine Board consists of seven to ten directors. Since the 61st Conference, there have been seven: two general service trustees; a Class A trustee; two regional trustees; one nontrustee director; and the executive editor/publisher.

As a rule, the purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

The A.A. Grapevine Board met ten times since the last Conference: three times during quarterly board meetings; four times as a Planning Committee; and three special meetings. In 2012-2013, two standing committees were active: the Nominating Committee, chaired by Nancy Haynes, facilitated all facets in the selection of candidates for board openings; the Finance & Budget Committee, chaired by Clayton Vandivort, oversaw the budget process. Don Miller represented AAGV, Inc. on the trustees' Social Media Committee. Three Grapevine directors also participated in the General Service Board Shared Resources ad hoc committee. The Editorial Advisory Board reconvened in 2012.

Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine, six issues of La Viña, an annual wall calendar and pocket planner, and eight e-books. La Viña magazine was expanded to 68 pages, in response to the 2011 Conference Advisory Action intended to bring La Viña to spiritual parity with Grapevine magazine.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. distributed 100,602 Grapevine and La Viña books, CDs, and other items, including the three latest book titles: *Young & Sober*, *Into Action*, and *Happy, Joyous & Free*.

Circulation — Grapevine's average monthly print circulation was 83,258 in fiscal year 2012 (this is less than budget by 3,671 and less than 2011 by 7,235). Following the relaunch of www.aagrapevine.org in May 2011, Grapevine Online (GVO) subscriptions were introduced, and as of December 2012 GVO averages 5,291 subscribers. The average bimonthly circulation of La Viña was 9,157 (this is 176 greater than budget and 175 above 2011 levels).

Based on the Grapevine's 2010 subscriber survey, it is estimated that the magazines are

passed on to approximately 2.5 readers per copy, thereby reaching an estimated 208,145 readers per Grapevine issue and 22,892 per La Viña issue.

Operations — In early 2012, A.A. Grapevine undertook major operational restructuring measures resulting in lowered expenses, most notably a move to a smaller office resulting in savings of 50% in Occupancy Costs over 2011.

Financial — Complete and audited financial details for 2012 are included in the Conference Manual and *Conference Final Report*. Here is an overview:

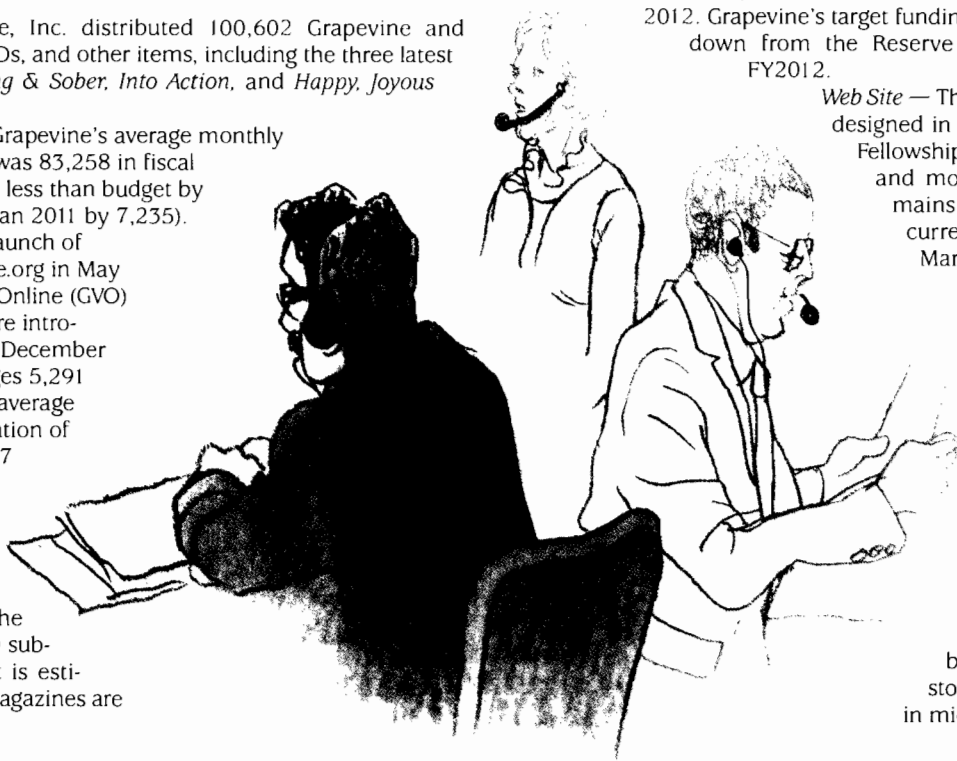
- Grapevine ended 2012 with net income of \$257,003 against budgeted net income of \$34,081. La Viña finished the year with a loss of \$115,820 against a budgeted loss of \$105,668.
- Revenue for the magazine and subscription products reached \$2,342,000. Gross Profit on the magazine was ahead of budget by almost \$53,000. This is a reflection of the July 2009 price increase as it integrated into the magazine subscription base and the inclusion of the new online subscription products.
- Gross Profit on books and related items was above budget by \$49,000.
- Overhead Costs were budgeted at \$1,843,906 and came in at \$1,706,713. This was a savings of \$137,193. This savings occurred mainly in Selling Expenses and circulation management.

La Viña — La Viña is published by A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and funded by the General Fund of the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship. La Viña had an average circulation of 9,157 per issue. Gross Profit on the magazine was \$54,342. This is below budget by \$5,136. Revenue was ahead of budget by \$706. Gross Profit on Related Items was below budget by about \$1,769. Overhead was over budget by \$3,246. The Net Loss for 2012 was \$115,820, or \$10,152 above the budgeted loss of \$105,668.

A.A. Grapevine and the Reserve Fund — A.A. Grapevine maintains a balance in the Reserve Fund to fund its unfulfilled subscription liability. Grapevine increased its balance in the Reserve Fund by \$100,000 to \$1,928,500 in May of 2012 because the subscription liability was increasing. The subscription liability is \$2,025,718 at December 31, 2012 and is 95% funded as of December 31, 2012. Grapevine's target funding level is 95%. No draw-down from the Reserve Fund occurred during FY2012.

Web Site — The Web site which was redesigned in 2011 to better serve the Fellowship and to engage a wider and more diverse audience remains central to Grapevine's current and future plans.

March 2012 reports indicate that an average of 38,290 unique visitors visit an average of 3.73 pages on aagrapevine.org each month. A new audio page was developed for the aagrapevine.org Web site to centralize Grapevine audio offerings in one location and to showcase the Audio Project, which began to collect recorded stories from the Fellowship in mid-January 2013.





In May of 2012, Grapevine introduced its complimentary Grapevine Quote, featuring excerpts drawn from the deep well of classic Grapevine literature. Selections are posted daily on aagrapevine.org and may be requested on an opt-in basis for e-mail delivery. Subscriptions are at 16,500 as of February 2013.

It is clear that many Grapevine subscribers are committed to the print magazine, and in keeping with the Fellowship's desire and support, the print publication will continue. At the same time, Grapevine's online products have attracted new subscribers with very few conversions from print. About 1/3 of AAGV's online subscribers are opting for both the online services and the print magazine. Offered as a bundle, the Grapevine Online subscription provides access to previously unpublished stories, Audio Grapevine, the Story Archive and the current issues of Grapevine/La Viña online.

At current prices, GV's basic online subscription costs subscribers about 10 cents a day and the print subscription is 8 cents per day. Work continues to attract an expanded subscriber base, and it is possible that a price increase of a dollar a year in 2013 might be required to achieve self-support. List-sharing with A.A.W.S., search engine optimization, and organization-wide support will also be important to the continued health of AAGV, Inc.

A.A. Grapevine board and management continue to be committed to self-support and are determined that A.A. Grapevine, Inc. will strive to be financially healthy while growing and evolving. The focus on financial health demonstrated throughout 2012 will continue in 2013. It is understood that cost reduction represents only one piece of the breakeven formula, while new approaches and additional revenue will be required to fulfill the other pivotal requirement of the breakeven picture.

In addition to the daily GV Quote, what the Grapevine Board and management are evaluating/considering for the balance of 2013 and through 2015 include:

- Communicating directly to groups through use of group contact information provided through Fellowship New Vision (FNV).
- Continuing to release e-book versions of current titles on a staggered basis.
- Converting and offering existing GV CD content in MP3 formats.
- Reimagining the GV Calendars in a variety of formats.
- Offering print versions of GV anthologies (books) through commissionable distribution channels.
- Presenting audio content through the subscription service.

- Provide a rewarding and supportive work environment for staff, including training and development in line with stated objectives.

As a mirror of the membership, Grapevine both reflects and belongs to the Fellowship. For 69 years, Grapevine has conveyed the "Voices of A.A." as a tool for many in recovery, evolving over time and reliably carrying the message to anyone who reaches out for the hand of A.A. If the Fellowship would like Grapevine and La Viña to be here now and in the future — for alcoholics and friends, many of whom may not know about A.A. yet — additional subscribers will be required. Organization-wide support for A.A. Grapevine, Inc. as an integral element of our program is essential.

Donald Cusson, chairperson



■ AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2012

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

Books

<i>Best of Bill (Hard Cover)</i>	1,819
<i>Best of Bill (Soft Cover)</i>	5,073
<i>Best of Bill — Large Print (Soft Cover)</i>	1,135
<i>Best of Bill — French (Soft Cover)</i>	1,363
<i>The Home Group — French (Soft Cover)</i>	340
<i>Le Langage Du Coeur</i>	475
<i>Best of the Grapevine I (Soft Cover)</i>	583
<i>Best of the Grapevine II (Soft Cover)</i>	452
<i>The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover)</i>	3,477
<i>El Lenguaje del Corazon</i>	1,843
<i>Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)</i>	469
<i>A.A. Around the World</i>	454
<i>The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)</i>	2,703
<i>Thank You For Sharing</i>	424
<i>Spiritual Awakenings</i>	2,658
<i>The Home Group — Revised (Soft Cover)</i>	1,274
<i>I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover)</i>	745
<i>Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)</i>	6,152
<i>The Language of the Heart (Large Print)</i>	476
<i>In Our Own Words</i>	971
<i>Beginners' Book</i>	3,703
<i>Voices of Long-Term Sobriety</i>	1,243
<i>A Rabbit Walks Into a Bar</i>	2,509
<i>Spiritual Awakenings II</i>	2,084
<i>Step By Step</i>	4,579
<i>Emotional Sobriety II (Soft Cover)</i>	5,224
<i>Young and Sober</i>	3,710
<i>Into Action</i>	2,622
<i>Happy, Joyous & Free</i>	3,083
<i>Best of Bill — Spanish</i>	2,341
<i>Lo Mejor de la Viña</i>	787
<i>El Grupo Base</i>	1,229
Total:	66,000

E-books

<i>The Language of the Heart</i>	2,043
<i>Best of Bill</i>	1,021
<i>Best of Bill — Spanish</i>	84
<i>Step by Step</i>	164
<i>Emotional Sobriety I</i>	404
<i>Emotional Sobriety II</i>	207
<i>Spiritual Awakenings I</i>	11
<i>Spiritual Awakenings II</i>	75
<i>Young and Sober</i>	100
<i>Into Action</i>	71
<i>Happy, Joyous & Free</i>	44
Total:	4,224

CDs - English 5,627

CDs - Spanish 3,479

Total: 9,106

Miscellaneous 20,625

Grand Total 99,955

	APRIL 2013	APRIL 2012	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	599	642	(43)
Alaska	437	478	(41)
Arizona	1,494	1,544	(50)
Arkansas	397	445	(48)
California	7,018	7,741	(723)
Colorado	1,426	1,633	(207)
Connecticut	1,145	1,234	(89)
Delaware	322	349	(27)
District of Columbia	169	174	(5)
Florida	4,101	4,520	(419)
Georgia	1,703	1,912	(209)
Hawaii	336	393	(57)
Idaho	549	618	(69)
Illinois	2,508	2,683	(175)
Indiana	1,206	1,241	(35)
Iowa	722	837	(115)
Kansas	832	918	(86)
Kentucky	709	754	(45)
Louisiana	582	622	(40)
Maine	462	534	(72)
Maryland	1,041	1,143	(102)
Massachusetts	1,955	2,209	(254)
Michigan	2,443	2,648	(205)
Minnesota	1,965	2,075	(110)
Mississippi	312	361	(49)
Missouri	1,245	1,341	(96)
Montana	453	538	(85)
Nebraska	645	698	(53)
Nevada	691	787	(96)
New Hampshire	550	611	(61)
New Jersey	2,243	2,384	(141)
New Mexico	509	531	(22)
New York	4,353	4,621	(268)
North Carolina	1,635	1,845	(210)
North Dakota	350	324	26
Ohio	1,865	2,042	(177)
Oklahoma	569	658	(89)
Oregon	1,207	1,376	(169)
Pennsylvania	4,362	4,696	(334)
Rhode Island	268	304	(36)
South Carolina	726	805	(79)
South Dakota	299	308	(9)
Tennessee	828	901	(73)
Texas	2,817	3,239	(422)
Utah	426	475	(49)
Vermont	312	346	(34)
Virginia	1,843	1,909	(66)
Washington	2,203	2,494	(291)
West Virginia	299	345	(46)
Wisconsin	1,891	2,041	(150)
Wyoming	208	224	(16)
Puerto Rico	18	19	(1)
U.S. Possessions/APO	48	74	(26)
Virgin Islands	32	17	15
Subtotal US	67,328	73,661	(6,333)
Subtotal US	67,328	73,661	(6,333)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	799	856	(57)
British Columbia/YKN	897	1,041	(144)
Manitoba	309	328	(19)
New Brunswick/PEI	222	244	(22)
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	319	355	(36)
Ontario	2,955	3,011	(56)
Quebec	182	224	(42)
Saskatchewan	353	357	(4)
Subtotal Canada	6,036	6,416	(380)
FOREIGN	761	892	(131)
Grand Total	74,125	80,969	(6,844)

LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*

Mar./Apr. '13	Mar./Apr. '12	Diff.
7,426	6,567	859

(*does not include monthly orders)

■ Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Archives Committee is responsible for developing and implementing the policies that govern the Archives services and makes recommendations to the General Service Board on Archives procedures and budget. Through its group conscience, and guided by A.A.'s principles and professional standards, the committee undertakes and upholds responsibility and authority for the maintenance and use of the Archives.

In consultation with the Archivist, the committee grants access to A.A. members, scholars, and other professionals who may have a valid need to review material in the archives for research purposes. The committee, since the 2012 Conference, granted permission to 18 researchers for use of archival materials. All requests are carefully considered through recommendations from the Archivist and established Archives policies. Recognizing that particular routine requests for access may be expeditiously handled, the committee agreed to review such requests via electronic mail.

At the July meeting, we reviewed the History and Actions and noted some significant actions and Archives policies. In response to a 2012 Conference Archives Committee Consideration, the committee requested that the Archivist develop new material on digitizing archival documents, as well as soliciting stories from

local A.A. archivists on their digitization efforts. We received helpful sharing from a wide variety of locations and selected a number of these, which will be added to the Archives Workbook. We also approved the new guidelines on digitizing archival material prepared by the Archives staff. An announcement will be made as soon as the new service piece becomes available for distribution. We appreciated those nine areas and districts that submitted sharing on their experiences with scanned archival documents.

In October we discussed the lack of ownership rights by A.A.W.S. of the anonymity-protected photographs taken at International Conventions. We asked A.A.W.S. to fully review ownership rights to the group photo and consider amending future contracts that at least will allow the General Service Office and the Archives to use the photograph in A.A. publications or other published pieces. The matter was discussed and A.A.W.S. agreed to explore the prospect of amending future contracts. The committee reviewed the "Biographical Sketch" section in the Oral Histories Kit and requested that the Archivist revise the section to exclude particular personal questions. In addition, the committee asked that the entire Oral Histories Kit be reviewed with necessary modifications made, as applicable. A revised Oral Histories Kit was approved by the committee in October.

In January the committee approved the reproduction of five photographs to be distributed within A.A. only for the purpose of local displays. These include various photographs of the co-founders alone, a photo of Lois and Bill standing in the garden at Stepping Stones and one of Father Ed Dowling, Bill W.'s "spiritual advisor." It was agreed to suggest a contribution of \$2.75 for each photograph, based on the assessment of current reproduction and shipping costs. At the same time, the committee agreed to increase the suggested voluntary contribution of the existing portrait photographs of the co-founders from \$1.50 to \$2.75.

We discussed ways of making selected archival recordings more available to the Fellowship. One idea, proposed and forwarded to the A.A.W.S. Board for consideration, was to post brief clips of selected recordings on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, and A.A.W.S. approved the concept. The committee then agreed to forward the proposal to the 2013 Conference Committee on Archives for consideration.

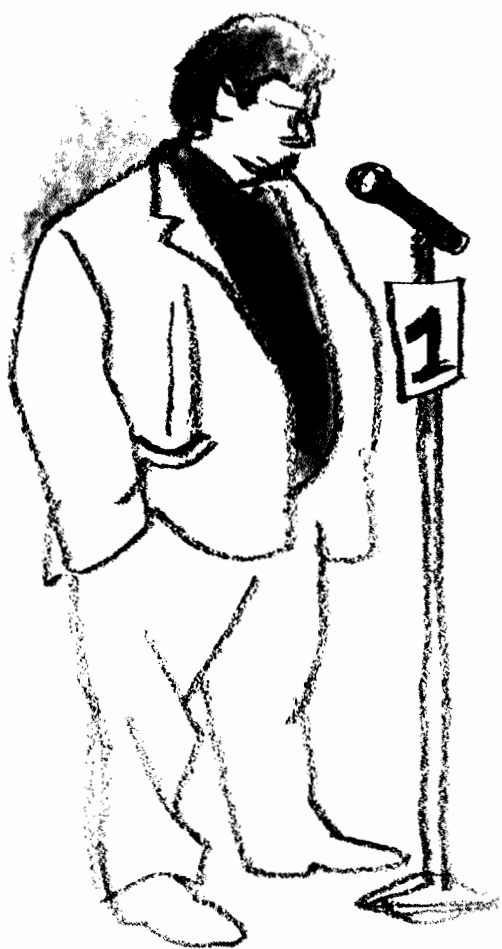
The committee received a proposal from A.A.W.S. to publish a commemorative edition of the First Edition, First Printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous*. We agreed to forward this proposal to the 2013 Conference Committee on Archives for discussion.

Throughout the year, the committee was kept apprised of projects executed by the Archives staff, as well as tabulated research inquiries handled by the staff. The archivist also informed the committee of new collections added to the repository within the year.

Nancy Haynes, chairperson

Staff report: The mission of the General Service Office Archives is to permanently document the work of Alcoholics Anonymous, to make the history of the organization accessible to A.A. members and other researchers, and to provide a context for understanding A.A.'s progression, principles and traditions. The repository holds collections of thousands of letters, audio recordings, photographs and other material that contain invaluable information about the growth of the Fellowship and the development of our service structure. As we fulfill our mission, the words of our co-founder, Bill W., in 1960 reminds us of the significance of our work: "We reverence the past and its lessons for so long as those teachings work...the lessons of the past, however, are something we ought to preserve."

The Archives provides resource material and service to A.A. members, researchers and others about A.A. history, responds to



worldwide information requests, and offers professional support to local A.A.s interested in researching their group or area's history. In 2012 we responded to over 1,550 requests for information. This is one of the many ways that we are committed to rendering service to the A.A. community and others. We welcomed over 120 new local archivists and committee chairs serving either in the area or district position and furnished each individual with an Archives Workbook and handy resources.

Markings—*Your Archives Interchange* is an electronic newsletter published three times a year and delivered to subscribers via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system. The spring 2012 issue marked the first time *Markings* became available in Spanish and French. Our subscriber list has continued to increase as *Markings* gains interest nationally; it is distributed electronically to over 10,800 recipients. Our ongoing efforts to digitize early Alcoholic Foundation/Works Publishing records beginning with 1938 through 1955, was completed and we can now perform effortless electronic searches in those records. The original documents have been preserved and sent to the Archives' secured underground storage.

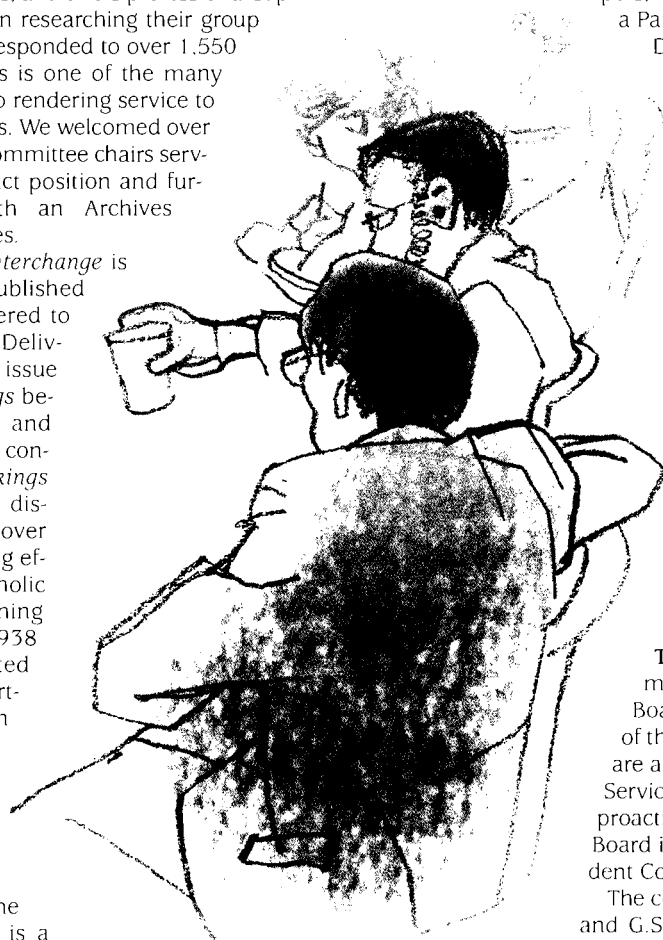
Another multi-year project was the development of the Archives audio catalog. This is a multiple-phase project that requires listening to thousands of audio recordings arranged in series. In 2012 we began a series of over three thousand recordings of oldtimers, early friends of A.A. and others. There are incredible talks by oldtimers and significant friends of the Fellowship telling their stories, their impressions of Bill and Dr. Bob, and particular aspects of the early days. In keeping with our mission, the Archives associate archivists worked with collections to preserve, arrange and create Finding-Aids for several personal collections and papers, including the Greg Muth Papers, Clarence Snyder Papers, George Strachan Papers and New Brunswick Old Maritime Intergroup Collection.

The Archives' onsite exhibits are intended to stimulate interest and inform visitors about a particular aspect of A.A.'s history or of a particular collection. For those members unable to visit our office, we designed a digital archives that presents several themed exhibits, including two new additions in 2012: "The story behind the Jack Alexander article on A.A." and a biography of Sister Mary Ignatia. The digital archives can be found in the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Last year we launched "News from the Archives," a monthly bulletin for G.S.O. and Grapevine employees that features significant dates in A.A.'s history. It is a small effort on our part to enlighten employees about people, places and events significant to the Fellowship's history. Hundreds of issues of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish and English have been scanned for posting to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The Archives staff is grateful to those members and others who have generously donated material to the Archives within the past twelve months. Some of the valuable donations include: **Collections:** Papers and books of Don Farrell, former G.S.B. trustee; pa-

pers, newsletters, pamphlets of August Backus, a Panel 2 delegate; and papers and books of Dennis Manders, G.S.O.'s former controller. **Publications:** First Edition *Alcoholics Anonymous* inscribed to Janet Blair from Hank Parkhurst; "True" magazine, 1943 featuring article by an alcoholic entitled "Snakes In My Boots"; and area history pamphlet, "Built with Love and Service: Glimpse of Early History of A.A. in Hamilton." **Ephemera:** Original copy of the Poverello Medal certificate awarded to the A.A. Fellowship by the College of Steubenville in December 1949; and a photograph on canvas of Bill W. speaking with a group of reporters in 1943 at an A.A. event in Chicago.

Michelle Mirza, archivist



AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed by the General Service Board in 2003, is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management, separately with the auditor, and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The Audit Committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

Terry Bedient, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of at least four trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

George Martin, chairperson

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee reviewed the Advisory Actions, pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 63rd General Service Conference, "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action." The committee discussed summaries of the 2012 Evaluation Questionnaires and a

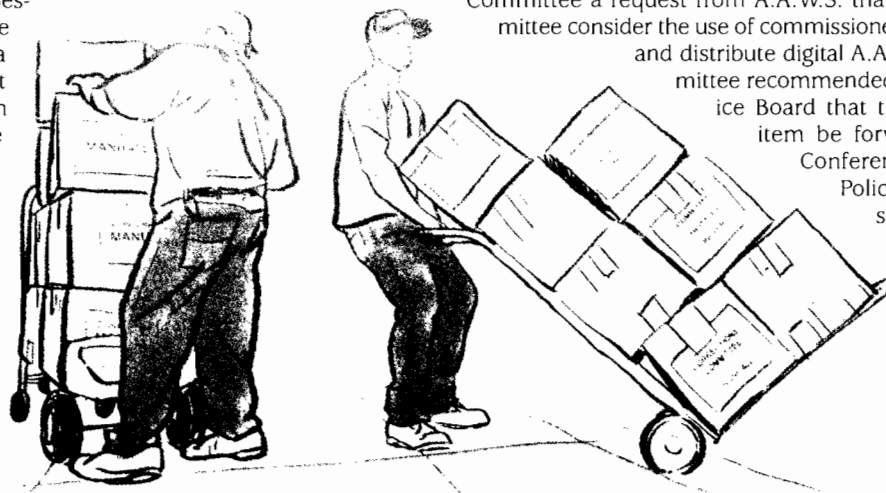
Post-Conference Sharing Session, and implemented the 2012 Conference Agenda Committee's suggestion that the "Pre-Conference" section on the Evaluation Form be separated from the "Sunday" section on the form for the 63rd Conference. We discussed the Evaluation Form and agreed to forward suggestions to the 2013 Conference Agenda Committee, which included an electronic option for conducting the evaluation. The committee requested that the staff secretary forward the evaluation summaries pertaining to board

reports to respective board chairpersons. Additionally, the committee suggested that the chair of the Conference remind the Conference body during the Conference that all Conference members have a voice and vote during floor discussions.

The committee reviewed the report of the 2012 Conference Agenda Committee and noted the reduction in the number of presentation topics for the 63rd General Service Conference to allow scheduling for the Conference Inventory process to take place during Conference week. There were no recommendations for workshop topics since the Conference Inventory group sessions will replace workshops during the Conference week in 2013, 2014 and 2015. We approved the schedule for the 63rd General Service Conference week, which includes sessions for the fifteen inventory groups to discuss assigned inventory questions and reports from inventory groups, followed by full Conference body discussion as outlined in the Inventory Plan approved in 2011. In response to a 2012 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee's Additional Committee Consideration, the committee forwarded a report to the 2013 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee on their role in granting international observers admission to the General Service Conference, which took into account the concerns expressed by the Conference Committee on Policy Admissions. The committee reviewed the 2012 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee's Additional Committee Consideration requesting that the trustees' Committee on Conference review the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the General Service Conference" on an ongoing basis and forward any updates to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for their review. The committee reviewed the guidelines and forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions a suggestion that the guidelines include a reference that power outlets would still be available in designated seating areas during general sessions.

In keeping with the two-year experiment regarding the Conference Dashboard that ended in 2012, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that the use of the Conference Dashboard be continued and encourages G.S.O. to explore additional options to facilitate Conference communications and provide Conference background. The committee forwarded to the 2013 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee a request that delegates who are elected to be alternate chairperson of a primary Conference committee would not be eligible to serve as chairperson of a secondary Conference Committee.

The committee forwarded to the trustees' Public Information



Committee a request from A.A.W.S. that a Conference committee consider the use of commissioned online stores to sell and distribute digital A.A. literature. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the following agenda item be forwarded to the 2013

Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions: "Consider changing the deadline for submission of Conference Agenda Items from January 15th to December 15th." The committee agreed that this would allow more time for preparation and review of background

material for the General Service Board's first quarterly meeting. This would also allow more preparation time to meet the February 15th background mailing deadline to Conference members. The committee forwarded to the A.A. Grapevine Board a request to rescind a 2011 Advisory Action pertaining to utilization of digital distribution and sales of Grapevine products through online vendors.

The committee forwarded to A.A.W.S. a request to consider an electronic voting system to be utilized on all nonelection votes at Conference and report back on the financial feasibility of an electronic voting system to the trustees' Conference Committee for their July 2013 meeting. The committee also agreed to forward to A.A.W.S. a request that the Conference reconsider use of the "circle and triangle" with the words recovery/unity/service as a service mark, since this may have legal ramifications. The committee forwarded to the General Service Board a request from A.A. Grapevine, pertaining to Grapevine's use of FNV lists by a third party e-mail vendor to send informational e-mails to recipients who have opted in. The committee forwarded to the Publishing department revised text on the Conference committee selection process for *The A.A. Service Manual*. The revision clarifies that the selection process could include any one or two trustees or directors on the boards.

The committee discussed a request that the trustees' Conference Committee submit to the 2013 Conference Agenda Committee a plan whereby the Conference Agenda Committee would be a part of the whole process of "format and content of the agenda for the General Service Conference meeting." The committee suggested that the Publishing department review the description on the Conference Agenda Committee in *The A.A. Service Manual* for consistency with the scope of that committee, and forward any changes to the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee discussed and recommended to the General Service Board that the 2013 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions discuss the concept of combining the Conference Agenda and Conference Policy/Admissions committees.

The committee took no action on the following items: We discussed a suggestion that Conference committee chairpersons only read recommendations and not the entire committee report. The committee noted that Conference proceedings, which include committee reports, are taped for archival purposes to record an accurate account of what transpired. The committee also discussed a suggestion that all recommendations from Conference committees be addressed first at the Conference and that additional committee considerations be handled separately

after all recommendations have been voted on. The committee noted that discussion on additional committee considerations is open only for questions and agreed that Conference members should be reminded of this before and during the Conference proceedings.

The committee discussed a request to consider creating a Conference Committee on Bridging the Gap and agreed that there is no widely expressed need for a Conference Committee on Bridging the Gap. The committee noted that, even though the service is handled differently from area to area, it seems to be handled successfully through local treatment, corrections or H&I committees. The committee discussed two requests regarding changes to Conference-approved literature and background distribution. One request pertained to changes in *The A.A. Service Manual* and the other pertained to all Conference-approved literature. The requests proposed that all changes/revisions to Conference-approved literature be included in the background distributed to all General Service Conference members. The committee agreed that in light of the upcoming General Service Conference Inventory 2013-2015, there are inventory questions that would generate discussion on this topic.

The committee discussed two requests pertaining to agenda items that are submitted for Conference consideration, which a trustees' committee tabled or took no action, be forwarded to the corresponding Conference committee for final disposition. The committee noted that this process was not practical within the timelines and may be discussed through the Conference Inventory, 2013-2015. The committee discussed a request to change the word "Usually" to "Always" on page S55 in the current *The A.A. Service Manual* and noted that this change would not be consistent with long-standing procedures on routing suggested agenda items, which allows for flexibility. The committee also suggested that Publishing review the text in *The A.A. Service Manual* for clarity.

Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a productive and enriching Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us.

Pam Reising, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encour-

aged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme and presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval. In Conference Inventory years, 2013-2015, there are no workshops.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual and, with the guidance of the Publishing Department, the summer edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Eva Sanchez

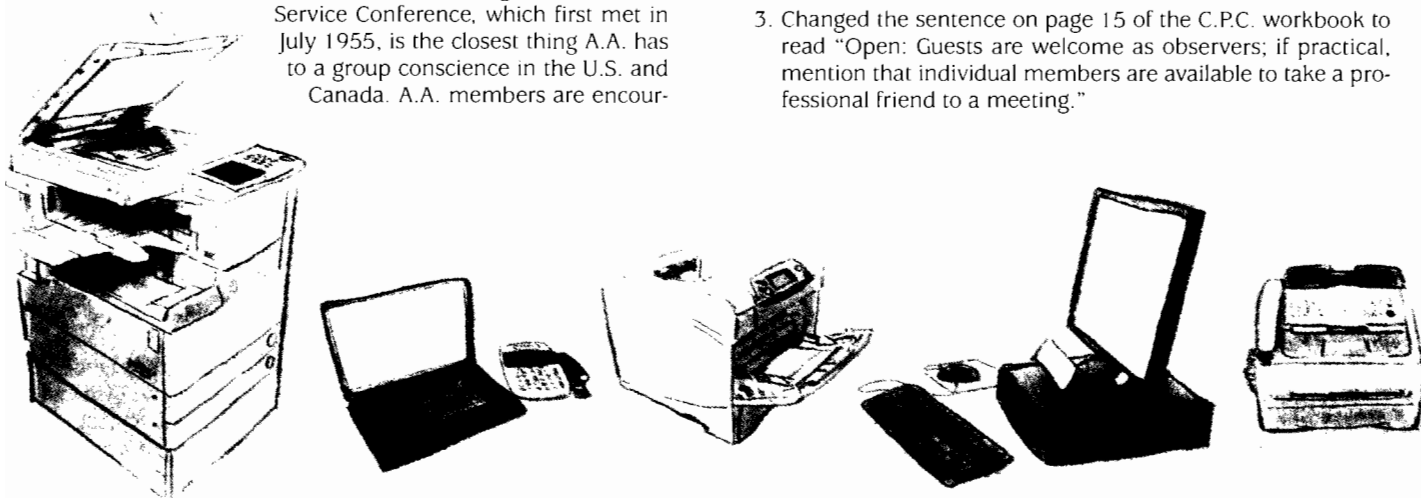
COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/ TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Then, in August of 2009, the trustees' committee expanded its scope to include service to Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees and oversight of Special Needs literature. The title of the committee has been changed to Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — Among the many tasks completed this past year:

- In response to the recommendations and considerations from the 2012 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community:

1. Added the phrase "nonalcoholics may attend as observers" to the "Singleness of Purpose" statement in C.P.C. literature.
2. Replaced the text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" text in C.P.C. pamphlets and service materials with the section "What A.A. Does Not Do" in the "A.A. at a Glance" flyer.
3. Changed the sentence on page 15 of the C.P.C. workbook to read "Open: Guests are welcome as observers; if practical, mention that individual members are available to take a professional friend to a meeting."





4. Forwarded the request to consider dedicating a portion of the Web site to making A.A. resources easily accessible to targeted professional populations and C.P.C. Committees to the A.A. World Services Board.

- Following a report from a subcommittee on exploring options for providing information about A.A. to professionals, a report was forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Public Information for inclusion in the Comprehensive Media Plan.

- Forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community a suggestion to revise a section under the heading "Proof of Attendance at Meetings" in the pamphlet, "If You Are a Professional..." to better reflect current A.A. experience.

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities — Among the many tasks completed this past year, the committee:

- In response to committee considerations regarding the French and Spanish translations of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*:

1. Worked with the Publishing department regarding concerns over the direct quotes read from the translated Big Book and expressed appreciation for the remedy of the Conference Committee concerns.

2. Agreed that no changes would be made in the current versions regarding possible background distraction, noting that while simultaneous translation is the preferred method, the Publishing department might review other options in the future.

- Forwarded a report on the above-mentioned items to the 2013 Conference Committee.

- Forwarded a final report on the pamphlet "A.A. For the Alcoholic with Special Needs" in formats for blind, deaf or learning challenged to the 2013 Conference Committee.

- Conducted a comprehensive review of current content and format of A.A. material intended to make the A.A. message accessible to alcoholics with special needs and requested that local shared experience be collected by staff.

Rogelio Flores, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively

few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an "open" A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2012, 364 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Hundreds of other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. is the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* The Winter 2012 issue featured an article detailing the use of technology to aid A.A. communities separated by vast geographical distances. In the Fall 2012 issue there is an article on the 2011 Membership Survey that highlights the importance of the work of A.A. members in informing professionals that A.A. can be a resource for them. Currently, more than 9,000 professionals receive *About A.A.* Approximately one-third of the list receives the newsletter via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system.

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 27 national or international conferences of professionals in 2012. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space, display and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. In the interest of extending the hand of A.A. to all who suffer, each year some Public Information events are also included, such as the N.A.A.C.P. and A.A.R.P. In addition, 13 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees. G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes

and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities have created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O., and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Clay Rittenhouse

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities — In July 2009, the task of communicating with Special Needs-Accessibilities service committees within the A.A. Fellowship was given a permanent home on the Treatment assignment. While each type of service committee addressed by the assignment may strive to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to different populations of alcoholics, the overall purpose of the Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment is to share A.A. and service committee experience and information through literature, activity updates and other communications with these distinct committees. The assignment currently communicates with approximately 1,150 area, district and Intergroup/Central office Treatment, Bridging the Gap (BTG), Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) and Special Needs-Accessibilities committee chairpersons.

Communication with these trusted servants begins with a welcome letter from the assignment coordinator, along with some of the service related materials that might be helpful as the committee chair starts out in their new position. While physical materials are still sent through the mail, the new trusted servants are also directed to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site (www.aa.org) where A.A. Guidelines, service committee Workbooks, and other A.A. materials may be read and/or printed directly from the service committee "buckets." In addition, all area level service committee chairs receive a list of other area level service committee chairs to facilitate sharing experiences and activities.

During their term of service, committee chairs receive updates on other committees' activities thorough articles in *Box 4-5-9*, and receive updates from the assignment coordinator that may contain ideas, activities, questions and solutions from other committees. These assignment updates also contain items of interest from the General Service Office, requests for sharing on a particular question when appropriate, and efforts to address possible areas of confusion.

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. In addition, communication is received from alcoholics with special challenges (blindness, deafness, brain injury, etc.) asking for A.A. literature in a format that they can understand. Each of these receives a response from the staff member, with as many as possible of these professionals, sober treatment clients and alcoholics with special needs linked to the appropriate local committee in the Fellowship who can serve as an additional resource.

The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

Steve Smith

CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Corrections recommends to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. The committee, which met three times since the 2012 General Service Conference, began work this year by acknowledging the current importance of corrections committees in carrying the A.A. message to newcomers. In order to facilitate corrections service work, the committee requested that a digital subscription option be made available for the quarterly newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls* and that the staff secretary explore how La Viña and other resources could be used to better reach Spanish-speaking inmates.

Corrections Engagement Strategy — We set up a subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy and asked them to take a strategic look at all resources and practices used to help carry the A.A. message into correctional facilities. The subcommittee agreed to review all materials employed by the Corrections desk. In order to gather experience and sharing from the Fellowship, we forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Corrections the following discussion topics: "How do we engage A.A. members in corrections service?" and "How do we use available resources in support of local corrections Twelfth Step work?"

We moved several other topics that came up for discussion at our meetings this year to the subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy and also requested the additional expertise of two appointed committee members. The items added to the scope of the subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy include:

- *"It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" video:* The committee considered an area delegate's request to gather sharing on the need and usability of a remake of the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and agreed the discussion belonged with the subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy. We subsequently asked the committee secretary to gather sharing from corrections committees who use this video on the need for a remake — a request that staff included in the January 2013 Corrections Activity Update.
- *Corrections Audiovisual Materials:* The committee tabled discussion about establishing a system for automatically reviewing and updating Corrections audiovisual materials and agreed to add consideration of such a system to the purview of the subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy.
- *Prerelease Contact Programs:* The committee briefly discussed how different committees and areas carry out Prerelease Contact Programs (sometimes referred to as Bridging the Gap, Temporary Contact, or Re-entry services) and requested that consideration of this A.A. Twelfth Step service be included in the scope of the subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy.
- *"A Message to Corrections Professionals" pamphlet* — The committee discussed replacing the section "A.A. in correctional facilities" in the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" in response to a 2012 Conference Advisory Action and decided to establish a subcommittee to accomplish that task. We also asked the subcommittee to review the entire pamphlet in response to a related request by an area delegate. Finally, we asked the subcommittee on "A Message to Corrections Professionals" pamphlet to consider different ways that the content of the pamphlet might be disseminated. The subcommittee met and requested the committee secretary work with the Publishing Department to draft a revision to the section "A.A. in correctional facilities" in line with the following suggestions:
- Move the 2012 Conference-approved paragraph about the pur-

pose of A.A. from the section "Re-entry and paroles" to the second paragraph under the section "A.A. in correctional facilities."

- Remove references to an outdated questionnaire.
- Rewrite the sharing from corrections professionals on the value of A.A. to eliminate statistics.

The full committee considered the draft replacement section and agreed to forward it to the 2013 Conference Committee on Corrections with two additional text revisions in other parts of the same pamphlet. We also agreed to forward to the 2013 Conference Committee on Corrections a suggestion that the entire pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" undergo a review.

Composition, Scope and Procedure — The committee reviewed our Composition, Scope and Procedure and recommended that the General Service Board approve the revised trustees' Committee on Corrections' Composition, Scope and Procedure based on the February 2009 General Service Board recommendations.

The committee looks forward to the corrections expertise of our two appointed committee members — Terrance (Terry) Flynn and Robert (Bob) Cordero—who begin service in July 2013.

Clayton Vandivort, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Approximately 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact.

If an incarcerated alcoholic requests free literature, he or she may be sent a Big Book, a copy of the Grapevine or La Viña, and a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*. Requests for multiple copies for an inside group, or ongoing requests from the same facility, are usually referred to those local A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service.

The Corrections Correspondence Service, coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many alcoholics who are incarcerated are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship for new correspondence volunteers — especially males. Every day more and more alcoholics in correctional facilities discover that the root of their problem is alcohol and decide to do something about it! In 2012 we linked 971 male and 371 female alcoholics in prison to an outside A.A. correspondent through the C.C.S. In order to meet those requests, we needed to be able to match the inmates with 1,342 outside A.A. volunteers. Although many of those offered to write to more than one incarcerated alcoholic at a time, the number of volunteers needed remains large.

Another aspect of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap committees. In 2012, we passed along to area corrections committee chairs 654 requests from inmates, corrections professionals, and A.A. members taking meetings into correctional facilities for prerelease contacts, outside support, or A.A. literature. We send out a periodic activity report to each of these committee chairs. This past year included notice that all Corrections service material could be accessed online to download, print out, and copy; news of updates to the Corrections Workbook; a call for sharing on the need for a remake of the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in

a Cell," a call for Grapevine stories for the annual prison issue and a new Bridging the Gap issue; a call for male participants in our Corrections Correspondence Service; news of Canadian corrections service work; and a reminder that corrections committees can connect with one another directly to find prerelease contacts for inmates going home to other areas.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site has a special section where most Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls* (SFBTW). This quarterly publication contains excerpts of sharing from A.A. members in prison who have written to G.S.O.

A.A. members involved in corrections service frequently ask how they can get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

M. Tracey Ober

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report:

G.S.O. — At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2012 and reported that G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$147,893, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was reduced by \$40,000 to \$107,893. For the year 2012, however, G.S.O. turned in positive results from operations of \$152,445. Both revenue and expenses were slightly less than budgeted.

Net sales for 2012 were approximately \$12,364,758, approximately \$350,242 (2.75%) less than budgeted. Manufacturing and royalty expenses were \$170,000 less than budgeted, and shipping and warehousing expenses were \$138,800 less than budgeted. The result was a gross profit of \$7,877,924, or \$41,758 (.52%) less than budgeted. On the positive side, Contributions received ended the year approximately \$29,600 (.45%) greater than budgeted. Expenses were \$56,788 (.4%) less than budgeted.

A.A. Grapevine — The Grapevine budget anticipated a net profit of \$34,081 for 2013. The actual result for the Grapevine was a net profit of \$257,003. For the year, gross profit from sales items was approximately \$48,777 better than budgeted, interest was \$11,200 less than expected and expenses were \$137,193 less than budgeted. La Viña anticipated a \$105,989 loss, but actually incurred a \$115,820 loss.

Reserve Fund — At December 31, 2012, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 11.3 months of operating expenses. It represents approximately 10.8 months of the 2013 budgeted expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions from members. Contributions of \$6,522,943 received from *groups and members* were approximately \$95,000, or 1.5 more than budgeted, and \$333,000 (5.4%) more than in 2011. The \$6,522,943 in contributions came from 27,326 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents approximately 42.4% of the 64,414 groups listed with G.S.O., even with the 42.4% reported last year. Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,557,608, received by G.S.O., reflected in our 2012 financial statements, include approximately \$34,665 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2011,

\$74,588; 2010, \$129,518; 2009, \$133,715; 2008, \$137,600; 2007, \$144,400; 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000.

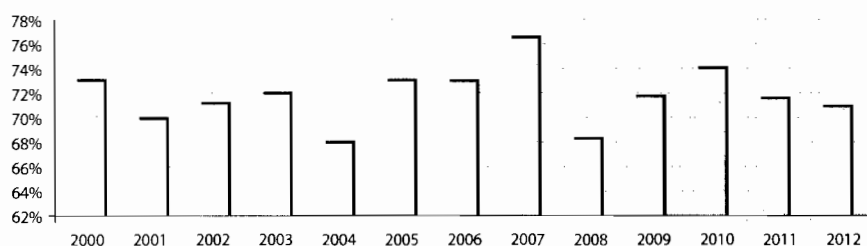
This year the number of groups listed at G.S.O., as shown on the Contributions Statistics report included in the Conference material, was 64,414, some 569 greater than the 63,845 reported last year. It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us. The Contributions department reported 80,936 contributions received during 2012, approximately 250 more than the 80,683 received during 2011 and compared with the 77,185 received during 2010. Beginning in June 2010 we implemented the Contributions online function. For the period June through December 2010 we received approximately 1,056 contributions via the online method, representing approximately \$82,500. During 2011 we received approximately 1,748 online contributions, or \$156,553, and in 2012, 2,346 contributions, or \$213,400, were received.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,364,758, which was only \$350,242 (2.75 %) less than budgeted, and approximately \$141,378 less than 2011. During 2012, approximately 949,296 Big Books were sold, compared with 945,500 Big Books in 2011 and 885,075 in 2010. Printing and manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were in the aggregate about \$308,682 less than budget. The Gross profit of \$7,877,924 was \$41,559 less than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$14,435,998, \$12,235 less than budgeted.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2012 were \$14,283,553, approximately \$56,787 less than budget but \$875,066 greater than 2011. For the year 2012 there were both under and over budget expense lines. Other Program Printing was under budget by approximately \$93,000. The primary reasons were due to reduced costs of Directories produced, various newsletters (including *Box 4-5-9*) and the Conference *Final Report*. The selling expense category was over budget, in the most part due to additional credit card usage by purchasers and fees associated with using and keeping the Web sites secure. Travel and meeting costs were over budget by \$58,000, approximately \$35,000 to \$40,000 of this due to additional costs incurred surrounding the board members and World Service Meeting participants being stranded for up to a week following Super Storm Sandy last November. When compared with budget, the lower revenues, combined with lower expenses, resulted in a 2012 positive operating bottom line of \$152,445, approximately

% of Services Supported by Contributions



\$665,500 less than 2011.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2012, \$9,254,132 was spent to provide Services to the Fellowship, approximately \$506,993 more than the \$8,747,139 spent in 2011. This compares with \$8,642,112 in 2010; \$8,783,762 in 2009; and \$9,447,300 in 2008.

The 2012 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 31.2 % (which includes various group contact-type costs in addition to *Box 4-5-9*; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.4 %; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 7.1 %; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.6 %; Regional Forums, 7.5 %; Archives, 9.2 %; C.P.C., 5.4 %; Public Information, 4.7 %; Correctional Facilities, 4.0 %; Treatment Facilities, 2.5 %; Special Needs, 2.5 %; Nominating, 3.2 %; World Service Meeting, 3.4 %; and other various 0.3 %.

Contributions provided 70.9 % of the support and 29.1 % came from the profit from literature sales. This compares with 71.6 % and 28.4 % in 2011; 74.2 % and 25.8 % in 2010; 71.7 % and 28.3 % in 2009; and 68.1 % and 31.9 % in 2008.

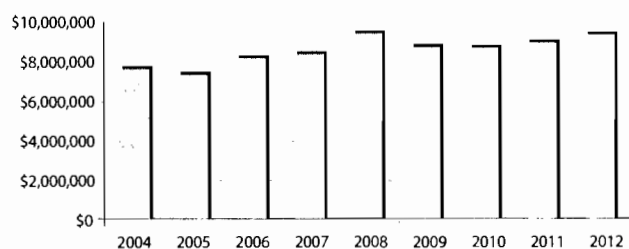
2013 G.S.O. Budget — Sales for 2013 have been budgeted approximately 1.4 % higher when compared with 2012, with a slight increase for e-book sales. With Contribution revenue up slightly in 2012 we have budgeted approximately 2 % increase in 2013, based on an improving economy and increased efforts by both the A.A.W.S. and the trustees' self-support communication efforts.

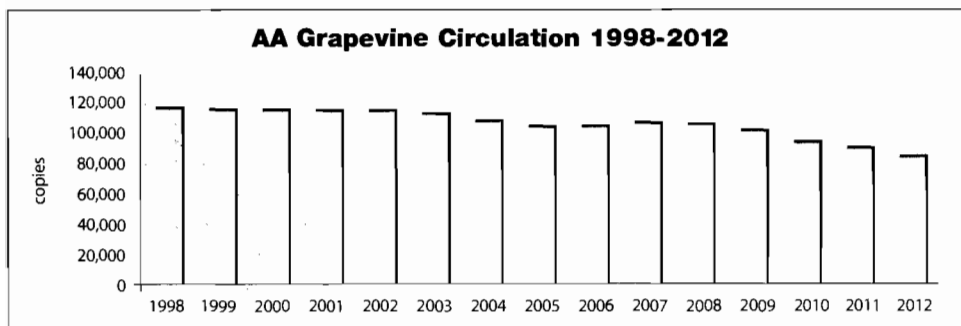
Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. We are trying to make more use of electronic communications wherever possible to reduce costs of postage and supplies. One should remember that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time.

Recent pricing history — In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed, by one year, the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. Previously, the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prices of books and booklets were increased effective July 1, 2009, anywhere from \$.25 to \$2.00.

The 2013 budget anticipates approximately a 5.6 % increase in costs when compared with 2012 actual results, and approxi-

Service Spending 2004-2012





magazine, single copies, back issues, Digital Magazine Subscriptions, GV On-line, Digital Archives Project Subscriptions, and the Audio Grapevine. Average paid circulation for the print magazine of 83,263 was 7,230 fewer than for 2011. The average paid circulation of 83,258 compares with 90,493 for 2011; 93,104 for 2010; 102,281 for 2009; and 104,993 for 2008.

Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,525,245 was \$52,834 greater than 2011, and \$48,152 greater than bud-

geted. Other publishing income was \$48,777 greater than budgeted and \$38,191 greater than 2011 as well. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,963,716, \$81,526 greater than 2011, and \$85,729 greater than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation, business, and administration were \$1,706,714. Costs and expenses were \$152,632 less than 2011, and \$136,989 less than budget. The Grapevine reported a profit from operations of \$257,003, which was approximately \$234,162 greater than the 2011 result of \$22,840, and \$222,718 greater than the budgeted profit of \$34,284.

Based on these preliminary assumptions — Approximately a 1.4% increase in sales, a 2% increase in contributions, and an increase in total operating expenses, the projection for 2013 is for a loss from operations of \$611,240. After considerable discussion, and taking into account the high level of the Reserve Fund, the A.A.W.S. Board did not propose an increase in literature prices for 2013. There will, however, be serious consideration for 2014.

The Grapevine's 2013 budget anticipates magazine income of \$2,200,256 (approximately \$142,653 less than the \$2,342,909 realized in 2012), a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$2,368, and a gross profit of \$1,384,960 is anticipated. Gross profit from magazine is anticipated to be approximately \$140,285 less than 2012. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to

During the budget process, the A.A.W.S. Board, as well as the trustees' Finance Committee, remains cognizant of the level of the Reserve Fund. Management continues to assess expenses and operations with an eye towards reduce costs.

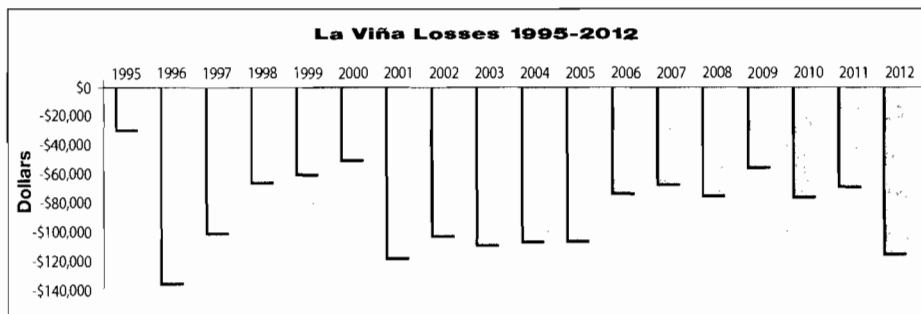
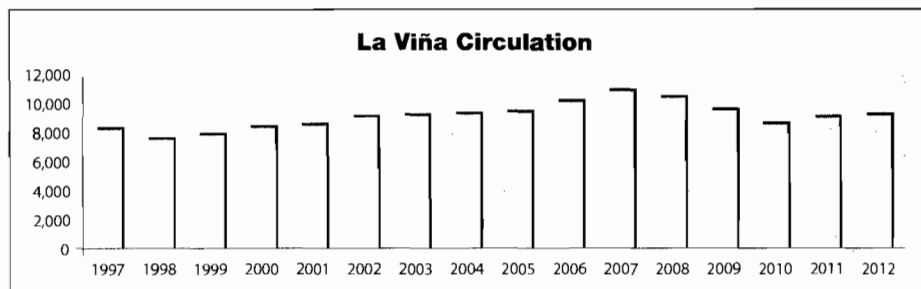
The Reserve Fund (and Historical Reference for price adjustments) — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted in previous reports, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31, 2012, of \$15,261,400 amounts to about \$237 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$985,000 from last year. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,557,608) by the 64,414 groups listed gives us an average of about \$102 up from last year's \$98, but equal with 2010, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$139 (up \$2 from last year).

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, gross magazine income for 2012 of \$2,342,909 was approximately \$26,100 more than the prior year. Included in total magazine income are the following items: the print

increase approximately \$11,228 to \$434,899, while interest income is estimated slightly higher than 2012. A profit for 2013 of \$11,954 is anticipated, compared with the \$257,003 profit for 2012.

La Viña — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2012 average circulation of 9,157. This compared with a 2011 average of 8,982; 2010 average of 8,741; 2009 average of 9,663; and 2008 of 10,404.

The hope had been that La Viña would increasingly fulfill the



■ Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2013¹

	Groups	Members
United States	59,321	1,295,656
Canada	<u>5,093</u>	<u>93,071</u>
Sub-Total	64,414	1,388,727
Correctional facilities ²	1,499	36,838
Internationalists	3	15
Lone Members	<u>0</u>	<u>67</u>
Total	65,913	1,425,647
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>48,726</u>	<u>705,902</u>
Grand Total	114,642	2,131,549

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 170 countries, including 63 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures

needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we would see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has yet to turn a profit. During 2012, subscription income was \$107,269 and direct costs of publishing were \$52,928, resulting in a \$54,341 gross profit. During 2012, La Viña realized approximately \$11,124 from the sales of other items, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$181,285. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on La Viña for the year was \$115,820, compared with a loss of \$69,725 for 2011; \$75,481 for 2010; \$54,472 for 2009; \$76,260 for 2008 and \$67,047 for 2007.

For 2013 the loss on the La Viña magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$127,179 (approximately \$11,359 greater than 2012), with circulation anticipated to be slightly higher. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,526,100 has been invested in La Viña in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other items — As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2006 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

Pension review — A subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011. Their objective was to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan

for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. Plan implementation is targeted for January 2013. During 2012 amendments were approved to close the old Pension plan to new employees and create a new Defined Contribution plan for employees hired after January 1, 2013.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations help to insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the economic outlook for 2013 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

Terrance Bedient, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 62nd General Service Conference, the General Service Board has held three General Sharing Sessions. In July 2012 the topic was "What is an A.A. Group?" Mary Dargan, G.S.O. staff member, shared on the topic "G.S.O.'s Group Listing Challenges" and Grapevine director Albin Zezula presented on the topic "Who Decides What an A.A. Group Is?"

During the October 2012 board weekend, the Sharing Session topic was "A.A. Literature Carries the Message Today." J. Gary Lutz, A.A.W.S. director, was asked to share about what A.A. World Services is doing to make the literature that they publish available to help carry the A.A. message. Nancy Haynes, Grapevine director, talked about what A.A. Grapevine is doing to make the literature that they publish available to help carry the A.A. message. Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O.'s Publications director, presented on A.A. literature in translation.

In February 2013 the Sharing Session topic was "How Are We Being Friendly With Our Professional Friends?" Adrienne Brown, G.S.O. staff member, talked about "How are we being friendly with our professional friends from G.S.O.?" Pam Jurica, Panel 62 Conference delegate, shared about "How are we being friendly with our professional friends in the area?" Terry Bedient, Class A trustee, presented on the topic "How are we being friendly with our professional friends from a professional perspective?"

Complete copies of these presentations are available and may be requested from the Staff coordinator at G.S.O.

Pam Reising, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine; six issues of La Viña; three new books (*Young & Sober, Into Action and Happy, Joyous and Free*); eight e-books — *Spiritual Awakenings I, Spiritual Awakenings II, Emotional Sobriety I, Emotional Sobriety II, Step by Step, Young & Sober, Into Action, and Happy, Joyous and Free*; a wall calendar; and a pocket planner.

In June 2012, A.A. Grapevine added a daily Grapevine Quote to the homepage. By the end of February 2013, over 16,500 people had signed up to receive the daily quote as an e-mail. In September 2012, we launched a pilot of our audio program at an audio recording workshop at the 54th annual ICYPAA Conference. Fifteen stories were recorded and collected for the Grapevine Audio Project. By year-end, Grapevine set up a new audio portal page on the AAGV Web site to invite members of the Fellowship to record their stories and submit them directly to Grapevine. By visiting that page members can learn how to either use the Grapevine recording system or their own devices (smartphones or digital

recorder) to record their story, as well as find tip sheets and sample audio stories. This portal page went live in January 2013.

In December 2012, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. began offering titles in the Amazon Marketplace. Currently for sale are 15 books and the 2013 calendar. The A.A. Grapevine Web site continues to grow and in 2012 received an average 36,000 unique visitors each month.

Eugene O'Brien, controller

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need, and to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines and Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A. Current ongoing projects involving Group Services:

- The Group Services coordinator collaborates with the Special Projects manager regarding the three A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.) and central/intergroup office records and lists.
- Supervises the updating of G.S.O.'s service material that is available, upon request and in Spanish and French, whenever possible.
- G.S.O.'s liaison to over 500 intergroup/central offices in the U.S. and Canada. Has a primary role in coordinating A.A.W.S.' participation at the annual intergroup/central office seminar and serves on the seminar's Policy and Site Committee. The 28th Intergroup/Central Office Seminar will next take place in Palm Springs, California, in October 2013.
- Coordinates with the Digital Media manager to continually update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- Serves as a resource to the managing editor regarding the updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter and as secretary to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee.

Jim Malone

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 22nd World Service Meeting (WSM) was held October 21-25, 2012 in Rye Brook, New York with the theme, "Rotation: The Heartbeat of A.A." We welcomed 62 delegates representing an estimated 36 countries or linguistic zones. Representing our General Service Board was first-term delegate Barbara Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada, and second-term delegate Don Massey, trustee-at-large/United States. G.S.O. general manager, Phyllis Halliday, presided at the event, and staff member Mary Clare Lynch served as WSM coordinator. Other staff members serving as secretaries to WSM committees were Mary Cumings, Jim Malone, and Rick Walker. John Kirwin was the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and li-

aision to hotel staff. After their closing dinner and an evening of opera, the delegates visited Stepping Stones and G.S.O. and were able to stay for the General Service Board meeting the following weekend. Their opportunity to become acquainted with members of the board was extended when we were hit by Hurricane Sandy and flights were delayed for a week or more. It was decided that the 2014 World Service Meeting will be held in Warsaw, Poland.

Literature Assistance — The 2013 Literature Assistance budget of \$75,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service board. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publishing Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2012, 76 reviews of proposed translations were completed in 30 different languages.

Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada will be represented at four zonal service meetings in 2013, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In June 2013, Phyllis Halliday and G.S.O. staff member Mary Clare Lynch will attend as observers, the 5th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM), which will be held in Johannesburg, South Africa. In July, Phyllis Halliday and Mary Clare Lynch will attend, as observers, the 10th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Irkutsk, Siberia, in Russia. In October, Phyllis Halliday and the newly assigned staff member on the International Desk will attend, as observers, the 17th European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany. Also in October, Barb Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada and the newly elected trustee-at-large/U.S. will attend, as delegates, the 18th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Salinas, Ecuador.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office continue to receive invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, to office visits and regional assemblies. In addition to the zonal events listed above, in 2012 trustees and staff members visited Kuwait, Mexico, the United Arab Emirates and Switzerland. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, which carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Don Massey, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s, and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 63 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers, and manages the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*.

The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, tele-

phone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our trust in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits from the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publishing Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publishing Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Working closely with our Records Department to insure that our International A.A. Directory (for countries outside of the United States and Canada), which is published annually, contains updated contact information for G.S.O.s, central offices and intergroups, groups, foreign contacts and Loners around the world.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publishing Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 68 languages, and additional translations are in progress.
- Communications related to overseas trips, and attendance at Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. These include the Asia-Oceania, European, and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Mary Clare Lynch

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — Much of the exciting activity for the 2015 International Convention lies in the next few years, but we are beginning to address some of the specifics of planning now. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the "Atlanta 2015 — Happy, Joyous, Free" design for the 2015 International Convention logo be approved. The logo will be trademarked for our use on International letterhead and signage. The committee considered its policy regarding vendors of goods and services at previous International Conventions and recommended to the General Service Board that during the International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous, July 2 through July 5, 2015, in Atlanta, Georgia, only those purveyors of goods and services that are part of or under contract to the Convention management will be permitted to operate on any of the facilities or grounds that are assigned to or under contract to the Convention management.

We reviewed and accepted the following general program cat-

egories for the 2015 International Convention: Marathons, Mini-Marathons, Panels, Regional Meetings, Special Interest Meetings, Special Needs Meetings, Special Language Meetings, Topic Meetings and Workshops (Sharing from the Floor). The committee recommended to the General Service Board that an A.A. Grapevine, Inc. souvenir item and a Grapevine or La Viña print subscription option be included on the registration form for the 2015 International Convention. We also recommended to the General Service Board that the sobriety requirement to share at the Saturday Old-timers Big Meeting be changed to 50 years of sobriety or more.

The committee discussed the participation of non-A.A. speakers at International Conventions and forwarded a request to the 2013 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums that up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate in the 2015 International Convention at A.A.'s expense. The committee reviewed the site-selection process and considered the Delegate and City Convention and Visitor's Bureau Bid Questionnaires submitted for site-selection of the 2025 International Convention. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the undernoted five cities be forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums for consideration as possible sites for the International Convention in 2025: Denver, Minneapolis, Montreal, St. Louis and Vancouver.

Regional Forums — Since the 2012 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Western Canada, Eastern Canada, Pacific and Southeast regions. One "Additional" Regional Forum was held in the East Central region. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the General Service Board, General Service Office, and A.A. Grapevine. Many in attendance were experiencing their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to exchange information between local trusted servants, A.A.s interested in service, trustees, directors and staff of G.S.O. and Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service. Following each Regional Forum the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums reviewed a summary of the Forum evaluation questionnaires.

In July 2012 the committee performed the fifth and final review of Local Forums and Additional Regional Forums and recommended to the General Service Board that Additional Regional Forums be discontinued after completion of the eight region cycle in 2016. The committee noted the cost of each Forum and the impact on the attendance and effectiveness of Regional Forums when three consecutive yearly Forums are held in any one region. The committee also recommended to the General Service Board that regions continue to be encouraged to support Local Forums structured to meet cultural, accessibility and population considerations within their own A.A. communities, and that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums continue to annually approve, at its July meeting, travel of up to two members of the General Service Board, nontrustee directors of the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards, or the G.S.O. or Grapevine staff at up to three Local Forums.

At their October 2012 meeting the committee considered the frequency of Regional Forums and, after thoughtful discussion, the chair appointed a subcommittee to review possible alternatives to make Regional Forums more cost effective. In February 2013, the subcommittee presented their report and suggested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums continue to explore alternatives to make Regional Forums more cost effective on an ongoing basis. The committee reviewed and accepted the board and staff schedule for participation at 2013 Regional Forums. The following Forums are scheduled for 2013:

2013

June 7-9	Northeast	Cromwell, Connecticut
August 16-18	Southeast "Additional"	Charleston, West Virginia
September 6-8	West Central	Bloomington, Minnesota
October 11-13	Southwest	Oklahoma City, Oklahoma
November 15-17	East Central	Fort Wayne, Indiana

J. Gary Lutz, chairperson

Staff reports:

The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

While still on the back burner, initial plans are underway for the 2015 International Convention in Atlanta, Georgia, July 2-5, 2015 to celebrate A.A.'s 80th Anniversary! The theme will be "80 Years—Happy, Joyous and Free." Big meetings will be held in the Georgia Dome, and other meetings will take place in the Georgia World Congress Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. General information is currently posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and updates will be published in Box 4-5-9, which is mailed throughout the Fellowship.

Eva Sanchez

Regional/Additional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Additional Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. groups, members and trusted servants in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staff. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes Regional Forum flyers to trusted service workers in the region that includes the registration form and coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, displays, on-site registration, etc. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the host contact who recruits volunteers to assist staff with hospitality, set-up and registration during the Forum weekend. The location for a Regional Forum is decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O., who also suggest presentations and workshops. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "early bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. Advance planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The General Service Board agreed that regions continue to be encouraged to support Local Forums structured to meet cultural, accessibility and population considerations within their own A.A. communities. The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Julio Espallat

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Committee on Literature since the 2012 General Service Conference.

• *Development of literature which focuses on spirituality* — At their July 2012 meeting, taking into consideration requested input and suggestions from the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature, the trustees' Committee on Literature continued its discussion on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality. The chair appointed a new subcommittee to continue working on the project. By their October meeting, the committee accepted the report from the subcommittee and requested that a draft pamphlet be prepared by the Publishing Department as background for their February 2013 meeting. Meanwhile, the subcommittee continued working on suggestions for the draft introduction to the pamphlet. At the February 2013 meeting the trustees forwarded the draft pamphlet, and final report on its development, to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration.

• *"Circles of Love and Service" pamphlet* — The 2012 General Service Conference recommended that the pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" be revised, and the trustees' Committee on Literature was asked to prepare a draft pamphlet or progress report for the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature. Following the Conference, general suggestions from the Conference Committee on Literature were passed to the Publishing Department to begin work on an initial draft of the pamphlet for consideration by the trustees' Committee on Literature. After reviewing the draft graphics and content at both their July and October 2012 meetings, the trustees' Committee on Literature agreed to forward the draft revised pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature.

• *No Action Items* — At the July 2012 meeting the committee continued to discuss a request to add the Twelve Concepts for World Service (with essays) to the current edition of the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and took no action. G.S.O.'s Publishing Department, along with staff, will continue to look for alternative ways to make information about A.A.'s Third Legacy available to the Fellowship.

At the February 2013 meeting the committee took no action on a request to reword a phrase on the *closed* meeting side of the "Primary Purpose" (blue) card, since they felt that the suggested language confused the issue of who could attend meetings with who could be a member of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Also at the February meeting the committee discussed a request to replace a phrase in the pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A." that addressed who could speak at an open A.A. meeting and took no action, agreeing that the proposed change was too limiting. The committee felt that the current statement makes it clear that it is not a common practice to have a nonalcoholic speak at open meetings, but that there may be a rare exception made according to group conscience.

Projects forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature:

- Revised draft pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service."
- Draft spirituality pamphlet with suggested titles.

Requests discussed and forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature:

- Consider a request to replace language in the second paragraph of the dust jacket of the 4th Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- Consider a suggestion to add "Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers" to the end of the open meeting side of the Primary Purpose (blue) card.

- Consider a request to add an index to the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- Consider a request to add the subtitle 'None Left Behind' to the newly revised "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet.

The committee extended their gratitude to the Publishing Department for their professional expertise, which is invaluable in completing the work of this committee.

Rod Betonney, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Committees on Literature, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publishing Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery books, booklets and pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services Publishing Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publishing staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, and intergroup/central office literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 69 area, 364 district, and 20 intergroup/central office literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, working closely with the Publishing Department managing editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to provide the Fellowship with news and notes from G.S.O. These "news and notes" may include articles containing shared experience from A.A. Conference-approved literature that addresses questions raised in multiple phone calls, e-mails and letters to staff members. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

Box 4-5-9 is published in English, French and Spanish with current quarterly distribution of 63,880 copies in English, 2,038 copies in French and 3,577 copies in Spanish. In addition, there are currently 12,233 subscribers to the digital delivery service for

Box 4-5-9 available through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site www.aa.org. Also on the Web site the interested A.A. member can find a digital copy of every issue of *Box 4-5-9* going back to the original issue from 1956. As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Mary Dargan

NOMINATING COMMITTEE

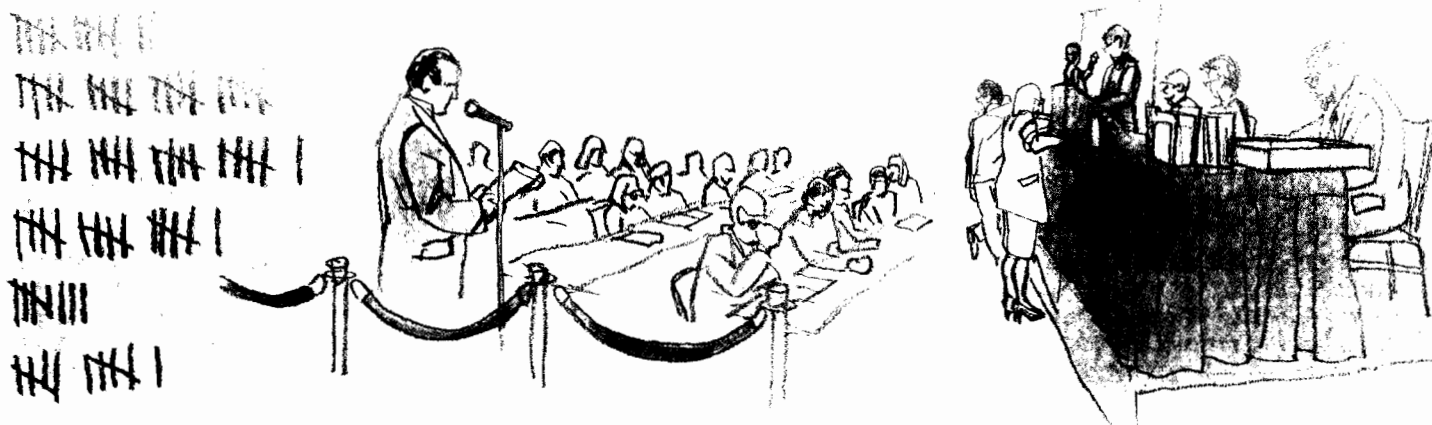
Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Nominating of the General Service Board was first appointed by the chairman of the board on January 18, 1944. At that time primary responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review resumes of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the trustees' Committee on Nominating.) The responsibilities of the committee grew over time to encompass criteria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees or among key service directors and staff members.

Activities of this committee in the past year:

- **Selection of General Service Board (GSB) Chairperson:** In keeping with the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action, "In accordance with the Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., the General Service Board consider all eligible Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board," 105 current and past Class A and Class B trustees were notified of the search for the chairperson of the General Service Board to succeed Ward Ewing, D.D. when he rotates in April 2013.

The committee reviewed the preliminary General Service Board chair search process and agreed that in keeping with Procedure No. 14, *Procedure for Selection of Chairperson of the General Service Board*, that it would act as a committee of the whole in its work to select candidates to be considered for the GSB chair.

The committee reviewed 15 responses from applicants and agreed to interview four people, one current and three past Class A trustees. After the interviews, one past trustee applicant withdrew his name from consideration. The committee agreed to forward two names to be interviewed by the full GSB at the October Quarterly Meeting. The committee expressed its gratitude to all current and past Class A and Class B trustee applicants who participated in the General Service Board chairperson search process.



In an Executive Session at their October 2012 meeting, the entire General Service Board, acting as a committee of the whole, interviewed the two candidates forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Nominating. With substantial unanimity, they selected Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE to be elected to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board at the April 2013 annual meeting of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. It was noted that, as a member of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Terry Bedient had absented himself during executive sessions when the General Service Board chairperson search process was discussed.

- **Class A Trustee Election:** The committee reviewed the resumes, curriculum vitae, and other background material of 21 applicants who had made themselves available to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees. The committee chose four applicants to interview in February 2013. Following the interviews, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that The Honorable Judge Ivan L.R. Lemelle and David M. Morris, CPA, be invited to serve as Class A trustees to succeed The Very Rev. Ward B. Ewing, D.D. and The Honorable Rogelio R. Flores following the 2013 General Service Conference.

- **Regional and At-Large Trustee Elections:** The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2013, all candidates submitted for East Central and Southeast regional trustees, as well as all candidates submitted for the trustee-at-large/U.S. election.

- **Board Slates:** The committee reviewed and recommended proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2013, following presentation at the 2013 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

- **Policies on Resumes:** At the request of the trustees' Committee on Nominating, A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine developed written policies on the solicitation, collection and maintenance of resumes for nontrustee director and general service trustee candidates.

- **Duties of the Chair:** The committee recommended that the following text briefly describing the duties of the chairperson of the General Service Board be approved and forwarded to the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

"Duties of the A.A. General Service Board Chairperson

"The chairperson of the General Service Board of A.A. presides over the trustees' meetings, co-chairs the General Service Conference, and functions on behalf of the General Service Board between board meetings. The chair appoints members of the trustees' committees, subject to G.S.B. approval, and is an ex-officio member of all trustees' committees. In addition to board meetings and the Conference, the chair participates in all Regional Forums and may participate in a number of other events."

Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures:

- **Procedures No. 9 and No. 10:** The committee forwarded suggested changes to Procedures No. 9 and No. 10 regarding the hiring of the G.S.O. general manager and the A.A. Grapevine executive editor/publisher to A.A. World Services, Inc. and to the A.A. Grapevine Board for their information and comments, if any.

- **Procedure 2:** The committee recommended that the following language in Item 9 of "Procedure 2 *Procedures for Selecting Appointed Committee Members*," which currently reads: "If a candidate is a past Conference delegate, he or she is not eligible until one year after rotation." be changed to read:

"Should the applicant be a past General Service Conference delegate, he or she is not eligible to apply for the opening until one year after his/her last Conference."

- **Executive Session:** The committee recommended to the General Service Board that William (Bill) Noonan serve as a general service trustee on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, following the April 2013 General Service Conference, replacing George G. Martin.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Albin Zezula serve as a general service trustee on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, following the April 2013 General Service Conference, replacing Don Miller.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that David T. Noll and Carole Boerner serve as nontrustee directors on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, following the April 2013 General Service Conference, replacing William (Bill) Noonan and Andrea Barthwell.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Lynda Bergeron and Ed Martin serve as nontrustee directors on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, following the April 2013 General Service Conference, replacing Albin Zezula and filling one of two vacancies on the Board.

- **Appointed Committee Members:** The committee recommended that Josh Eggleston of Durham, NC serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Public Information, commencing with the July 2013 General Service Board weekend.

The committee recommended that Terrence (Terry) Flynn of New York, NY and Robert (Bob) Fernando Cordero of Peoria, AZ serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Committee on Corrections, commencing with the July 2013 General Service Board weekend.

The committee recommended the reappointment of Tom Becherer of Louisville, KY for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Public Information Committee, and that Christine Hofer of Redford, MI and Teresa Frohock of Reidsville, NC serve as appointed committee members for an additional one-year term on the trustees' Literature Committee.

El Nault, chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment is responsible to the trustees' Committee on Nominating, and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. Since the last Conference, the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings. The staff member worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announcements, and also coordinated the transcription and review of resumes for 76 trustee candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedure.

Adrienne Brown

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing video and audio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on aa.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and

school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

- *Anonymity* — In response to a request from the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information, the committee asked the secretary to send a request for area sharing on the effectiveness of the language of the Short Form of Tradition Eleven in addressing the needs of the Fellowship today. At the February 2013 meeting, the committee noted the importance of continued efforts to increase understanding of Tradition Eleven within the Fellowship, and forwarded the areas' responses to the Conference Committee on Public Information.

In October, the committee considered a request to develop an additional service piece about Anonymity on the Internet and took no action, agreeing that currently available literature addresses this topic. At its February 2013 meeting, the committee considered a request to develop "a service piece based on the pamphlets 'The AA Group' and 'Understanding Anonymity' and adding language to emphasize current media where anonymity may be broken." The committee agreed to table this request until the General Service Board has reviewed the report from the General Service Board's Ad Hoc Committee on Social Networking/Media within our Three Legacies.

- *Communications with the Media* — The committee discussed the Anonymity Letter to the Media and the process for its distribution and the chair appointed a subcommittee to consider the Annual Anonymity Letter and how to implement the best possible distribution to media professionals. The subcommittee made several suggestions on how to make the letter and mailing process effective and attractive, and reviewed and accepted the text of the Annual Anonymity Letter to Media.

- *Membership Survey* — The results of the Alcoholics Anonymous 2011 Membership Survey were produced in pamphlet and tabletop display formats. A subcommittee was formed to consider the survey methodology and how the survey information is used as a Public Information tool. The subcommittee has gathered sharing from the Fellowship regarding the A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet, and a final report will be reviewed at the July 2013 meeting.

- *Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site* — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests and a status report on the redesign of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2013 Conference Public Information Committee.

- *The Grapevine/La Viña Web Site* — The committee reviewed reports from the Grapevine Board on Grapevine/La Viña Web site activity.

- *Video P.S.A.s* — The A.A. Conference-approved 2012 video P.S.A. for the Spanish-speaking community, "Tengo Esperanza," was finalized and is available for purchase. A subcommittee was formed to select a vendor for tracking and distribution of "Tengo Esperanza," as well as to review all current A.A. TV P.S.A.s for relevance and usefulness, and to consider if there is a need for a new A.A. TV P.S.A.

At the October meeting, the committee reviewed and accepted the report from the subcommittee on A.A. Video P.S.A.s and noted the selection of WestGlen Communication to distribute and track "Tengo Esperanza," in addition to the work done by the local com-

mittees. The committee agreed to forward the report on A.A. Video P.S.A.s to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information; the report includes the following two recommendations:

1. that the video P.S.A.s "My World," "I Thought," "Force of Nature," "Testimonials," and "We Know What It's Like" remain relevant and useful for the time being and therefore should continue to be distributed, and that "Living in Chaos" be retired; and
2. that one or more video P.S.A.s be produced in calendar year 2013, using the current five "Young People's Videos."

After discussion at the July and October meetings of a request to add references to Special Needs to new P.S.A.s, the committee took no action. The committee noted that while it is vital to communicate in Public Information efforts that recovery is available to all, local resources for alcoholics with special needs vary. The committee discussed other approaches to communicate the availability of A.A. to alcoholics with special needs and noted this demographic, along with others, is included in the Comprehensive Media Plan.

The committee considered a request to produce a Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.) aimed at attracting elderly alcoholics to A.A. and a request that a new television P.S.A. in American Sign Language (ASL) be developed and agreed that these requests should be included in the continuing development of the Comprehensive Media Plan.

The committee asked the staff secretary to implement minor format changes to current video P.S.A.s in order to facilitate obtaining Canadian Telecaster numbers necessary to broadcast these P.S.A.s in Canada.

- *Utilizing New Media Platforms* — In response to the Additional Committee Consideration of the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information about a Public Information social media page, a subcommittee was appointed in July 2012 to "explore all aspects of this social media page and, if feasible within our Traditions, provide the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information an implementation plan that addresses the implications of such a page, including sample content and estimates for implementation cost and maintenance."

At its October 2012 meeting the committee accepted the report of the subcommittee on a Public Information Social Media Page, and unanimously agreed with the subcommittee's conclusion that A.A. World Services, the General Service Office, and A.A. Grapevine and La Viña cannot establish a presence on Facebook in a manner which would be consistent with A.A. Traditions. The committee agreed to forward the report of the subcommittee on a Public Information Social Media Page to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information along with the subcommittee background. The committee also agreed to forward to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information a request from A.A.W.S. for permission to use commissioned online stores to sell and distribute digital A.A. literature.

- *Comprehensive Public Information Media Plan* — In July, a subcommittee was formed to continue development of the comprehensive Public Information Media Plan. At the October meeting, an oral progress report was given noting the subcommittee identified a need for a professional review of the plan and the importance of reviewing the plan annually.

At its February 2013 meeting, the committee accepted the report of the Comprehensive Media Plan subcommittee and agreed with the subcommittee's suggestion to continue communicating information about the media plan. The committee asked the staff secretary to attach the subcommittee's report, the Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan as approved in January 2012, and the

Tactical Matrix to the Plan, which was forwarded to the General Service Board. The committee agreed to include these materials in its report to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information. Development of the Comprehensive Media Plan is an ongoing project.

Cooperation with taping companies — The committee reviewed and accepted a draft letter regarding cooperation in maintaining the anonymity of A.A. speakers at the public level, which will be sent to all known taping companies that distribute or sell A.A. speaker talks— whether by catalog, onsite at conventions, or on the Internet. This letter will also be copied to the area delegates.

Literature — The committee considered a request for a new Public Information pamphlet focused on Public Information service and took no action. The committee agreed that locally developed literature can be a helpful tool and hoped that local committees will continue to produce such pieces to meet local needs. The committee also considered a request for a revision of the pamphlet “Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings” and took no action, noting the group autonomy expressed in Tradition Four and the long-held practice of many groups and A.A. events that invite professional friends of A.A. and Al-Anon members to participate.

P.I. Workbook — The committee reviewed requests to add language referring to committee record keeping and the Grapevine/La Viña to the Public Information Workbook and asked the secretary to work with the Publishing Department to incorporate these suggestions into the Public Information Workbook.

The committee remains committed to do all it can to assist the membership in its service of carrying the message of recovery through public resources to the general public and to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from the Fellowship as to what more can be done.

George Martin, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, community events, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with the 977 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees, which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of video and audio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.

- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In April 2012 it was e-mailed and mailed to over 14,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.

- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

The goal of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Mary Cummings

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the “G.S.O. Staff” with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. The staff coordinator shares responsibility for corresponding with members from the Pacific Region, covering the busy six months of the year for the Conference coordinator.

In 2012, the staff received 69,630 pieces of correspondence by mail, e-mail and fax, a 30 percent increase over correspondence received in 2011. The staff also answers many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. Mail, e-mail, faxes, etc., are responded to within ten business days.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries.

G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees’ and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2012, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,584 individuals, including many English- and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear “how G.S.O. works” and view a display of Grapevine materials during a tour of G.S.O. Often visiting members and guests attend the open A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Rick Walker

■ Area Service Highlights — Panel 63 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alabama/Northwest Florida: Area 1 covers the entire state of Alabama and the panhandle of Florida. We have over 500 groups in 24 districts, including our Spanish-speaking district. Our area assembly meets quarterly, which includes a pre-Conference assembly every April. Throughout our weekend-long assemblies, usually attended by about 250 people, we have workshops, committee meetings, an ask-it-basket meeting, a few A.A. meetings, and a business meeting. All of our Area Service Committees are actively carrying the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic, as well as cooperating with those who may be in contact with alcoholics. We have had a few challenges that we are still recovering from. One was an area convention in 2009, which resulted in a large hotel bill (\$93,000) that we could not pay. Gratefully, we were able to settle this situation reasonably, and have learned a lot from this experience. We have not had an area convention since, which forced us to become fully self-supporting through a sole reliance on group and member contributions. We now have our next Area 1 Convention scheduled for this October in Panama City. Despite our self-inflicted challenges, through God's grace and our Three Legacies, we are able to stay sober and carry the message — one day at a time. Thank you for my sobriety, and for the honor and privilege to serve Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Craig Miller*

Arkansas: Area 4 has 260 active groups in 13 districts, including one statewide linguistic district for our Spanish-speaking members. We hold four two-day assemblies each year in a central location. Our state Convention is the oldest convention west of the Mississippi River, held each summer at the historic Arlington Hotel in Hot Springs, Arkansas. This year will be Old Granddaddy's 73rd. The Archives Committee is active and the display set up at conventions is one of the finest. The Corrections committee coordinates meetings "behind the walls." The Treatment committee has established a Bridging the Gap program. The Grapevine Committee encourages subscriptions and has displays at all of our area assemblies as well as conventions throughout the area. The Web site committee maintains an informative, user-friendly, service-oriented Web site. The C.P.C. and P.I. committees work together to inform our professional friends and the public about what A.A. is and what it is not. The Group Relations committee is comprised of D.C.M.s from our 13 districts, who share their experience and solutions from district to district. Each of the area committees works with counterparts at the district and group level. Our past delegates make their experience available to everyone. I am honored and privileged to serve Area 4 as their delegate to the 63rd General Service Conference. — *Steve Foster*

British Columbia/Yukon: Area 79 is over 900,000 square miles, and is the second largest area in the Canada/U.S. service structure. More than three times the size of Texas, we have districts bigger than California. Area 79 includes 150 islands, five mountain ranges, and (of course) Canadian winters. We have 47 districts with approximately 700 registered groups, two "quarterlies" and two assemblies, with an average of 300 members attending each. We have held assemblies in Kitimat and Whitehorse where the majority of attendees were required to travel by plane. Ferry travel is frequently required. We are very grateful to have over 90% district participation. There are literature sales and/or meetings in many languages, including Punjabi, Farsi, Chinese, and Russian. We have several communities where the primary language is a First Nations language, such as Gwich'in or Tlingit,

and where neither A.A. literature nor A.A. meetings are available. An "Area 79 Micro-Forum" and an "Area 79 Remote Committees Kit and Workbook" are among the possibilities under discussion to help us to better reach *all* of the alcoholics in this vast and diverse area. We have recently redeveloped our area Web site to include a secure "trusted servant site" to facilitate communications with the groups. Area 79 is an active part of our Western Canada Region and hosts Regional Forums and Western Regional A.A. Service Assemblies on a rotating basis. — *Carolyn Barnes*

California (Central): Area 93 consists of 23 active districts; seven are linguistic districts. We hold four area assemblies, four area committee meetings and a Pre-Conference Workshop each year. Our Accessibilities Committee coordinated efforts with central offices to assist those with various disabilities in need of getting to meetings. Our Archives Committee hosted our annual Oldtimers event and has been digitizing their speaker tape library. C.P.C. continues to communicate with professionals with their "Sponsor-Your-Doctor" program and by participating in PACT (Police and Corrections Team), health fairs, workshops, and distributing A.A. literature to psychiatrists at mental health facilities. The P.I. Committee participated in programs for homeless veterans; P.S.A.s were placed with local radio stations and newspapers and Big Books were placed in libraries. We had reduced the number of unknown and inactive groups by 30 percent. Thanks to our Translation Committee, Area 93 remains a well-informed area by providing interpretation at ACM's, assemblies, and events and by translating minutes, agendas, our newsletter, and other documents. Treatment continues to make progress with setting up a Bridging the Gap program. Area 93 will continue to seek to joyfully serve our Fellowship. — *Sharon Gibbs*

California (Northern Coastal): Our 30,000 sq. mile area borders the Pacific coastlines, green valleys, urban areas and tree-covered mountains. Area 6 has over 2,000 groups and 58,000 members. Our expenses run about \$100,000 annually and contributions from members, groups and districts support all area activities. Our size, population, diversity and remote communities challenge is to achieve equal participation and effective communication. Our 23 districts have a D.C.M. and hold monthly meetings. About 75 D.C.M.s support 140 subdistricts and five linguistic districts serve 140 Spanish-language groups. The delegate and seven area officers rotate, visiting all district meetings monthly. CNCA has four assemblies, rotating through the area. We interpret and translate into Spanish all assemblies, area meetings, monthly newsletters and Web site; our Post-Conference Delegate Report is video recorded in ASL. Area business meetings include sessions for standing committees of: Archives, BTG, Finance, Interpretation-Translation, P.I./C.P.C., and Web, and meetings for Literature/GV/LV, DCMCs and D.C.M.s. We include reports from H&I intergroup-central offices council committees and young people's groups. Our biannual area inventory looks at services, expenses, and communication challenges. The love and enthusiasm to serve Alcoholics Anonymous in Area 6 is spirited and contagious. I thank CNCA for the opportunity to serve as their delegate. — *Padee McCreary*

California (Southern): Area 5 extends from Malibu Beach, including Hollywood, Los Angeles and seasonally snow-capped

mountains, to Ontario Airport. We have 15 service committees. Our most recent standing committee is Corrections. In California, Hospitals and Institutions precluded areas from instituting a corrections committee for many years, however, the connection with general services was sorely needed and now we fill that void. We hold four area assemblies, four area committee meetings, four steering committee meetings, a foro (yes, that is spelled the Spanish word for forum), and a two-day pre-Conference workshop annually, which we find invaluable. After discussing Conference agenda items with their groups, G.S.R.s attend the pre-Conference to meet at roundtables for further discussion and offer their insights to our delegate. All of our assemblies and area committee meetings provide professional Spanish interpreters. We have 32 active districts, of which five are overlaying linguistic districts. Although we are geographically the smallest area in the Pacific region, we are the third largest in membership. Sixty-six years ago our first Spanish group was formed, and they still hold their meetings in exactly the same place. Should you find yourself driving through Area 5, you can find a group holding a meeting not too far from you, day or night, carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Juan Montiel*

Colorado: Area 10 is geographically intersected north and south by the Rocky Mountains. Currently we have 847 groups in 31 districts and 19,571 members, including a state-wide linguistic district for our Spanish-speaking members. Our assemblies meet three times per year in districts voted on by the assembly after a bidding process. Our State Convention rotates among the larger cities, as does our Corrections Conference, which has been gaining favorable interest from other areas. We have eleven standing committees, one being our temporary Budget and Finance Committee, another being our translation committee. Using technology in this digital age, several of our standing committees use teleconference calls to encourage participation to connect districts and groups. *The Hi Country News*, our area newsletter is translated into Spanish and sent via electronic mail. One of our challenges is finding a way to bring the A.A. Service Structure into the conscious awareness of outlying groups, which could easily drop into isolation. How do we find and keep new members? Can we transmit a respect for Traditions successfully enough to ensure our future survival? What does new technology mean to our anonymity and to our face-to-face traditions? In order for our area, districts and groups to grow and reach more of our potential members, we need to encourage everyone to assume the responsibility for carrying our message through their own contribution and participation. This is the challenge of our Twelfth Step in action. — *Diane Davis*

Connecticut: Area 11 has ten districts; one is a linguistic district. We have eleven special service committees, meet monthly in a central location, and have three assemblies—pre-Conference, Spring, and Fall. Our area is very enthusiastic about being self-supporting and most recently we had a poster contest for the best Self-Support Slogan. The winner was, "With respect to the Seventh Tradition, I no longer give a buck." We spread the message of hope through our services and one is a statewide number for our Answering Service, which is 866 Steps 12, where anyone in need can call and be routed to the proper district. Our Grapevine Committee hosts an annual Grapefest. Our schedules are free and the committee works to keep the listings as accurate as possible. Recently our Archives Committee started to record our members with 30 years or more of sobriety. We translate our meetings and our literature

into Spanish. We make an annual trip to G.S.O., where our members meet the staff and enjoy fellowship on the trip into the city and home. Along with doing the great Twelfth Step work we have fun at our events: Rompiendo Fronteras/Breaking Frontiers, which is a day of bilingual sharing and workshops, our Area Convention, Round Up, Soberfest, which is a camping event, and Connecticut State Conference of Young People in A. A. I hope this short highlight gives you a quick journey through our state, and we welcome you to join us any time on *the road of happy destiny*. — *Rose Sherburne*

District of Columbia: Area 13 encompasses groups in D.C. and in Maryland's Prince George's and Montgomery Counties. We have over 485 active groups in 41 districts, including three Spanish-linguistic districts. There are 50 Hispanic groups hosting service workshops throughout the year, including an annual local Hispanic Forum. We have three assemblies and 11 committee meetings a year. Each Spring we host a mini-Conference to allow groups to exercise their "Right of Participation" in the Conference structure. We revised our Area Handbook and also produced it in Spanish. We revamped our Web site in an effort to duplicate it in Spanish. We held a Day of Sharing where we discussed the Service Structure; Safety in A.A. — Our Common Welfare; Anonymity; and Self-Support. We practice the Seventh Tradition at monthly committee meetings. Through our joint efforts with the Washington Area Intergroup Association, we were able to send our Archives Committee co-chair to the 2012 Archives Workshop in Cocoa Beach, FL; she is now serving as the Archivist. We are privileged to have 11 past delegates who serve as advisors to our area committee chairs. We in Area 13 are vibrant, diverse and committed to carrying the A.A. message, for our very lives as ex-problem drinkers depend upon our constant thought of others and how we may help meet their needs. It is an honor and a privilege to serve the Fellowship and Area 13 as Panel 63 delegate. — *Carmella Crockett*

Florida (North): We have over 800 registered groups and 31 districts, one of which is a linguistic district. We span from the Gulf of Mexico to the Atlantic Ocean, from the Georgia border to SE of Melbourne and SW to Hernando County. In 1941 the First North Florida A.A. group, Central, was formed in Jacksonville and is still meeting today in the San Marcos Club. We have four assembly weekends per year to do educational and training workshops, except in the spring when concentration is on the Conference Agenda items. We started to do pre-Conference Workshops in the field. We travel across the region doing what we call a "speed dating" format. Tables are set up around a room and our Area Service Committee chairs review the final agenda items in their respective field of service. Each session lasts 15 minutes. We also have final agenda workshops all day at the Spring assembly and a general session meeting Saturday night to get an informed group conscience for our delegate. North Florida's goal is to provide our members and groups with the necessary information and tools they will need to help the still-suffering alcoholic in their geographical area. Ever mindful of our Primary Purpose we are always striving to increase participation and enhance communication, because Area 14 believes that we are in the "Life Saving Business." — *Marilyn Balliet*

Florida, the Bahamas, U.S. Virgin Islands, St. Maarten, Antigua, and the Cayman Islands: Area 15 has 2,175 groups and over 40,000 members. We practice these principles, stay sober, and keep it simple through all of South Florida and the 2,534 nautical miles down the Overseas Highway to Key West,

the Bahamas, the Virgin Islands, St. Maarten, Antigua, and the Cayman Islands. We have 19 districts with 128 D.C.M.s and 1,481 G.S.R.s. Our Remote Communities Committee frequently meets over Skype, and includes the Seminole and Miccosukee Tribes. We have four quarterly assemblies; 917 members attended our January assembly, which was chock-full of Concepts, Traditions, *Service Manual*, and other workshops, speakers, and committee meetings. We have Spanish and American Sign Language interpreters at our assemblies and more and more committee meetings. We translate our minutes into Spanish and also place the scrubbed minutes on the password protected part of the Web site. Our Florida State Convention, shared with Area 14, is full of great speakers and workshops and attended by 3,000-4,000 folks. I am truly blessed to serve Area 15 and A.A. In grateful willingness, love and service. — *Don Fucik*

Hawaii: Area 17 has 240 groups, eleven standing committees, and 14 districts within six major islands: the island of Hawaii (frequently called the Big Island) has three districts; Maui has three districts including the islands of Lanai and Molokai; the island of Oahu with seven districts; and the island of Kauai as a district for the island. Our area meets three to five times a year for committee meetings and three to four times a year for area assemblies. One of the challenges of a "remote community" separated by water is to travel by air to the other islands. We have a couple of different airlines available, and/or by canoe, if one chooses. Hawaii has a high cost of living, and so are the airfares for the committee meetings and assemblies, yet "God provides." Our service participation continues to grow with the Young People of A.A. and our Annual Hawaii Convention will be held November 14-17, 2013, at the Hilton Hawaiian Village in Waikiki. We are a melting pot of the world, where we come together from different cultures and backgrounds to a place called Paradise, where we commonly "carry the message" in English, Local Pidgin, and the Language of the Heart. Love you and God bless. Aloha. — *Ken Koga*

Illinois (Chicago): Area 19 has 3,991 weekly meetings and 20 districts, four of which are linguistic, three Spanish and one Polish. We have eight standing committees and seven special committees. Our Chicago Area Service Office has six special workers and many volunteers that help it run efficiently. Opportunities for service include answering phones and helping with orders for our bookstore, which carries a variety of both A.A. approved and non-A.A. approved literature in many languages. Our bookstore will soon be going online. Our Corrections committee is very active and works regularly with neighboring areas to carry the message to inmates and help bridge the gap for those that will, upon release, come back to Area 19. This year marks the 74th anniversary of the first A.A. meeting in the Chicago area. We celebrate this yearly by hosting the All Chicago Open, held in September. Our committee on Conferences is currently planning something special for next year's 75th anniversary. Additionally we host the Illinois State conference once every three years as part of a rotation we share with Areas 20 and 21. In 2014 we will be hosting the Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar. Area 19 has a profound commitment to practice our Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service and I am honored to represent them. — *Mark Mankowski*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 covers the lower two-thirds of the state. We currently have 431 active groups in 17 districts. Three of our districts are dark, but two are starting to come back. We

hold four assemblies each year — each in a different district. The area committees hold a sharing session at each assembly, and give a report during the business meeting. We also hold a G.S.R. Workshop during every assembly for all first time G.S.R.s. Our past delegates have a vote at the area assemblies and we value their wisdom and participation. We held our first G.S.R. school last April. Area 21 hosts an annual Corrections Conference since we have a large Corrections population. This conference helps to foster communications with the Department of Corrections and to help encourage new people to carry the message behind the walls. We are working to bring this conference more in line with the information that will be discussed at the General Service Conference. Every third year our area hosts the Illinois State Conference with Area 19 and Area 20. We hosted the conference last year; it was a wonderful event and an opportunity to fellowship with members from the other areas. Thank you so much for the opportunity to serve Area 21. — *Becky Burden*

Indiana (Northern): Area 22 has 702 registered groups, of which eleven are Spanish-language groups. Our assembly meets four times per year in odd numbered years and five times in even numbered years, the additional assembly being an election assembly. Annually we conduct two D.C.M. Conferences. In March we help prepare the delegate for the Conference with the area Committee's review of each specific Conference agenda item and offer to the delegate the group conscience of each area Committee. In 2013 we will conduct a G.S.R.-D.C.M. school that will address the needs, qualities and responsibilities of the G.S.R. and D.C.M. Area 22 has maintained and supported an area Web site as a vital communication tool for the alcoholic who still suffers. Our Web site is designed to provide information about Area 22 activities and the process for contacting any of the nine standing committees that comprise our service structure. The Web site provides direct access to group meeting schedules and A.A. contact phone numbers for 46 of our 48 service districts. In November 2013 the East Central Regional Forum will be presented in Fort Wayne. We will interact with the representatives of the General Service Board and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members to share our enthusiasm and interest for carrying the A.A. message of hope to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Bill Reidy*

Iowa: Area 24 has 21 districts and 664 registered groups. Our area committee meets three times a year. During our March meeting we review the Conference agenda items so that our delegate has our conscience. Area 24 also participates in our West Central Regional Conference. Area assemblies are held twice a year, and are hosted by districts that have brought bids to the area committee or assembly. At our Spring Assembly our delegate presents their report from the Conference. Our Corrections committee takes several meetings into correctional facilities throughout Iowa. They have a biannual Corrections Workshop held in one of these facilities. Our Pink Can Fund currently has a balance of \$6,378.80, which has purchased 673 Big Books for correctional facilities. We have a Webmaster that serves on our P.I. committee by updating our meeting times and locations statewide, along with any upcoming area events. Our newsletter publishes five times a year. Our Archives has been able to share more of Iowa's A.A. history by giving tours during area committee weekends. We recently had a C.P.C./P.I. Workshop that included a panel consisting of a doctor, probation officer, drug court officer, district attorney and psychologist. Area 24 is blessed to have our past delegates participate in all of our meetings. Area 24 is full of drunks who love A.A. and

who have shared a message over and over with me that, "it isn't my job to change A.A., but to protect our Traditions and Concepts." — *Sheryl Figley*

Louisiana: Area 27 includes 31 districts, one of which is a statewide Spanish-speaking district. There are 544 groups and five central offices. We have a quarterly assembly where there is an average attendance of 150. We hold pre-Conference assemblies, in which members are randomly assigned to committees modeled after those at Conference. The Conference Agenda Items are reviewed and discussed, and the results are shared with the delegate. During each rotation, our area holds an inventory. We maintain an area Web site, aa-louisiana.org, which contains links to meetings and events around the state. The area and district P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections, Grapevine, and Archives Committees reach out to schools, radio and TV stations, newspapers, treatment centers, prisons, hospitals, courts, hotels, medical and law professionals, collecting group histories and stories from oldtimers, sharing and studying literature, and attracting more committee members. Our State Convention rotates around the state every two years. This year, we are hosting the 2nd Southern States A.A. Service Assembly (SSAASA) in Baton Rouge in November. Although our group contributions have increased, our area has found itself with a deficit budget. We are having discussions about our responsibility in services provided and priorities in budgeting. We are continuing to grow and learn in the unity of our primary purpose. — *Holly Peterson*

Massachusetts (Eastern): The over 2,200 meetings and 1,400 registered groups in Area 30 are divided into 27 districts; 26 geographical and one Spanish-linguistic. Our assembly meets five times a year at various locations. Each assembly has a different theme: budget/kickoff, pre-Conference, post-Conference, workshop, and on even years, an election assembly. On odd years the fifth assembly is used for an additional workshop. Our active committees meet monthly and provide information and support to the districts, handle commitments to facilities and the public, supply literature to institutions in the area, and facilitate the Bridging the Gap program. The monthly area committee meeting is held at a central location and is where the Conference and standing committees report to the area D.C.M.s and officers. Our six central service and intergroup offices provide vital local A.A. services for the over 46,000 members of the Fellowship. Our area Web site, aaemass.org, contains links to the service committees, the local intergroups, service pieces, and a calendar of events in the area. This year Area 30, along with our friends from Area 31, Western Massachusetts, will be hosting the 50th Annual Massachusetts State Convention in November. A.A.'s message of hope that was freely given to me when I entered these halls unasked is still being carried in Area 30, and the love of service felt by those who share that message ensure that it will still be passed on for some time to come. — *Ken Taylor*

Michigan (Central): Area 32 has 752 registered groups and over 15,000 members in 14 districts. One district was dark and is now bright. Our committees are actively working to make sure the hand of A.A. is always there. Our area meets every other month and is hosted by alternating districts. We have a Statewide meeting quarterly where we meet with Areas 33 and 34 to share information on activities in all three areas. Our statewide Corrections committees held a successful statewide Corrections workshop. In March we host the Mock Conference to prepare our three Michigan delegates for the General Service

Conference, and we discuss the Agenda items of the committees the Michigan delegates are serving on. Our Michigan State Convention rotates between the three areas each year. The districts are very active in hosting events throughout the year. Area 32 prepares an inventory every other year, which allows us to see how we can better serve the Fellowship. We are grateful for our past delegates and past trustees, they are always there with their experience and knowledge. It is an honor and privilege to serve Area 32 and the Fellowship as the delegate. — *Pauline Newas*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33's assembly meets monthly and the minutes are available by e-mail or regular mail. We are in the first year of our two-year officer's term and in the second year of our committee chair's term. This staggered election process has provided stability for our area service structure. We had an officers meeting (group conscience), prior to our January assembly, to identify and discuss our 2013 – 2015 legacy. The following guidance emerged: Follow up with all area committees, who receive our G.S.O. correspondence, to respond within the time requested; encourage communications between committees and area officers, to assist in maximizing the outreach of our service message through each committee; to assist our 25 districts, communicate with the 900+ registered and unregistered groups by bringing awareness of becoming involved in service to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Our area assembly offers a *Service Manual* study. Our January 2013 assembly experienced a power outage due to high winds and we had approximately 125 attendees who braved on by cell phone light, flash light and unamplified speaking. No one left; they all came to do the business of A.A. and it was done. — *Dennis Morrow*

Minnesota (Southern): Area 36 has 26 districts serving over 1,200 registered groups, with three active Intergroup offices. We have six officers and 13 committees. In addition to committee chairs we have five nonrotating positions, including Archivist, Pink Can coordinator, Treatment and Corrections contact program coordinators, and Web master. Annual activities include our weekend Recovery, Unity and Service conference. Early in the year we have our Trusted Servant Leadership Training day. To help develop awareness of the Conference Agenda items we encourage participation in our annual West Central Regional Service Conference and our delegates workshop day in April. Area 36 holds four quarterly area committee meetings and three assemblies each year. Our archives recently expanded in a new location that allows for better storage and display. C.P.C. participates in a number of professional conferences and there is an increasing emphasis on "Sponsor Your Professionals." Our P.I. committee coordinates our participation in several State and County Fairs. We have area-wide participation in our Treatment and Corrections contact work. Our Pink Can program provides tens of thousands of pieces of literature to those inside the walls each year. Other A.A. activities include the annual Gopher State Roundup, where more than 9,000 spent their 2012 Memorial Day weekend. We are hosting the Regional Forum this September 6-8 in Minneapolis. — *Terry Lindgren*

Missouri (Eastern Missouri): Area 38 has 545 registered groups with 8,600 members over 32,000 square miles. Approximately half of our districts are in the St. Louis Metro region, with the other half spread between outlying cities and rural communities. We have 23 districts, including a newly formed Spanish-speaking district. We conduct four one-day assemblies annually in St. Louis with a two-day election assembly in the even num-

bered year. We conduct a mock Conference at the March assembly to allow our delegate to hear the informed group conscience of our area. Our Missouri State convention, in partnership with Area 39 (Western MO), is held annually in our state capital, Jefferson City. Our Archives has expanded and all of our ten standing committees are filled and active. Due to moving the assembly to St. Louis and our renewed outreach our attendance at assemblies has grown over the last two years. Our area officers, past delegates and oldtimers work to bring along the new person in service through each rotation. This allows us the benefit of experienced and prepared servants at all positions. Eastern Missouri greets you with open arms, a smile and a fresh, hot cup of A.A. coffee. I am grateful to serve as delegate with our own Clayton V. as SW regional trustee. — *Larry Noonan*

Missouri (Western): Area 39 has 248 groups in 16 districts and covers approximately 35,000 square miles. We have two central offices, in Kansas City and Springfield. We hold four two-day assemblies in Sedalia. We have a G.S.R. sharing session, a D.C.M. sharing session, and area committee chairpersons meeting. Saturday afternoon is our area committee meeting, and Saturday evening we have a workshop followed by area officer reports and past delegates comments. We have the Western Area of Missouri Convention in October in Branson, and co-host the Missouri State Convention in Jefferson City in August. Area 39 also holds an Institutions Weekend, where we invite professionals who correspond with the area standing committees to participate on workshop panels with our A.A. members to better carry the message. In 2012 our Grapevine committee held The Many Faces of Grapevine. Thanks to the humble service of so many dedicated members the message of Alcoholics Anonymous is being carried throughout the western area of Missouri. I would like to thank my area. It is indeed an honor and privilege to serve as your delegate. — *Dave Hall*

Montana: Area 40 has 14 districts and 290 registered groups. We include most of the state of Montana, about 144,000 square miles. We hold two assemblies a year. In the spring assembly we discuss Conference agenda items. The assemblies have traditionally been held in Lewistown, at the geographic center of the state. The immediate past delegate serves as area advisor; we invite two past delegates to facilitate workshops and ask-it-basket sessions; many past delegates attend; we invite our regional trustee to one assembly during each rotation. The area recently took its inventory and made changes in the agenda for the assemblies in order to keep energy high. We recently made changes to our Bridging the Gap program, providing a secure repository of contacts through the area Web site. We will be able to quickly match alcoholics coming back into our communities from Treatment or Correctional facilities with A.A. members. We have discussed the business to be conducted at this Conference and I have a sense of my area's thoughts on the agenda items. I am grateful to serve Alcoholics Anonymous for the daily blessing of sobriety I am given. — *Sharon Stevenson*

Nevada: The state of Nevada and Eastern California form Delegate Area 42. Nevada has more than 400 registered groups; California has approximately 50. We are 23 districts, two of which are Spanish. In the 1970s Area 42 divided into northern and southern service assemblies, ultimately creating three service structures. In the north the majority of the groups are in the greater Reno area. In the south Las Vegas is the focal point. Each service assembly meets four times per year: the southern Area stays in Las Vegas while the northern area assembly travels to smaller and more distant towns. Area 42 will take its

inventory at our September assembly. In January the northern and southern committees each host special G.S.R. training. They are followed in late February by agenda item roundtables. In late March, we meet as Area 42 where additional agenda items are presented and discussed. Group participation has steadily increased as the roundtable events have evolved. What are our challenges in Area 42? We have three service structures including three treasuries. What are our blessings? We have three service structures and many opportunities to participate in General Service. Another blessing is that we have many past delegates, and two rotated and one seated trustee participating at our area assemblies. Thank you Alcoholics Anonymous for our solution and thank you Area 42 for trusting me to serve as your delegate. — *Sophie Kenn*

New Jersey (Northern): Area 44 has 42 districts serving approximately 1,200 groups with 33,000 members. The districts are grouped into six sections, each with a section coordinator. Additionally, two of the districts are Spanish-speaking, supported by a permanent committee on translations. Five of our seven standing committees, and two special committees, are jointly chaired and funded by Northern New Jersey Intergroup. Each year we hold six area committee meetings, three assemblies, one mini-Conference, and one Work Weekend where the area conducts its annual inventory. Our groups and members proved just how resilient they are in how they weathered Superstorm Sandy and just how dedicated they are to our program and the alcoholic. While some groups were only temporarily displaced, others may never return to their original meeting places as the buildings did not survive the storm. The D.C.M.s related stories about meetings held in homes until new locations could be found, of churches and other locations that took us in — sometimes temporarily and sometimes permanently — to replace the lost facilities. Our groups never missed a beat. Our Web site committee is constantly updating meeting information. I am honored and humbled to serve my area and I will never be able to give back to A.A. what I have received. — *Linda Kornacki-Kuhns*

New York (Central): Area 47 spans north near to the Canadian border, to the south of the state, including districts in Sayre, Pennsylvania. It is a large area serving cities such as Syracuse, Rochester and Binghamton. We have nearly 600 groups; our assemblies are conducted eleven times a year with an area convention in May or June. Different districts host the assemblies and convention. We average about 75-80 members at the assemblies, and provide literature, as well as Grapevine material, at a lower cost. We continue to work toward informing the groups about our area to increase group participation. We have seven area officers and ten active area committees, and a standing archivist, that meet at the monthly assemblies. We have a Web site. In August we share an Informational Workshop with the other areas in New York State. The committee chairs of all four areas present on panels throughout the weekend. From time to time the four area committees have joined together in events such as Correction Connection, C.P.C. events, and Bridging the Gap. I was sad to see our NY State Convention come to an end last year, but our four area delegates help each other with common problems and share solutions. — *Patricia Schaller*

New York (Southeast): Area 49 covers 12 counties. We are unique in that we have districts as well as counties. We have over 2,000 groups in SENY and hold five full-day assemblies per year. We hold a Delegates Day of Sharing, which includes presentations by committee chairs of items on the Conference agenda. This gives the

G.S.R.s an opportunity to ask questions that will help them present to their group those items which may come up at the Conference. Our translation committee translates English to Spanish, Polish and Russian, at our assemblies, conventions, County Share-A-Days, workshops and Unity Breakfasts when needed. Our agenda, minutes, and area newsletter, the *LINK*, are translated, giving us *ENLACE*, the Hispanic newsletter. The La Viña liaison scheduled four successful workshops in an effort to increase subscriptions and one writing workshop to help members send in their stories. Our P.I. committee, along with the N.Y. Young People in A.A., launched a high school project where letters were sent to all public and private schools with an interest in receiving an A.A. package consisting of the Young People's animated video and various pamphlets. We continue to hold our annual Area Convention and share expenses with the other three areas in New York. Through our continued efforts we are seeing an increase in attendance at assemblies and committee meetings. We look forward to more service participation, one day at a time. — *Linda McGhee*

North Carolina: Area 51 includes all of North Carolina, extending approximately 600 miles from the Great Smoky Mountains on the west to the Atlantic beaches and the Outer Banks on the east. We have 19,000 members who belong to approximately 1,100 groups, which are served by 38 districts. Our Spanish linguistic service structure includes three districts and 37 groups. We also have 58 corrections groups. Our area's general service events include four quarterly committee meetings. Five years ago we initiated a Mock Conference at our winter committee meeting. We also conduct three regional and one Spanish pre-Conferences. Our pre-Conference theme this year was "Be Involved, Be Informed, Be Inspired, Be of Service." There is great fun and fellowship at our 66th Annual NC State Convention in July, and our 25th Annual Freedom from Bondage Corrections Conference in March. Our area has strong past delegate support, which has resulted in significant growth in Area 51. During the last five years, our membership growth has exceeded 20% and our annual total contributions to G.S.O. have increased by over 40%. This year we are planning an area inventory that will help us provide a solid foundation in carrying our message to the still-suffering alcoholic and to continue being self-supporting. I am most grateful for the opportunity to serve Area 51 and A.A. as a whole. We welcome you to visit us anytime! — *Homer Moeller*

North Dakota: Area 52 is composed of 12 districts with approximately 150 registered groups. We have about 3,300 members. Groups have a varying attendance in rural areas with three to four attending at a meeting, up to 150 and more in attendance in the urban areas, with 51% of our groups contributing. We have three area assemblies yearly. A Service conference is held at the same time as the mid-March Assembly. September Assembly is held in conjunction with the State Round-up. Several years ago, we implemented the Committee system to oversee the process of Area 52 business. This has been proven to be very beneficial. We are excited to announce that Bismarck has been selected to host the 2016 West Central Regional A.A. Service Conference. Area 52 has concerns like all areas, such as: How to better carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic; Seventh Traditions contributions; transitioning into the digital age; and how to encourage more alcoholics to get involved in service work. And concerns of the why, where, when and who on ensuring the continuation of Alcoholics Anonymous into the future. We believe that the Area 52 Service structure remains responsive and responsible to those they serve. — *Mike Rogalla*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Area 82 extends from all of Nova Scotia to the tip of Newfoundland/Labrador. The area consists of 17 districts and 218 groups; English is the spoken language. We have one assembly, in the fall, which rotates throughout the two provinces. Also, we have two Service Weekends: one in May held in NL/Lab and the other in June held in Nova Scotia. Each district has P.I., C.P.C., Bridging the Gap, Twelve Step, and Corrections committees, and the area has a Remote Communities committee. These committees are actively carrying the Twelve Step message to the prisons, jails, treatment centers, health fairs, schools, etc. Our Archive committee has gone digital. We have a Web site that is a very useful tool for people to find updated information on meetings, service functions, roundups, socials, Christmas parties, celebrations of sobriety, and other events. Many of the districts put on Roundups (Socials) Mid-Winter and summer. In the last two years Nova Scotia has experienced a Maritime Conference for Young People which was very successful. This year Newfoundland/Labrador is hosting the conference in St. John's, NL. Words cannot express my gratitude for the love and support of my area and past delegates who have been such wonderful examples and mentors, and who have encouraged and supported me on this journey. It is both an honor and privilege to serve as their Panel 63 delegate to this General Service Conference. — *Marilyn Rodgers*

Ohio (Central/Southeastern): Area 53 encompasses 38 counties, with approximately 691 registered groups meeting in 29 districts. The area holds quarterly assemblies and the area committee meets in the month following each assembly. The Correctional Facilities committee continues to support A.A. in prisons. In 2012 the group contributions in the "Change for Change" jugs enabled the committee to allocate \$25,100 to buy and carry A.A. literature into 17 institutions that hold A.A. meetings. The C.P.C./P.I. committee recently placed Big Books in Columbus Public High School libraries and staffed a P.I. booth at a three-day Addictions Studies Institute event. The Special Needs/Accessibilities committee helps groups with American Sign Language (ASL) interpreters, and Group Services efforts produce the G.S.R. School on line and for districts and special events. Area elections are held every other September at the assembly in the even numbered years. A mini-Conference is held on the second weekend in March. Area 53 will host the 57th Ohio State Convention of A.A. in August at Worthington-Columbus. The 2013 OYPAA State Convention will be held the same month in Columbus. It is an honor and a privilege to serve Area 53 as delegate and participate in the 63rd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *David Cornwell*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 is home to 1,300 registered groups and eight intergroup/central offices. The groups, located throughout 20 counties, are divided into 62 geographical districts that include a Spanish-linguistic district. Encompassed within our borders is the birthplace of A.A., Akron, Ohio, with all of its many carefully preserved historical sites. Each year in June, A.A. members and their families, worldwide, make the pilgrimage to Akron. About 40 minutes north of Akron, also integral to our area's rich A.A. history, is Cleveland, Ohio. It was here that the first International Convention was held in 1950 with 3,000 in attendance. While providing many vital services to the groups, Area 54 is always bustling with service activity. Annually, there is the Mini-Conference, Founders' Day, the Area Open House Picnic, and Gratitude Sunday. Throughout the year, there are area assemblies, workshops,

district picnics and workshops, mailing parties, and Service Panels that visit the groups upon request. All activities are designed to provide great opportunities for service, sharing sessions, fellowship, and an avenue to stimulate interest in general service. It is with deep gratitude, great passion and honor that I thank you for the privilege of being a trusted servant in our most amazing Fellowship. — *Ola Pearson*

Oklahoma: Area 57 has 424 registered groups with approximately 8,400 members. We have eight districts, two in each metro area and four comprising the rural areas. Each district has an equal amount of D.C.M.s. We also have a Spanish sub-district, as we have nine Hispanic groups across the state. We have four committee meetings and one assembly per year, and hold a minimum of four area-hosted workshops in the rural towns with a range of service topics. We have held several "Internet, Friend or Foe" workshops across the state and this has seemed to help curb some of the negative aspects of social networking and anonymity. We also have created an annual service conference, dubbed "Fun in the Fellowship" to stir interest in our service committees. We open with a G.S.R. Forum and a D.C.M. Duties Review, then hold committee workshops and end with a skit and a speaker meeting. Our success is reflected by our continued growth since its inception, four years ago. We are honored to host the Southwest Regional Forum this coming October in Oklahoma City. Our host committee, made up of people from all over the state, is excited to show some good old-fashioned Oklahoma hospitality. Unity is at an all-time high in Oklahoma, thanks to the vision and combined efforts of our trusted servants. I'm both honored and humbled to be in the ranks. — *Harold Casey*

Ontario (Eastern): Before getting here I envisioned Area 83 to be massive — 300 miles long with 512 active groups in 27 districts, including one Spanish! Our 19,000 souls live between Toronto on the west and Ottawa on the north; the Quebec border on the east then back along the top of Lake Ontario to the south, taking in some U.S. real estate in upstate New York. We're a bit quaint and homey in Area 83, but that sure isn't indicative of the quality of service we claim. Our two area assemblies each year are vital and well attended places of joy and much excitement. At our last elections, 13 members let their names stand for area chair and each position that followed saw the same infectious enthusiasm. We're a happy, willing, well-adjusted area with a storied history and an impressive record of service. If Area 83 were a bird, it'd be a Bluejay — perky, known for its intelligence and its tight family bonds. If Area 83 were a dog, it'd be a Golden Retriever — cheerful, trustworthy, dependable and forgiving. We are doubly blessed to have Joe Downey, our Panel 51 delegate, currently serving as a nontrustee director of A.A.W.S. and Barb Kelly, our Panel 55 delegate, currently serving as trustee-at-large/Canada. I am the 32nd delegate to come from our area and I just couldn't be more proud or more humbled to be here. Thank you all for Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Mel Caterine*

Ontario (Northeastern): Area 84's meetings are held primarily in Cree, English, French and Ojibwa languages. Our area follows suggested procedures and guidelines at three meetings a year in addition to our Fall Assembly and Spring Sharing Session. We will be holding our 46th area convention this fall in Sault Ste. Marie. Each spring our area participates in a rotating Ontario Delegates Committee Meeting in order to prepare for the Conference. This year, we were one of the ten areas sponsoring the newly formed Canada Eastern Regional Alcoholics

Anonymous Service Assembly, held in Montreal. In July 2012, we attended the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in St. Catherines. We have an active Intergroup Office and a material-rich Archives office. Our area is divided into seven active districts, which encompass roughly 800 miles. Many of our Remote Communities are accessible only by plane or ice roads in the winter. Often high gas prices and great distances affect our ability to communicate in person. Members of our 134 groups speak to students, medical faculty, prison inmates and rehabilitating clients. Our districts hold day or weekend-long events as well as Gratitude Dinners, group anniversaries, dances, service workshops and campouts. I am indebted to all our members and our loving trusted servants who have kept the doors open for us, and for those who follow. — *Gail Robinson*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 is divided into seven districts containing 56 active groups with approximately 1,500 members. assemblies, with elections are held every second year. In addition to the seven districts there are approximately 27 Remote Communities located within Area 85's 260,000 square mile boundaries. The Remote Communities Committee shares information and ideas, via teleconference, with counterparts across Canada and Alaska on a bimonthly basis. Electronic communications are tools necessary in providing support for members and groups. The area Web site is capable of sponsoring online meetings and this service is used frequently. Active groups work diligently maintaining their primary purpose and continue being self-supporting. In the spirit of attraction many groups hold various social events, such as pot luck dinners, chilli cook-offs, fish fries, barbecues, dances, picnics, ice cream socials and special celebration events around Halloween, Christmas and New Year's. Last year there was a well attended event called "Celebrating 100 Years of Sobriety," at which two members of the Fellowship were honored for celebrating 50 years of continuous sobriety each. New for the upcoming year is the Annual Area Round-Up being spread over three days in three different venues, a Cultural Center, a driveway and a basement A.A. meeting room. It is indeed a great honor and privilege to represent the members of Area 85 and to serve the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Ken Baker*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 has approximately 1,500 groups with 48 districts, including one Spanish-linguistic district. Our annual assembly/convention, held each November, had 875 attendees with 533 total votes for area officers elections in 2012. We maintain eight standing subcommittees plus a Convention Committee. We hosted NERAASA in 2013; held Days of Sharing with six regional intergroups/Central Offices; hosted a joint workshop with eight of our 12 intergroups/ Central Offices; participated in the PA State Convention and PENNSCYPAA; held a pre-Conference Sharing Session to gather the area's conscience on Conference agenda items. We are looking forward to holding two regional Delegate's Conference Reports with additional reports as requested; holding an Area Inventory midway through the Panel; conducting a D.C.M. Orientation, done each year; continuing to explore ways in which Area 59 members will be attracted to General Service. — *Steve Otto*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 consists of 27 counties in the western half of Pennsylvania, containing 844 active groups in 45 districts that serve over 12,000 members. We meet quarterly and hold three assemblies per year. Our Get Away Weekend/Pre-Conference Assembly has returned to a more NERAASA-like format with panelists sharing on selected topics from the Conference agenda items. The recent area inventory provided

valuable constructive feedback regarding the effectiveness with which Area 60 helps to carry the message to the still-sick and suffering alcoholics among us. We are blessed to have several active past delegates who continue to share their experience, strength and hope. In close proximity to Akron and the home of co-founder Dr. Bob Smith, we enjoy a rich history with Alcoholics Anonymous and still have several meetings well over 60 years old. I am grateful for the Third Tradition that cannot keep "beggars, tramps, asylum inmates, prisoners, queers, plain crackpots, and fallen women" out, and I am honored and privileged to be the fourth consecutive woman to represent the Fellowship of Western Pennsylvania at the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Yvette Nelson*

Quebec (Northeast): Area 89 is a vast territory that stretches from Louiseville in the West, to Blanc-Sablon in the East, North to Chibougamau, and South to Lévis. Our vast and beautiful area includes 23 districts. Each year, we have two general assemblies and four area assemblies, and eight active committees. Area 89 has 283 groups, of which 274 are French, four English and two bilingual, one in Atikamekw, and two in Innuksituk. We hold 319 meetings each week, and have 5,406 registered members. The area committee meets three times a year with the three other area committees of Quebec. As delegate, I am a director of our bimonthly magazine *La Vigne*. Area 89 also has a well designed and easy to navigate Web site, as well as a Seminars Committee for sharing our knowledge and experience of our principles and Legacies. We have been privileged to hold a First Nations Convention in Pessamit for the last 12 years. At the center of our area (Quebec City) we have an Intergroup with the various service committees, one of which is Literature, and we have an administrative assistant, the 'ear' of our Area. Our area has grateful members who get together to help other suffering alcoholics. Our first Eastern Canada Regional Service Assembly is approaching (ASTE-CAA – CERAASA). Ten areas will meet to share their Experience, Strength and Hope. Thank you for greeting me in my language and for travelling with me in my progression, particularly during this 63rd General Service Conference. — *Roger Bédard*

Quebec (Southeast): I am proud to represent Area 88, identified in French as Québec-Sud-Est. Our region spreads over 1,280 kilometers in length. This territory is divided into 18 districts regrouping 192 weekly A.A. meetings. Area committee meets together three times a year plus the annual general meeting. Our three regional committee meetings take place at various locations throughout the region. In 2013, our area attended the CERAASA meeting held in February. Our area is well represented on the administrative board of our French bimonthly journal, *La Vigne*. We also take part to three inter-regional meetings, which put together the four Quebec Areas. This year, we will be the host area of a provincial gathering, which will be held in May in Rimouski. Our area organizes annually two gratitude dinners in order to raise funds and the total benefits are sent directly to G.S.O. Our area committee is basically formed of faithful trusted members, including the 18 D.C.M.s, a board of five elected members supported by service committee such as P.I. and C.P.C. committees, an Archives committee, *La Vigne* and a Web site committee. It is a real honor for me to represent our area and my full gratitude is given to the members that have granted me their trust in electing me as their delegate. — *Daniel Blanchard*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 has approximately 275 groups, a membership of about 3,300, and 20 districts. The districts are mostly rural with two urban centers. We hold one area committee

meeting and two area assemblies each year. The location changes each time to allow all districts the opportunity to host. Approximately 35–40 % of the groups are represented at each of our assemblies, with generally 100 % of the D.C.M.s being present. Area 91 has the following committees: Bridging the Gap, District Development/Remote Communities, Corrections and Archives. We also have an Area 91 Web site. DR/RC attempts to carry the message of general service to the far reaches of our area and assists when it can to help groups send their G.S.R.s to assemblies. Our Corrections contact is aided in his task by our Pink Can Fund providing the monies necessary to get A.A. literature into our federal and provincial correctional institutions. Because Area 91 stretches from the 49th parallel to the 60th parallel, we face challenges in both carrying the message and in the cultural and language barriers, particularly in the Northern end of our province. We have a great area committee in place to face these challenges. — *Kim Carswell*

Texas (Northeast): Area 65 stretches from Abilene to the Louisiana border; from Waco to the Red River border of Oklahoma. Ours is truly a diverse area with 29 districts, including five linguistic (Spanish) districts and 24 base districts. There are over 500 groups. Our area covers over 70,000 square miles and we have approximately 20,000 members. We hold three assemblies per year and three orientations at the beginning of each year. We also have four area committee meetings per year. Our Spring and Summer assemblies focus primarily on the General Service Conference. Our Spring assembly includes "Mock Committees" with everyone participating to discuss the upcoming Conference Agenda. Our Summer assembly is dedicated to the delegate's report on the Conference. Our ten standing committee chairpersons work with their committees to provide information and reports to the area's groups and districts, which include workshops, mini-conferences and presentations. Attendance at our assemblies average around 200. We continue to reach out to those districts that are dark and try to be of service in any way possible. The spirit of A.A. is alive and well in NETA. The Steps, the Traditions and the Concepts have been a guiding force in our area since Panel One. It's a privilege and honor to serve as Area 65 delegate and to be of service to Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. — *Mo Neal*

Texas (Southeast): Area 67 covers about 30,000 square miles, with Houston being the largest city. There are over 500 groups divided into 18 districts, five of which are Spanish-speaking. We hold three quarterly assemblies and a fourth during our annual convention in January. The area also has an annual Gratitude Dinner and a multilingual CFC Convention. The Texas State Convention is held in Houston once every six years. Communication has been a critical topic within our area assemblies. We continue to search for ways to be inclusive of everyone, especially our Spanish members, and want to help them increase their participation in general service. We utilize the following tools for communication: area Web mail, quarterly newsletter, area Web site, and written and translated reports. We are testing the use of Go-to-Meetings to enhance participation in our standing committees. Three years ago our area began supporting a local archives repository to maintain the records of our past experience. The cost is substantial and this past year there were many sharing sessions about the need to continue supporting this effort. A group conscience decision was reached at our January 2013 assembly to continue to support the archive repository. Our area took its inventory in 2012, indicating a need to grow in service sponsorship, study *The A.A. Service Manual*, and improve how we train new

G.S.R.s. Thank you for the opportunity to share about the Southeast Texas Area. — *Patrick Claymore*

Utah: Area 69 has over 330 active groups, divided into 11 geographic districts and one borderless, Spanish-speaking district. Our local service structure mirrors the General Service Conference using the committee system. We have nine committees: Agenda Assembly, Archives, Communications, C.P.C., Corrections, Grapevine, Literature, P.I., and Treatment. The committee system is used to spread the word of Alcoholic Anonymous that there is a way out and the committee system is used to collect the group conscience for the area. The Utah area hosts per year: three area assemblies, three workshops, and two committee meetings. At these events, groups and districts from all over the state are able to meet and help each other. Area 69 Web site has become a useful tool for the area. I found myself using the area Web site more than ever since I became the delegate. Although there are twelve districts, it is a rarity that all twelve are in attendance at the area events. Also, the overall attendance at the area events has declined. However, I believe that if the groups are reminded that their voices are needed in A.A., they will find a way to be there. — *Walter Curry*

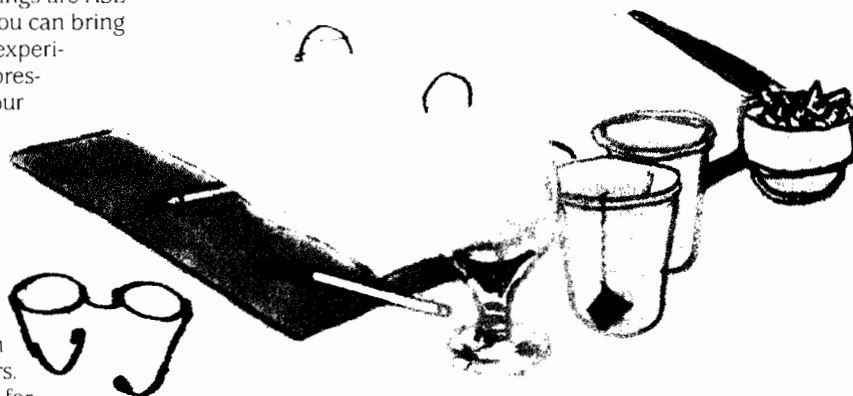
Virginia: One of our earliest groups dates back to June 1940, but it did not survive. One of its members who managed to stay sober reported that without any guidelines to follow, they sat around, played poker and "didn't drink anything but beer." Fortunately, Area 71 learned a sobering lesson from that example and has become the vibrant fellowship that we are today. We have approximately 1,200 active groups, including 18 Spanish-speaking and 101 Correctional facility groups. We also have 12 intergroups and 43 active districts. We hold two assemblies and two planning meetings each year, where each of our 11 standing committees meet before the general session to provide our membership information and gather an informed conscience from that committee. We also have seven Special Assignment coordinators, including a newsletter editor and a nonrotating archivist. Our newsletter is published three times per year. In addition to our yearly state convention, Area 71 hosts an annual Archives open-house, a combined P.I. and C.P.C. workshop, and a Corrections workshop. Area 71 groups and members continue to be self-supporting. I am blessed to serve Area 71 as its delegate and to be given another opportunity to give something back to Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Scott Gilkerson*

Washington (Western): Snuggled between the Oregon and Canadian border, the Cascade Mountains and Pacific Ocean you will find the 41 districts that make up Area 72. Two are Spanish districts, with a combined total of 24 meetings. We also have Russian and Korean language meetings. Some meetings are ASL interpreted, but we also have two meetings where you can bring your own speaking interpreter, or just come and experience silence and see our message conveyed via expressive faces and graceful hands. We are known for our rain and our coffee. No matter what the weather, every morning alcoholics are putting bottled water and espresso in their fanny packs and hiking to the top of a mountain to see the sun rise while attending the open-air A.A. meeting. We conduct business at one annual assembly and three quarterlies. Of our 1,400 listed groups, 415 were represented at our last assembly. In addition to standing committees, we've been served by overworked Archivists and Web masters. This year those duties have been lightened by the formation of separate chairpersons for the Standing Archives

Committee and our newly formed Standing Web Committee. A.A. is the best thing that ever happened to me and I am so happy and grateful that Area 72 chose me to serve as their 33rd delegate. — *Astri Torjussen*

West Virginia: Because Area 73 A.A. is small, our average meeting size is between 15 to 20 people, so it's hard to hide out. Every voice is essential — the experience, strength and hope provided by each member who shares at meetings, makes coffee, and stands to welcome the newcomer, helps to keep the doors open. Compared to other areas, we may be small in size and number, but the heart of West Virginia A.A. is as big as the Appalachian Mountains. With an area divided into 16 districts, seven regions and approximately 300 groups, we cherish the recovery provided by this program. Most of our meetings are wheelchair accessible, and we are reaching out to accommodate that segment of our population with hearing disabilities with a meeting that uses the Big Book in American Sign Language. Thanks to our friends in South Florida, that meeting now also has speaker DVDs in ASL. Area 73 has groups in Maryland, Pennsylvania, Virginia and Ohio also — it seems everyone wants to be a part of West "By God" Virginia! I'd like to invite you to the additional Regional Forum, August 16-18th. We need all of you — we need each other on this amazing journey. It is with loving gratitude that I am able to grow and to serve Area 73. Thank you for this privilege. — *Cathy Beckham*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 currently has 32 districts, including one Spanish linguistic district, over 1,000 registered groups and a membership of over 20,000. We support four all-day assemblies and an annual Spring Conference, where the delegate's report is shared. The Spring Conference is held by the district that earns the bid, which enables the conference to travel to different locations throughout the area. At our spring and summer assemblies the area holds a D.C.M. sharing session and a G.S.R. school. Area 75 voted by assembly actions to have the alternate area chair facilitate a "dark district" report at each assembly. Area 75 continues to partner with Area 74 to co-host a Corrections Workshop annually. Area 75's corrections chair continues to be invited to three "Re-Entry Fairs" within its borders and strives to connect with other correctional facilities. Our P.I., Treatment, and C.P.C. chairs are continuing to build relationships with the Veterans Administration Hospital medical staff. Our area's inventory is taken every other year at the fall assembly, which creates lively and spirited discussion and does result in positive change. For all the people that helped me in my time of need, I give back in service. — *Randy Rogness*



■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form, along with the comments and suggestions from the trustees' Conference Committee and agreed that the form was adequate and that no changes be made at this time.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and expressed satisfaction with the content.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed how local C.P.C. committees are utilizing new technologies to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous to professionals, and suggested adding information to the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook on:
 - Using PowerPoint and Webinars.
 - Providing electronic subscriptions to A.A. newsletters.
- The committee discussed ways of stimulating interest in C.P.C. service work and suggested:
 - Using mock C.P.C. presentations at service workshops.
 - Encouraging groups to elect C.P.C. chairs.
 - Bringing A.A. members along on C.P.C. presentations.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and suggested:
 - Adding an index of past issues of *About A.A.* to the publications tab.
 - Including a copy of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in each Kit.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections continue their thorough review of all Corrections materials.
- The committee discussed how to engage A.A. members in corrections service and shared about the opportunities to highlight the current available corrections literature through local area and district Web sites.
- In discussing difficulties in engaging A.A. members in corrections service, the committee recognized that some A.A. members who have not been incarcerated may feel they have nothing to offer in corrections service. The committee requested the staff secretary work with the Publishing Department and the trustees' Committee on Corrections to incorporate text in the Corrections Workbook section "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A." to reassure all A.A. members that they can participate in corrections service by sharing A.A.'s basic message about getting and staying sober.
- The committee discussed available resources in support of local corrections' Twelfth Step work and suggested:

- that the committee secretary gather sharing on ways that areas fund A.A. literature for incarcerated alcoholics for an article in *Box 4-5-9* and other service materials;
- that corrections committees be encouraged to use *La Viña* as a valuable resource for Spanish-speaking A.A. meetings and members inside correctional facilities.

- The committee reviewed a sample Letter of Introduction to Correctional Facilities, a sample Correctional Facility Fact Sheet, and a sample A.A. Program Plan for Correctional Facilities, and requested that all three samples—with suggested changes—be added to the Corrections Workbook at the next printing.
- The committee suggested that in cases when the Area Corrections Committee is inactive, communications from the G.S.O. Corrections assignment requesting prerelease contacts or outside support for correctional facility A.A. meetings be forwarded to the delegate.
- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook, and suggested that the service piece "Suggestions for Using the A.A. Grapevine Magazine (or *La Viña*) as a Tool in Corrections Service" be updated and considered for inclusion in the Workbook.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and felt an increase was not necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support packet and suggested adding the following words to the packaging sleeve: "Information from Self-Support packet also available on the Web site aa.org" and "Please Share with Your Group."
- The committee suggested adding the following phrase to the Self-Support Green Card (F-42): "Gratitude expressed through contributions reaches the still-suffering alcoholic."
- The committee thoroughly reviewed the report on self-support from the trustees' Finance Committee and urged that the work of the Self-Support subcommittee continue.
- The committee suggested that the appropriate committee reconsider the policy concerning the General Service Conference site selection ("The responsibility for General Service Conference site selection be delegated to General Service Office management, subject to approval of the General Service Board")* and that Conference members consider the spiritual and financial aspects.

*2008 Policy/Admissions Committee

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the 2013 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy and made the following requests:
 - That Grapevine communications regarding the Grapevine Audio Project specify that GV is not recording meeting speakers at A.A. events.
 - That an updated status and financial report on the project, including practices, financials, metrics and plans for the future, be provided to the 2014 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the results of the 2012 assessment of *La Viña* as a bimonthly, perfect bound, black and white, 68-page magazine and concluded:
 - The committee recognized that funding *La Viña* as a service, through the General Fund, is an issue affecting the overall Fellowship.

- The committee acknowledged the increase in circulation by 8.6% from January 2011 to December 2012 may be tied to the changes in format and additional content.
- The committee acknowledged that the 2012 increase in La Viña deficit results in large part from allocation of pension funding expense.
- The committee expressed concern that funding La Viña through the General Fund of the General Service Board, while A.A. Grapevine Inc. has responsibility for the production of La Viña, may suggest an imbalance between responsibility and authority.
- The committee requested that the GV board submit a proposal to the 2014 Conference Committee on the Grapevine that would significantly reduce the La Viña deficit.
- The committee considered discontinuing the requirement for the current format of the La Viña print magazine (i.e., 68 pages, perfect bound) and took no action. The committee needed more background regarding La Viña's financial history and information regarding what a new format would be.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2014 or later:
 1. Making Amends (working title)
Members share their experience about making Ninth Step amends from stories previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 2. How I Found My Higher Power (working title)
A collection of stories by AA members sharing their experience with their personal journeys with Step Two, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AA-Grapevine.org.
- The committee reviewed the revised workbook and approved the draft copy with the following suggestions:
 - Expand Appendix V to include all past Advisory Actions about the Grapevine.
 - Look into the feasibility of hyperlinks and a live table of contents to facilitate ease of navigation of the electronic workbook.
- The committee requested a report from the A.A. Grapevine Board on the feasibility of producing one book in American Sign Language (ASL) format.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums and attract first time attendees and suggested:
 - Using locally created "save the date" flyers to encourage attendance and participation.
 - Emphasizing that you do not have to be involved in General Service to attend a Regional Forum.
 - Making Regional Forums more prominent on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - Continuing to include information about Regional Forums in Box 4-5-9 on a regular basis.
 - Encouraging local host committees to include food, treats and A.A. meetings as part of the hospitality.
 - Providing additional service opportunities for local A.A. members at each Forum.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the draft pamphlet of "Circles of Love and Service" and offered additional suggestions for the trustees'

Literature Committee to consider. The committee looks forward to reviewing an updated draft pamphlet that includes their considerations at the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature meeting.

- The committee discussed a suggestion to add an index to *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action, noting that our Big Book is spiritual in nature rather than academic and that an index might discourage a full reading of the material.
- The committee thoroughly discussed a request to add the subtitle "None Left Behind" to the newly revised "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet and took no action. The committee agreed that this request was fully and appropriately addressed by both the Conference Committee on Literature and Conference members at the 62nd General Service Conference.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the report of the trustees' Committee on Conference regarding the role of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions in granting international observers admission to the General Service Conference. The committee agreed that no change to the current practice is necessary.
- The committee discussed the concept of combining the Conference Agenda and Conference Policy/Admissions Committees. The sense of the committee was that there was not enough information presented to express a need or benefit to combining the committees. In addition, the amount of time currently allotted for each committee's deliberation seems appropriate, and combining the committees might result in too heavy a workload for the combined committee. The committee was also dissuaded by the complications involved in merging the committees (revising the Composition, Scope and Procedures of committees; updating *The A.A. Service Manual* and other literature; additional responsibilities for staff, etc.).
- The committee noted a discrepancy between the description of the Conference Agenda Committee in *The A.A. Service Manual* and in the Conference Agenda Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, and suggested that the 2014 Conference Agenda Committee review the description in *The A.A. Service Manual* for consistency.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2012 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and requested that as soon as possible, and independent from the Web site redesign, A.A.W.S. insure that A.A. videos on aa.org be accessible on as wide a variety of electronic devices as possible.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on A.A. Video Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s).
- The committee considered production of one or more video P.S.A.s to be produced in the calendar year 2013 using the current five "Young People's Videos" and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee define more specifically the target audience, the cost, the method of distribution appropriate to the targeted audience, and any format issues, and bring back a report to the 2014 Conference Public Information Committee.
- The committee reviewed all current A.A. video public service announcements and found them all to be relevant and useful, noting that "Living in Chaos," which the trustees' committee had suggested for retirement, continues to effectively portray the consequences of alcoholic drinking.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee reviewed the interim report on the centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of "Tengo Esperanza," the video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community. The committee noted the strong performance of this P.S.A. thus far, and looks forward to receiving the final report next year.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on establishing a Public Information Social Media Page and agrees with the trustees' conclusion that A.A. World Services, the General Service Office, and the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña cannot establish a presence on Facebook in a manner which would be consistent with A.A. Traditions.
- The committee suggested the General Service Board encourage the trustees' committees to review existing literature that discusses how A.A. members apply the Eleventh Tradition, e.g., "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," and suggest updates to the literature that reflect current experience with anonymity in a digital age, with an eye towards reaffirming the importance of the Eleventh Tradition to the Fellowship.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook and suggested that:
 - The address of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, www.aa.org, be added to the front of the new P.I. Kit packaging.
 - The pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be included in the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2013-2014 Edition, and the 2013 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions. The committee noted that one of the editorial updates regarded the description of a Conference Committee, and asked that a review of the descriptions of all Conference Committees for consistency with current Composition, Scope and Procedures be made, and any suggested editorial updates be included in the annual list to be forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee also requested that a similar review of the list in Chapter Eleven of services provided by G.S.O. be made, and any suggested editorial updates be included in that list as well.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered a request to add "Advisory Action" and "Additional Committee Consideration" to the Glossary of General Service Terms in *The A.A. Service Manual*, and forwarded suggestions to the Publishing Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee considered a request that "the definition and Composition of an Area Assembly be modified for consistency and clarity in Chapter Four" and took no action. The committee believes the existing descriptions of Area assemblies accurately reflect the variety of autonomous practices determined by each Area's group conscience.
- The committee considered a request to revise the description of "Director (nontrustee)" in the Glossary of General Service Terms in

The A.A. Service Manual, and agreed to forward this suggestion to the General Service Board for consideration as part of the annual review of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered a request to update information in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding suggested qualifications for area registrars, and forwarded suggestions to the Publishing Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee also suggested that G.S.O. develop a new piece of service material outlining the specific abilities and resources area registrars have found helpful in assisting with the maintenance of vital information in the Fellowship New Vision database.
- In light of the recent decision not to publish regional directories this year, the committee asked the staff secretary to communicate their concerns to the A.A.W.S. Board about the still existing, albeit decreasing, need for print resources by A.A. members in rural and remote areas, and those members who may travel frequently.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed the report on Spanish and French translations of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* and expressed the need for translated versions of audio visual materials to have improved sound production in the future.
- The committee reviewed the report on the DVD version of the pamphlet "A.A. For the Alcoholic with Special Needs" formatted for alcoholics who are blind, deaf or learning challenged and expressed appreciation for the availability of the item. There was a concern expressed whether a DVD in American Sign Language (ASL) and with subtitles in English serves the needs of French and Spanish language-based members.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook contents and its current content.
- The committee reviewed the contents of Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook and Kit and requested the following:
 - That the staff secretary produce a memo with the following wording suggested by the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities: "Committees gather local information and identify outside local resources regarding accessibility requirements and options." This memo is to be a temporary insert in the section, "Activities Suggested for Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees," of the current Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook until the next printing of the workbook. The memo will be sent to area, district, and intergroup/central office Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities chairs.
 - Add the service piece, "Online Meetings/Reunions a L'Internet/Reunions del Internet" (SM F-124), to the Special Needs-Accessibilities Kit.
- The committee had a wide-ranging discussion on how Special Needs-Accessibilities committees can communicate the various ways to make meeting places accessible to all alcoholics. Topics included:
 - Start Special Needs-Accessibilities committees and hold workshops on various topics to inform members about this service area.
 - Communicate in web-based and print meeting directories which meetings are handicapped equipped, wheelchair accessible, and ASL interpreted.
 - Consider ensuring that the entire meeting experience for those with special needs is accessible-friendly, e.g. assuring that the height of literature displays or coffee dispensers are accessible to those in wheelchairs.
 - Prepare meeting greeters to identify attendees with spe-

cial needs and to help provide accommodation as best as possible.

- Provide local special needs contact information in meeting formats and event flyers.
- The committee also discussed ways that Special Needs-Accessibilities committees might help groups prepare in advance for the arrival of deaf/hard of hearing alcoholics. Topics included:
 - Provide optimal seating arrangements.
 - Use a microphone, discourage cross-talk, and ask those speaking to stand and avoid covering their faces with hand gestures.
 - When economically possible, provide ASL interpreters or seek out capable A.A. members who can sign; some areas fund ASL interpreters.
 - Communicate with the hard of hearing in attendance that seating and other accommodations can be made.
 - Encourage cooperation with local professionals serving the deaf/hard of hearing community.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and updated the references to the trustees' committees on "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities" and "Correctional Facilities" found in their Scope to trustees' committees on "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities" and "Corrections."
- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the East Central and Southeast regional trustees and trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee reviewed the General Service Board's proposed plan regarding the slate of directors for the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board and took no action. The committee did not support the proposed interlocking directorate.
- The committee noted that the General Service Board has sufficient authority to implement changes in Practices as outlined in the initiatives in the sections under the heading "Communications and Unity" and "Efficient Operations and Financial Stability" and expressed their support for those ongoing changes. It was the sense of the committee that the changes in Practices could address the concerns of the General Service Board.
- The committee requested that, before implementation, any changes proposed in the section "Governance," regarding "Non-trustee Director Service," "Eligibility of General Service Trustees" and "Eligibility of Appointed Committee Members" be brought to the Conference Committee on Trustees for review.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the second paragraph on the inside front flap of the dust jacket which currently states:

At the time of the third edition, in March 1976, the worldwide membership of A.A. was estimated at 1,000,000 or more. Copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in circulation exceeded 1,450,000. In 1995, the General Service Conference approved the recommendation: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Doctor Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is."

Be replaced with the following language:

At the time of the third edition, in March 1976, the worldwide membership of A.A. was estimated at 1,000,000 or more. Copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in circulation exceeded 1,450,000. The basic text (pages 1 through 164) remains largely unchanged. This is the A.A. message, just as it was introduced in the 1939 edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the book that gave the young fellowship its name.

NOTE: This change will also be made to all formats of the dust jacket of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- The committee recommended that "Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers" be added to the open meeting side of the Primary Purpose (Blue) Card (F-17) in all three languages when the inventory of the English version is depleted.

The statement will read as follows:

"This Is An Open Meeting Of Alcoholics Anonymous"

"This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here – especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that 'The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking,' we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol. **Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers.** (Bold text reflects addition)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that the alternate chair of a primary committee be eligible to serve as chair of a secondary committee only if there are no other available candidates.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- The General Service Board develop a process in which the Conference can be participants in the development of its own agenda to include agenda items and present the process to the 64th General Service Conference. **(Not approved)**
- The General Service Board's proposed plan of an interlocking directorate serving the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine, shall be continued in scope and procedure as proposed to the General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- To discontinue the current formatting requirements for the La Viña print magazine (i.e., 68 pages, perfect bound), in order to return the responsibility for formatting La Viña to the A.A. Grapevine Board and management. **(Not approved)**
- The commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition of the First Edition, first printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be published in April 2014 in Spanish and French. **(Not approved)**
- Propose that the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous develop, implement, and maintain a nationwide online, searchable meeting list and locator. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That any vote on reorganizing our General Service Board and two service corporations be decided by 3/4 rather than 2/3 substantial unity vote as this is a matter of vital importance. **(Not approved)**

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
December 31, 2012 (with comparative totals for 2011)**

	General Service Board of A.A.								
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2012	Consolidated 2011
ASSETS									
Cash	\$ 877,321	\$ 1,156,952		\$ 126,274		\$ 408,643	\$ 306,898	\$ 2,876,088	\$ 3,303,157
Accounts and interest receivable		16,563				248,796	75,506	340,865	303,283
Intercompany balances	(1,040,958)	(1,934,600)				1,039,344	1,936,214	-	-
Inventories									
Books, pamphlets, etc.						1,504,985	260,139	1,765,124	1,718,348
Paper, prepublication costs, etc.						174,507	45,226	219,733	230,343
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		16,114,838		1,943,526				18,058,364	17,173,106
Property, Equipment and Software (net of accumulated depreciation and amortization of 2012 - \$4,699,143; 2011 - \$4,368,394) (Note 2)			\$ 600,609			497,024	43,173	1,140,806	1,177,078
Deferred charges and deposits	28,142					99,522	86,637	214,301	162,858
Prepaid conventions	195,469							195,469	171,844
Total Assets	<u>59,974</u>	<u>15,353,753</u>	<u>600,609</u>	<u>2,069,800</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>3,972,821</u>	<u>2,753,793</u>	<u>24,810,750</u>	<u>24,240,017</u>
LIABILITIES									
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ -					\$ 326,214	\$ 92,156	\$ 418,370	\$ 537,098
Deferred income - orders and subscriptions, etc.	2,961					31,705	2,034,109	2,068,775	2,059,695
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 5,937,994				5,937,994	5,524,123
Accrued pension benefits					\$ 10,368,723			10,368,723	10,293,757
Total Liabilities	<u>2,961</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>5,937,994</u>	<u>10,368,723</u>	<u>357,919</u>	<u>2,126,265</u>	<u>18,793,862</u>	<u>18,414,673</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>15,353,753</u>	<u>600,609</u>	<u>(3,868,194)</u>	<u>(10,368,723)</u>	<u>3,614,902</u>	<u>627,528</u>	<u>6,016,888</u>	<u>5,825,344</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>59,974</u>	<u>15,353,753</u>	<u>600,609</u>	<u>2,069,800</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>3,972,821</u>	<u>2,753,793</u>	<u>24,810,750</u>	<u>24,240,017</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2012 (with comparative totals for 2011)

	General Service Board of A.A.					A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2012	Consolidated 2011
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	Grapevine	La Viña	
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE									
Gross Sales						\$12,620,075	\$3,048,220	\$123,479	\$15,791,774
Less: Discounts						255,317	-	-	255,317
Net Sales						12,364,758	3,048,220	123,479	15,536,457
Cost of Literature Distributed									
Printing						(2,946,066)	(420,702)	(35,224)	(3,401,992)
Royalties on books						(27,161)	-	-	(27,161)
Direct shipping and warehousing						(1,513,607)	(678,603)	(22,790)	(2,215,000)
Gross Profit from Literature						7,877,924	1,948,915	65,465	9,889,938
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$6,557,608								6,557,608
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	74	\$ 56,832		\$ 196,284		392	14,800	-	268,382
Total Income	6,557,682	56,832		196,284		7,878,316	1,963,715	65,465	16,718,294
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)									
Program	5,617,814			-		2,869,470	1,128,256	181,285	9,796,825
Supporting services	3,636,318		\$117,363	162,871	\$ (218,803)	2,159,951	578,456	-	6,436,156
Total Expenses	9,254,132	-	117,363	162,871	(218,803)	5,029,421	1,706,712	181,285	16,232,981
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,696,450)	56,832	(117,363)	33,413	218,803	2,848,895	257,003	(115,820)	684,014
Change in pension liability - nonoperating	-	-	-	-	(293,769)	-	-	-	(293,769)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS									
GSB La Viña support	(115,820)	-	-	-	-		-	115,820	-
Other transfers	2,812,270	800,000	92,374	-		3,704,644	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	856,832	(24,989)	33,413	(74,966)	(855,749)	257,003	-	(4,545,758)
NET ASSETS									
Beginning of year	57,013	14,496,921	625,598	(3,901,607)	(10,293,757)	4,470,651	370,525	-	5,825,344
NET ASSETS									
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	15,353,753	600,609	(3,868,194)	(10,368,723)	3,614,902	627,528	-	5,825,344

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2012 (with comparative totals for 2011)

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña	Supporting Services	2012 Total	2011 Total
OPERATING EXPENSES											
Salaries	\$ 794,532	\$ 947,841	\$ 181,285	\$ 6,197	\$185,092	\$1,248,160	\$ 455,651	\$ 116,886	\$2,431,743	\$ 6,367,387	\$ 6,245,171
Payroll taxes	57,191	71,886	12,612		13,153	102,894	34,334	9,876	176,619	478,565	476,492
Health and group insurance	115,713	145,441	25,518		26,612	208,183	69,078	9,290	577,953	1,177,788	1,166,533
Retirement expense - funding	265,398	333,584	58,527		61,038	477,484	100,589	29,400	785,999	2,112,019	1,975,581
Other program printing	217,403	69,791	68,917	6,260	9,055					371,426	398,300
Mailing labor	94,090	7,284	1,255		2,339					104,968	108,153
Postage and express	211,766	46,016	40,368		26,628	9,715	6,981		31,794	373,268	417,223
Writers' fees	24,805	18,750	8,450	1,200	4,891					58,096	56,758
Foreign literature assistance		56,004								56,004	41,692
Selling expenses	555					346,303	136,327	4,386	69,664	557,235	406,297
Professional fees								140	219,934	220,074	237,328
Contracted services	70,472	163,234	38,436	32,904	24,134	156,275	152,144	8,640	703,937	1,350,176	1,032,292
Occupancy	103,776	134,380	10,422		2,979	186,369	39,726		362,614	840,266	906,892
Telephone	15,975	13,743	2,705		1,427	12,884	17,177		65,285	129,196	160,887
Equipment maintenance	1,980	7,090	23		23	13,309			68,324	90,749	96,251
Depreciation and amortization	36,140	17,686	2,108		5,497	90,196			51,118	202,745	172,432
Stationery and office supplies	82,564	5,250	12,222	4,739	2,624	700	58,125		51,863	218,087	207,271
Office service and expense	8,031	11,358	20,361	11,073	17,037	12,197	58,124	960	230,325	369,466	369,506
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,127	13,654	519,859	258,452	83,373	4,801		1,707	519,507	1,402,480	1,131,167
Bad debts									17,820	17,820	7,239
Delegate fees			(228,168)	(108,323)						(336,491)	(243,604)
Total Operating Expenses	<u>2,101,518</u>	<u>2,062,992</u>	<u>774,900</u>	<u>212,502</u>	<u>465,902</u>	<u>2,869,470</u>	<u>1,128,256</u>	<u>181,285</u>	<u>6,364,499</u>	<u>16,161,324</u>	<u>15,369,861</u>
Severance benefits									10,226	10,226	38,424
Postretirement health benefits									162,871	162,871	995,979
Retirement expense adjustment									(218,803)	(218,803)	(866,414)
Capital projects depreciation									117,363	117,363	89,371
Total Expenses	<u>2,101,518</u>	<u>2,062,992</u>	<u>774,900</u>	<u>212,502</u>	<u>465,902</u>	<u>2,869,470</u>	<u>1,128,256</u>	<u>181,285</u>	<u>6,436,156</u>	<u>16,232,981</u>	<u>15,627,221</u>
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>1,383,258</u>	<u>1,357,899</u>	<u>510,054</u>	<u>139,873</u>	<u>306,665</u>	<u>2,159,951</u>	<u>578,456</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(6,436,156)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	<u>3,484,776</u>	<u>3,420,891</u>	<u>1,284,954</u>	<u>352,375</u>	<u>772,567</u>	<u>5,029,421</u>	<u>1,706,712</u>	<u>181,285</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>16,232,981</u>	<u>15,627,221</u>
Services	\$3,484,776	\$3,420,891	\$1,284,954	\$352,375	\$772,567					\$ 9,315,563	\$ 8,966,075
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	5,029,421				5,029,421	4,661,348
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,706,712	\$181,285		\$1,887,997	\$1,999,798
										<u>16,232,981</u>	<u>15,627,221</u>
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2011	<u>\$3,413,803</u>	<u>\$3,415,297</u>	<u>\$1,489,924</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>\$647,051</u>	<u>\$4,661,348</u>	<u>\$1,859,347</u>	<u>\$ 140,451</u>		<u>\$15,627,221</u>	<u>\$14,691,792</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2012
 (with comparative totals for 2011)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2012</u>	<u>2011</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 191,544	\$(4,545,758)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(94,489)	68,031
Amortization of bond premiums	5,570	6,973
Depreciation and amortization	343,188	267,573
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(37,582)	19,783
Inventories	(36,166)	100,812
Deferred charges and other assets	(75,068)	(65,041)
Accounts and accruals payable	(118,728)	(305,496)
Deferred income	9,080	119,452
Postretirement health benefits obligation	413,871	1,246,978
Accrued pension benefits	74,966	4,363,358
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided by Operating Activities</u>	<u>676,186</u>	<u>1,276,665</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(306,916)	(354,676)
Proceeds from sales of investments	5,525,267	6,020,183
Purchases of investments	(6,321,606)	(9,534,976)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used) by Investing Activities</u>	<u>(1,103,255)</u>	<u>(3,869,469)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	(427,069)	(2,592,804)
Cash, beginning of year	<u>3,303,157</u>	<u>5,895,961</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>2,876,088</u></u>	<u><u>3,303,157</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

■ Report of the Independent Auditor

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT

April 1, 2013

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2012 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

Management's Responsibility for the Financial Statements

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of these financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America; this includes the design, implementation, and maintenance of internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

Auditor's Responsibility

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit. We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement.

An audit involves performing procedures to obtain audit evidence about the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. The procedures selected depend on the auditor's judgement, including the assessment of the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error. In making those risk assessments, the auditor considers internal control relevant to the entity's preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the entity's internal control. Accordingly, we express no such opinion. An audit also includes evaluating the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of significant accounting estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall presentation of the financial statements.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2011 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 21, 2012, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

Opinion

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2012 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Other Matter

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming an opinion on the financial statements as a whole. The consolidating information presented in the consolidated statement of financial position is presented for purposes of additional analyses and is not a required part of the financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and was derived from and relates directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the financial statements. The information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the financial statements and certain additional procedures, including comparing and reconciling such information directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the financial statements or to the financial statements themselves, and other additional procedures in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. In our opinion, the information is fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the financial statements as a whole.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2012

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. bylaws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the

regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$1,561,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND — A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been charged based on the actual lease cost; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2012 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$3,122,741	\$117,363	\$2,522,132
Furniture	8 Years	741,260	4,405	734,784
Computers	3 to 5 Years	549,987	75,043	474,220
Software	5 Years	1,425,961	146,377	968,007
		<u>5,839,949</u>	<u>343,188</u>	<u>4,699,143</u>

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Corporations follow Accounting Standards Codification 820, Fair Value Measurements. It establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 — Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 — Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 — Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Corporations at December 31, 2012 and 2011 have been valued at either Level 1 or Level 2.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity and certificates of deposit.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2012, investments were comprised as follows:

	Cost	Fair Value	Level 1	Level 2
Reserve Fund				
Certificate of deposits	\$8,564,090	\$8,564,090	8,564,090	\$ -
U.S. Treasury	7,477,198	7,550,748	7,550,748	-
Totals	<u>16,041,288</u>	<u>16,114,838</u>		
Postretirement Medical Fund				
Bond funds	639,212	649,097	-	649,097
Equity funds				
Small Cap Index	93,684	106,180	-	106,180
Mid Cap Index	91,113	104,080	-	104,080
S&P 500 Index	724,456	838,370	-	838,370
International Index	251,876	245,799	-	245,799
	<u>1,800,341</u>	<u>1,943,526</u>		
Totals	<u>17,841,629</u>	<u>18,058,364</u>	<u>16,114,838</u>	<u>1,943,526</u>

Investment income for 2012 and 2011 is comprised of the following:

	2012	2011
Interest and dividends	\$ 199,576	\$ 248,781
Realized gains	9,399	27,130
Change in unrealized appreciation	85,090	(95,161)
Investment expenses	(25,683)	(23,907)
	<u>268,382</u>	<u>156,843</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services." Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including staff services, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French- and Spanish-speaking groups in North America.

Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which cannot be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates cannot be determined.

Subsequent Events: In connection with the preparation of these consolidated financial statements, Management evaluated subsequent events after the balance sheet date of December 31, 2012 through April 1, 2013 which was the date the financial statements were able to be issued.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset cannot reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with ASC 715 which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, ASC 715 requires an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under ASC 715 is recorded as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2012:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 19,505,597
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	29,874,320
Funded status	<u>(10,368,723)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 10,368,723</u>
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$ 26,083,387
Benefit cost	1,593,447
Employers' contributions	1,812,250
Benefits paid	1,014,838

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 1,812,250
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(218,803)
	<u>1,593,447</u>

Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine benefits obligations at December 31, 2012:

Discount rate	3.88%
Salary increases	3.5%
Expected long-term return on assets	8.0%

Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine net periodic pension cost for year ended December 31, 2012:

Discount rate	4.5%
Salary increases	4.5%
Expected long-term return on assets	8.0%

The expected rate of return on plan assets is determined by those assets' historical long-term investment performance, current asset allocation, and estimates of future long-term returns by asset class.

The fair value of plan assets at December 31, 2012 were composed as follows:

	Total	Level 1	Level 2
Cash and equivalents	\$ 1,018,296	\$1,018,296	\$ -
Domestic equity mutual funds	9,984,189	-	9,984,189
International equity mutual fund	2,379,112		2,379,112
Bond mutual funds	6,124,000		6,124,000
Totals	<u>\$19,505,597</u>	<u>\$1,018,296</u>	<u>\$18,487,301</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2013	\$ 1,362,813
2014	1,379,610
2015	1,468,702
2016	1,510,405
2017	1,524,940
2018 - 2022	8,087,482

The employers' contributions for 2013 are expected to be \$2,100,000.

Effective January 1, 2013, the Corporations implemented a "soft freeze" of the defined benefit pension plan. Employees in the plan as of December 31, 2012 will continue to accrue benefits; however, employees hired after that date will participate instead in a new defined contribution plan.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2012, A.A.W.S. as fiscal agent for the G.S.B. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) for office space at 475 Riverside Drive in New York City:

\$775,450 annual leases effective January 1, 2009 through December 31, 2018 for space on the 10th and 11th floors;

\$46,264 annual lease effective January 1, 2012 through November 30, 2014 for space on the 12th floor.

Future minimum rental payments due under the leases are as follows:

2013	\$ 821,714
2014	817,859
2015	775,450
2016	775,450
2017 and subsequent	1,550,900
	<u>\$4,741,373</u>



The space on the 10th floor is subleased at \$121,255 per year from February 15, 2012 through December 31, 2015 to an unaffiliated not-for-profit organization. The above lease expense will be offset by payments due under the sublease as follows:

2013	\$121,255
2014	121,255
2015	121,255
	<u>\$363,765</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 3.88% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B at December 31, 2012. The discount rate was 4.5% at December 31, 2011.

Prior to 2006 the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years. As of De-

cember 31, 2012, the Fund's assets were equal to 34.9% of the benefit obligation.

The following table sets forth information regarding the Plan for 2012:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$5,937,994
Benefits paid	\$ 209,272
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 623,143</u>

Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities	\$ 460,272
Postretirement Medical Fund	\$ 162,871
	<u>\$623,143</u>

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2013	\$ 221,828
2014	235,138
2015	249,246
2016	264,201
2017	280,053
2017 - 2022	1,673,404

Note 6 Tax Status: The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Management has determined that the Corporations had no uncertain tax positions that would require financial statement recognition. The Corporations are no longer subject to audits by the applicable taxing jurisdictions for the periods prior to 2009.

The General Service Office 2013 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2012 Budget	2012 Actual	2013 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$13,000,000	\$12,620,075	\$12,800,000
Discounts Allowed	285,000	255,317	260,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	12,715,000	12,364,758	12,540,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,115,117	2,946,066	3,100,000
Royalties	28,000	27,161	28,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	9,571,883	9,391,531	9,412,000
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,652,400	1,513,607	1,629,200
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	7,919,483	7,877,924	7,782,800
Contributions Received	6,528,000	6,557,608	6,697,000
Interest Income	750	466	750
<u>Total Revenue</u>	14,448,233	14,435,998	14,480,550
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	5,574,000	5,576,785	5,915,000
Payroll taxes	409,500	416,238	435,000
Insurance	1,067,100	1,031,285	1,148,200
Retirement expense	1,901,000	1,931,569	2,234,000
Other program printing	464,900	371,426	389,900
Mailing, labor, etc.	124,500	104,969	124,500
Postage & express	434,500	366,286	439,000
Writers' fees	65,350	58,096	42,500
Other literature assistance	50,000	56,004	90,000
Selling expenses	333,000	416,522	298,900
Professional fees	212,500	162,906	209,500
Contracted services	1,160,300	1,189,391	991,300
Occupancy	767,000	780,572	800,500
Telephone	88,900	104,797	107,825
Equipment maintenance	75,465	61,306	70,215
Furniture & equipment	181,600	194,259	217,900
Stationery & office expense	167,100	159,963	162,500
Office service & expense	300,175	286,735	314,950
Travel, meals, & accommodations	953,450	1,011,929	1,090,100
Bad debts	10,000	2,515	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	14,340,340	14,283,553	15,091,790
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>\$107,893</u>	<u>\$152,445</u>	<u>(\$611,240)</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2013 BUDGET

	GRAPEVINE			LA VIÑA		
	2012 Budget	2012 Actual	2013 Budget	2012 Budget	2012 Actual	2013 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF PRINT COPIES	86,929	83,263	78,760	8,982	9,157	9,200
Online Circulation	4,324	5,535	4,653			
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$2,107,159	\$2,163,553	\$2,041,459	\$97,930	\$96,482	\$96,648
Single copies and back issues	38,659	31,909	32,049	8,428	10,540	10,185
Digital Magazine Subscriptions				205	247	
GV Online	157,750	147,448	126,748			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	2,303,568	2,342,910	2,200,256	106,563	107,269	106,833
<u>Total direct costs</u>	826,475	817,663	815,296	47,085	52,928	53,204
Gross Profit on Magazine	1,477,093	1,525,247	1,384,960	59,478	54,341	53,629
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	602,500	705,310	704,320	16,067	16,210	16,210
<u>Total direct costs</u>	227,606	281,642	269,421	3,174	5,086	5,086
Gross Profit on Special Items	374,894	423,668	434,899	12,893	11,124	11,124
Total Gross Profit	1,851,987	1,948,915	1,819,859	72,371	65,465	64,753
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	369,200	347,944	393,008	69,120	81,523	79,120
Payroll taxes and benefits	141,325	136,359	155,781	33,458	31,343	36,323
Occupancy costs	56,864	43,450	46,821			
Office supplies and expenses	22,963	25,697	25,379	392	962	242
Product development & Web	75,000	51,639	75,000			
<u>Total Editorial</u>	665,352	605,089	695,989	102,970	113,828	115,685
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	354,165	364,789	360,189	40,400	35,361	41,012
Payroll taxes and benefits	241,664	204,356	216,073	19,405	17,223	20,362
Fulfillment	111,850	100,505	99,016	8,739	8,640	8,640
Occupancy costs	50,625	40,643	43,912			
Office supplies and expenses	76,326	90,552	92,002			
Selling expense-regular	136,000	90,061	95,000	3,976	4,386	4,386
- GvR program	14,000	7,248	7,000			
Postage	4,000	6,981	7,565	50		
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	988,630	905,135	920,757	72,570	65,610	74,400
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Employee's Severance		10,226				
Computer Consulting	25,824	29,442	30,000			
Insurance	4,900	6,756	6,682			
Professional fees	60,000	57,029	60,000			
Meetings and conferences	54,200	52,353	64,970	2,500	1,707	1,707
Furniture and equipment	15,000	8,485	15,000			
Canadian exchange and other	4,000	1,948	4,000		140	140
Bank service charges	14,000	14,944	14,807			
Bad debts	12,000	15,305	12,000			
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	189,924	196,488	207,459	2,500	1,847	1,847
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,843,906	1,706,712	1,824,205	178,040	181,285	191,932
Add: Interest earned	26,000	14,800	16,300			
Support from GSB General Fund				105,669	115,820	127,179
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	\$34,081	\$257,003	\$11,954	\$0	\$0	\$0

2012 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	443	208	470%	43,879	8,832	4.96	826	3,000	411		48,115.47	5.45
2.	Alaska	188	94	50.0	18,382	3,142	5.85	1,127		325		19,833.22	6.31
3.	Arizona	1,137	450	39.5	108,118	25,696	4.21	7,873	3,500	9,848	558	129,896.91	5.06
4.	Arkansas	259	129	49.7	26,257	4,509	5.81	505		1,653	151	28,565.32	6.34
California													
5.	Southern	1,302	396	30.3	106,368	47,431	2.23	12,209	132	423	704	119,835.34	2.53
6.	N. Coastal	1,951	1,117	57.2	277,522	58,823	4.72	26,281	6,967	9,417	266	320,451.59	5.45
7.	N. Interior	994	450	45.2	81,209	28,773	2.82	8,150	10	5,916	337	95,620.98	3.32
8.	San Diego/Imp.	1,004	403	40.0	74,100	28,188	2.63	4,051		4,760	159	83,069.98	2.95
9.	Mid-South	1,970	795	40.4	168,963	60,151	2.81	6,199		3,265	708	179,134.74	2.98
10.	Colorado	847	431	50.9	106,556	19,479	5.46	10,560	50	8,681	111	125,957.36	6.47
11.	Connecticut	1,609	598	37.1	117,806	36,925	3.19	12,001	2,175	22,633	771	155,386.00	4.21
12.	Delaware	244	119	48.7	34,921	3,701	9.44	490		250		35,661.26	9.64
13.	D.C.	494	213	43.0	54,996	14,885	3.69	3,134		2,880		61,010.02	4.10
Florida													
14.	North	909	432	47.4	95,542	19,178	4.97	7,804	6,025	12,401	40	121,811.98	6.35
15.	South/	1,974	907	45.9	170,576	40,737	4.19	19,646	3,820	83,207	165	277,413.93	6.81
16.	Georgia	754	478	63.4	100,778	18,315	5.50	8,305	175	2,694	92	112,043.41	6.12
17.	Hawaii	321	162	50.4	32,783	5,428	6.03	3,551		497	90	36,920.91	6.80
18.	Idaho	257	106	41.2	19,691	4,765	4.12	580		2,320	61	22,652.83	4.75
Illinois													
19.	Chicago	1,350	338	25.0	80,938	29,430	2.74	5,699	660	6,201	155	93,653.35	3.18
20.	North	1,193	462	38.7	64,188	22,760	2.81	5,001		8,901		78,089.25	3.43
21.	South	438	163	37.1	24,551	7,967	3.07	152	167	1,915		26,784.86	3.36
Indiana													
22.	North	680	265	39.0	39,342	10,071	3.91	3,962	1,000	2,982		47,287.22	4.70
23.	South	712	306	43.0	40,496	12,833	3.16	677		621	187	41,981.03	3.27
24.	Iowa	688	295	42.9	52,317	13,904	3.75	1,330		240		53,886.86	3.88
25.	Kansas	390	169	43.3	30,173	9,696	3.10	1,615	200			31,988.18	3.30
26.	Kentucky	681	321	47.0	74,755	11,218	6.66	6,969	2,015	10,238	139	94,116.17	8.39
27.	Louisiana	566	189	33.3	46,161	11,158	4.13	2,046	160	539		48,905.66	4.38
28.	Maine	545	171	31.3	25,972	8,754	2.96	2,503		9,151	600	38,250.25	4.37
29.	Maryland	1,054	409	38.7	85,506	16,566	5.15	3,989	50	1,984		91,528.62	5.53
Massachusetts													
30.	East	1,458	550	37.6	128,703	46,697	2.75	12,752	5,095	5,306		151,856.35	3.25
31.	West	316	152	48.0	20,980	5,660	3.70	840			16	21,835.49	3.86
Michigan													
32.	Central	684	255	37.2	33,052	14,798	2.23	6,869		614	44	40,579.59	2.74
33.	Southeast	946	279	29.4	47,374	21,343	2.22	1,649	123	15	50	49,211.58	2.31
34.	West	647	226	34.8	41,381	12,809	3.22	1,359		3,252		45,991.99	3.59
Minnesota													
35.	North	588	271	46.1	34,621	8,844	3.90	713		525		35,858.14	4.05
36.	South	1,126	453	40.2	95,206	26,804	3.55	1,359	60	12,947	200	109,772.30	4.10
37.	Mississippi	227	102	44.9	22,332	4,577	4.88	1,037				23,368.70	5.11
Missouri													
38.	East	571	258	45.1	54,459	9,072	6.00	1,642		5,478	344	61,922.59	6.83
39.	West	258	122	47.2	22,125	7,480	2.96	165	85	523		22,897.36	3.06
40.	Montana	286	127	44.3	25,652	5,795	4.43	3,477		516		29,644.23	5.12
41.	Nebraska	714	277	38.7	48,961	16,039	3.04	1,013		1,382	123	51,478.91	3.21
42.	Nevada	609	206	33.8	37,233	14,066	2.63	2,572	100	1,742		41,646.67	2.96
43.	New Hampshire	625	284	45.4	36,033	11,060	3.26	1,887		3,850		41,770.01	3.78
New Jersey													
44.	North	1,360	547	40.2	130,074	33,381	3.89	10,703	500	5,242	1,261	147,779.25	4.43
45.	South	555	251	45.2	59,792	9,289	6.44	3,709		3,066	358	66,925.35	7.20
46.	New Mexico	375	165	49.2	33,217	7,296	4.54	3,350	46	1,222	106	37,940.57	5.20
New York													
47.	Central	769	278	36.1	47,831	11,072	4.31	3,718	227	2,003		53,777.91	4.86
48.	H.M./B.	746	303	40.6	28,861	10,856	2.66	913		20,296		50,069.59	4.61
49.	Southeast	1,770	729	41.1	245,789	56,952	4.32	13,260	520	6,659	535	266,763.24	4.68
50.	West	371	94	25.2	17,822	5,948	2.99	322	150	500		18,793.95	3.16
51.	N. Carolina	1,122	566	50.3	141,142	19,294	7.31	14,806	5,600	7,962		169,509.12	8.79
52.	North Dakota	162	79	48.7	14,981	3,258	4.59	84		2,317		17,381.53	5.34
Ohio													
53.	Cent. & S.E.	826	231	28.0	28,165	10,746	2.62	2,693		102		30,960.14	2.88
54.	Northeast	1,534	350	22.8	40,929	19,436	2.10	1,780	25	1,917	519	45,170.34	2.32
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	311	78	25.0	9,194	4,406	2.08	86		1,100		10,380.46	2.36
56.	S.W. Ohio	546	256	46.8	44,426	9,929	4.46	3,631		3,800		51,856.58	5.22
57.	Oklahoma	407	200	49.0	37,774	9,053	4.16	510	50	1,000		39,333.89	4.34
58.	Oregon	1,142	416	36.4	74,199	22,013	3.36	2,709	27	2,736	20	79,690.96	3.62

Pennsylvania													
59	East	1,595	773	48.5	166,522	32,644	5.09	9,247	2,000	9,400		187,168.96	5.73
60	West	918	378	41.2	53,293	12,274	4.33	4,194	45	1,508		59,039.94	4.81
61	Rhode Island	286	117	40.8	24,385	5,862	4.14	729	20	2,773		27,906.79	4.74
62	South Carolina	381	195	51.1	54,000	9,309	5.79	1,542	50	10,897	1,000	67,488.63	7.25
63	South Dakota	185	71	38.4	11,008	5,082	2.16	3,865		753		15,624.75	3.07
64	Tennessee	577	246	42.5	50,409	12,532	4.02	4,880	100	2,010		57,399.06	4.58
Texas													
65	Northeast	525	191	36.3	91,531	19,598	4.67	6,283	162	9,865		107,840.45	5.50
66	Northwest	259	75	28.9	16,264	5,561	2.91	5,800	3,200	6,000	4	31,268.58	5.62
67	Southeast	617	292	47.3	80,290	16,647	4.81	9,345	50	2,314	800	92,798.92	5.57
68	Southwest	617	267	43.2	87,063	14,772	5.88	5,181		916	40	93,199.76	6.31
69	Utah	350	160	45.6	33,801	6,688	5.05	990	16	500	66	35,373.29	5.29
70	Vermont	294	141	47.9	22,709	4,954	4.58	1,254		1,251	78	25,291.33	5.11
71	Virginia	1,425	744	52.1	161,089	25,785	6.24	15,535	250	4,484	438	181,795.60	7.05
72	Western Washington	1,441	614	42.6	132,641	30,855	4.29	10,657		10,368	996	154,661.30	5.01
73	West Virginia	285	117	41.1	13,097	3,030	4.32	3,353	50	1,350	50	17,899.82	5.91
Wisconsin													
74	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	736	279	37.9	30,097	10,865	2.75	1,035		192		31,423.84	2.89
75	South	1,087	434	39.9	53,194	19,898	2.67	1,896	1,056	691	183	57,018.99	2.87
76	Wyoming	121	56	46.3	12,424	2,148	5.77	295		1,700		14,419.04	6.71
77	Puerto Rico	116	78	67.2	8,625	1,168	7.38	1,050		604		10,279.15	8.80
79	Alberta/N.W.T.	542	220	40.6	61,051	8,962	6.81	895	80	2,588	247	64,861.40	7.24
79.	B.C./Yukon	810	414	51.1	106,442	14,874	7.15	3,529		5,867	444	116,282.35	7.82
80	Manitoba	149	45	30.2	11,642	3,640	3.20	250		3,000		14,891.73	4.09
81	N.B./P.E.I.	202	80	39.5	14,000	3,270	4.28	367		100		14,466.66	4.42
82	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	246	98	39.8	23,217	3,241	7.16	100		1,226		24,542.95	7.57
Ontario													
83	East	595	252	42.3	72,286	14,879	4.85	848	490	17,556	2,352	93,530.75	6.29
84	Northeast	170	72	42.3	19,443	1,821	10.68	1,000		445		20,888.42	11.47
85	Northwest	59	15	25.4	4,714	996	4.72	710		1,645		7,069.19	7.10
86	West	603	218	36.2	61,060	10,773	5.67	3,880		15,380	554	80,873.36	7.51
Quebec ⁽¹⁾													
87	Southwest	551	497	90.1	13,786	12,178	1.53	2,489		15,890		37,165.33	3.05
88	Southeast	205	164	80.0	2,240	2,891	0.77	3,000		4,918		10,158.43	3.53
89	Northeast	323	291	90.0	1,943	6,129	0.31	1,331		19,510		22,733.77	3.72
90	Northwest	358	305	85.0	3,270	6,262	0.51	2,247		108,107		113,623.59	18.14
91	Saskatchewan	280	113	40.4	22,851	3,165	7.22	264	612	2,199		25,926.18	8.19
92	Washington East	453	215	47.5	31,157	5,811	5.35	352	400	4,664		86,572.65	6.29
93	Central Calif.	1,048	398	38.0	90,183	26,825	3.12	8,827		917	450	100,376.59	3.48
Total U.S./Canada		64,414	27,326	42.4%	\$5,451,874.04	1,388,727	3.93	\$384,055.69	\$51,418.20	\$582,011.64	\$16,571.31	\$6,485,931.04	\$4.67
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					\$452,045.20								
Specials					\$582,012.64								
Total for U.S. & Canada					\$6,485,931.04								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
Online and Telephone Meetings					\$2,253.67								
Correctional and Hospital facility groupups													
Foreign, WSM, other					\$67,403.41								
Internationalists					\$310.00								
International Lawyers in A.A.													
Loners					\$709.99								
Birds of a Feather					\$1,000.00								
Grand Total					\$6,557,608.11								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON – 2012-2011 – (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC.		
U.S. & Canada 2012	64,414	27,326	42.4%	\$5,451,874.20	1,388,727	\$3.93	\$4.67		
U.S. & Canada 2011	63,845	27,066	42.4%	\$5,233,900.40	1,384,699	\$3.94	\$4.54		
Increase (Decrease)	569	260	0.0%	\$217,973.80	4,028	(\$0.01)	\$0.13	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	
								2012	2011
								\$6.43	\$6.32

⁽¹⁾A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of AA entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup, etc.

⁽²⁾A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board.

⁽³⁾Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per into from areas).

The Budget Highlights

2013 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office—A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation), the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2013 budget projects gross sales of \$12,800,000. Unit sales are expected to be approximately even with 2012. While reviewing and recommending the 2013 budget the A.A.W.S. Board continues to consider that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 5% higher than 2012 and just slightly less than the 2012 budget. This increase allows for possible increases in various parts of the manufacturing process.

Royalties are budgeted at \$28,000 for 2013, even with 2012. There is only one remaining royalty recipient. Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 7% higher than 2012, again allowing for inflationary increases. We do expect that a new system of determining shipping instituted this year will continue to mitigate costs.

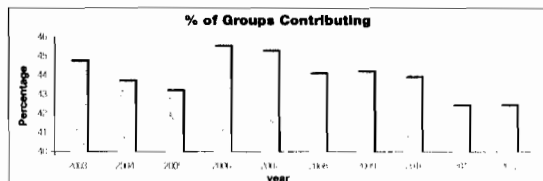
After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$7,782,800 or 62.1%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$95,000 less than 2012. The 62.1% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2013 compares with 63.7% realized for 2012. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Structure in Spanish and French, as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2008 through the 2013 budget.

2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013 Budget
55.9%	61.1%	64.5%	63.7%	63.7	62.1%

Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services provided.

Contributions: Contribution revenue had shown positive movement for several years. 2008 and 2009 showed reductions, and 2010 rebounded to \$6,408,421, \$58,400 and 2011 declined to \$6,265,649. For 2012, Contributions of \$6,557,600 were received, an increase of \$293,800 from 2011. The increase for 2012 is significant because it was in spite of a further reduction in support from Countries who contribute to the World Service Meeting literature efforts. For 2013 we have budgeted an overall increase of contributions of approximately 2%. We are hopefully that the economy is turning around and continuing efforts to communicate with the Fellowship about the needs for funds and how they are spend will show positive results.



During 2012, contributions from groups and individuals (as distinguished from those received for the World Service Meeting literature efforts) of \$6,522,943 were \$95,000 (1.5%) more than budget and \$333,077 (5.4%) greater 2011. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International Literature efforts amounted to \$34,665, approximately \$40,000 less than 2011. Total contributions as noted above were just over \$6,557,600.

The chart at the left reflects the approximate percentage of the A.A. groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the Seventh Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.

Total Operating Revenue for 2013 is anticipated at \$14,480,550, an increase of approximately \$40,000 due to a slight increase in sales and improving contributions.

Total Operating Expenses for 2013 have been budgeted at \$15,091,790, approximately \$800,000 or 5.6% greater than 2012 expenses and approximately five percent greater than the 2012 budget. The 2013 budget anticipates filling several positions that have been either vacant or filled by temporary/part timers. In addition, G.S.O. continues to fund larger amounts for the old pension plan according to US Government rules established a few years ago. These extreme funding levels should mitigate by 2016-2017.

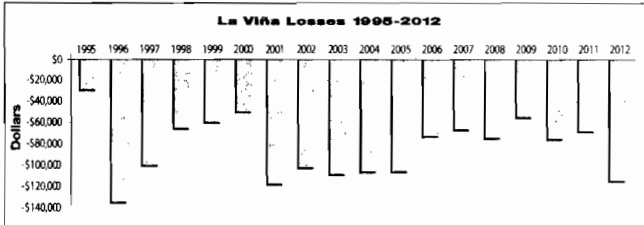
The 2013 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of expense over revenue of \$611,240. After considerable discussion, in view of ongoing self-support efforts, and the concerns by some corners how an increase in prices might be viewed considering a considerable Reserve Fund, the A.A.W.S. Board did not recommend an adjustment in prices for 2013. A drawdown from the Reserve Fund will be required to fund the deficit. It should be remembered that generally the Reserve Fund is funded by literature profits of G.S.O. This anticipated loss for 2013 compares with an excess of revenue of \$152,448 for 2012; \$819,132 for 2011; \$1,255,289 for 2010; \$1,273,500 for 2009, and a loss of \$275,000 for 2008.

2013 Grapevine Budget

The 2013 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for the print magazine of 78,760. This anticipates 8,200 fewer copies than the 2012 budget and approximately 4,500 fewer copies than the 2012 average paid circulation of 83,263. The 2013 budget calls for approximately 4,653 GV online subscriptions. Print magazine circulation for the last 15 years is depicted in the chart to the right.

Income: Magazine income of \$2,200,256 is expected to be approximately \$142,000 less than 2012. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$704,320, approximately even with 2012.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,819,859 is budgeted for 2013. This compares with \$1,948,916 achieved for 2012 and the 2012 budget of \$1,851,987.



Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2013 are budgeted at \$1,824,205, \$117,491 greater than the 2012 expenses of \$1,706,714 and \$19,500 less than the 2012 budget.

Net Income (loss): For 2013 the Grapevine anticipates a net profit of \$11,954. This compares with a 2012 budgeted profit of \$34,284 and an actual profit from operations of \$257,003.

2013 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The General Service Board recommended, and the 2001 Conference approved, that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Service Boards General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2013 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$53,629, compared with \$54,341 achieved in 2012. Circulation for 2013 is estimated at 9,200 slightly more than the 2012 average and slightly greater than the 2012 budget as well. Other Publishing Income is estimated at \$16,210, which after deducting cost of product of \$5,086 expects to contribute \$11,124 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$191,932 for 2013, \$10,000 more than 2012. The 2013 budget projects a net loss of \$127,179, \$11,000 higher than the 2012 loss of \$115,820. As noted above these losses are funded by the General Service Board General Fund. You may recall 2010 Conference Actions that added costs to La Viña production.

The Chart (above) reflects the La Viña magazine losses since inception (1995). To date, losses of approximately \$1,526,100 have been incurred.

2013 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Ken Baker
Mike Donnelly
Steve Foster
Mike Hudson
Padee McCrery
²Dave Murray
Bill Reidy
¹Lynda Rivers
Sharon Stevenson

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Daniel Blanchard
Dave Cornwell
Sharon Gibbs
¹Pam Jurica
²Kenny Kaatz
Terry Lindgren
Homer Moeller
Pat Moody
Linda Thompson

Secretary: Clay Rittenhouse

Corrections

Gary BraVard
Walter Curry
Linda McGhee
²Brian Morishita
Dennis Morrow
Holly Peterson
Roger Schelling
¹Janet Smith-Cook

Secretary: Tracey Ober

Finance

Kim Carswell
Harold Casey
Sheryl Figley
²Cyndi Follich
Marty Laakso
Yvette Nelson
Gail Robinson
¹Jeff Saunders
Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Marilyn Balliet
Roger Bedard
¹Bob Clegg
Keith Domack
Rich Healless
²Tom Mooney
Mo Neal
Bob Swindaman
Astri Torjussen
Secretary: Eugene O'Brien

Literature

Greg Boone
Carmella Crockett
Diane Davis
Cheryl Lawson
²Lela Meinke
Ola Pearson
Oscar Rivera
¹Walter Stadnyczuk
Secretary: Mary Dargan

Policy/Admissions

Gilles Flynn
Sophie Kenn
Kit Johnson
Mark Mankowski
²Brian O'Shea
Marilyn Rodgers
Rose Sherburne
¹Alan Spencer
Doris Sullivan
Secretary: Rick Walker

Public Information

Cathy Beckham
Chase Browning
Mel Caterine
Patrick Claymore
²Chris Doyle
Dick Humphrey
Linda Kornacki-Kuhns
¹Eden Lovejoy
Secretary: Mary Cumings

Report and Charter

¹Mark Everett
Scott Gilkerson
Percy Graves
Pauline Newas
Larry Noonan
Mike Rogalla
Ken Taylor
²Jeryl Thompson
Secretary: Jim Malone

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities

Pierre Couture
¹Jay Decker
Dave Hall
Craig Miller
Juan Montiel
Steve Otto
Randy Rogness
²Pamela Vollans-Matthews
Secretary: Steve Smith

Trustees

Carolyn Barnes
Becky Burden
Don Fucik
Michael Hansen
¹Tom Hoban
²Jim Kath
Ken Koga
Jim MacDonald
Patty Schaller
Secretary: Adrienne Brown

³ Archives

Carolyn Barnes
²Gary BraVard
¹Brian Morishita
Oscar Rivera
Marilyn Rodgers
Mike Rogalla
Rose Sherburne
Alan Spencer
Secretary: Michelle Mirza

³ International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

¹Mike Hudson
Sophie Kenn
Linda Kornacki-Kuhns
²Marty Laakso
Lynda Rivers
Gail Robinson
Pamela Vollans-Matthews
Secretary: Julio Espailat
Eva Sanchez

2014 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Padee McCrery, California, Northern Coastal	Sharon Stevenson, Montana
³ Archives	Rose Sherburne, Connecticut	Mike Rogalla, North Dakota
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Dave Cornwell, Central/Southeast Ohio	Homer Moeller, North Carolina
Corrections	Holly Peterson, Louisiana	Dennis Morrow, SE Michigan
Finance	Yvette Nelson, W. Pennsylvania	Kim Carswell, Saskatchewan
Grapevine	Mo Neal, NE Texas	Astri Torjussen, W. Washington
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Sharon Stevenson, Montana	Linda Kornacki-Kuhns, N. New Jersey
Literature	Carmella Crockett, District of Columbia	Diane Davis, Colorado
Policy/Admissions	Mark Mankowski, Chicago	Rose Sherburne, Connecticut
Public Information	Cathy Beckham, West Virginia	Patrick Claymore, SE Texas
Report and Charter	Ken Taylor, E. Massachussetts	Scott Gilkerson, Virginia
Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities	Craig Miller, Alabama/NW Florida	Steve Otto, E. Pennsylvania
Trustees	Carolyn Barnes, British Columbia/Yukon	Don Fucik, S. FLorida/Bahamas/V.I./Antigua/ St. Maarten/Cayman Islands

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2013 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 63rd General Service Conference.

■ 2013 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Nancy Haynes, *chairperson*
 Frances Brisbane
 Donald Cusson
 Michele Grinberg
 George Martin
 Don Miller
 Andrew Ware
 Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
 Donal Cusson
 Roberta Lindeman
 Clayton Vandivort
 Don Meurer, *secretary*

Compensation

George Martin, *chairperson*
 Michele Grinberg
 Gary Lutz
 Don Massey
 Don Meurer, *consultant*
 Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*
 Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

Conference

Pam Reising, *chairperson*
 Joe Downey
 John Fromson
 Michele Grinberg
 Barb Kelly
 Don Miller
 El Nault
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment/Special Needs- Accessibilities

Rogelio Flores, *chairperson*
 Andrea Barthwell
 Frances Brisbane
 Rod Betonney
 John Fromson
 Marty Watters
 Albin Zezula
 Clay Rittenhouse,
secretary — C.P.C.
 Steve Smith, *secretary*
— Treatment/Special
Needs-Accessibilities

Corrections

Clayton Vandivort, *chairperson*
 Andrea Barthwell
 John Fromson
 Barb Kelly
 Don Miller
 Andrew Ware
 Albin Zezula
 Tracey Ober, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
 Donald Cusson
 Michele Grinberg
 Roberta Lindeman
 Gary Lutz
 George Martin
 Don Massey
 Bill Noonan
 Clayton Vandivort
 Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
 Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Don Massey, *chairperson*
 Corliss Burke
 Rogelio Flores
 Barb Kelly
 El Nault
 Pam Reising
 Marty Watters
 Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

J. Gary Lutz, *chairperson*
 Terry Bedient
 Rod Betonney
 Joe Downey
 Rogelio Flores
 El Nault
 Bill Noonan
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*
— International Conventions
 Julio Espallat, *secretary*
— Regional Forums

Literature

Rod Betonney, *chairperson*
 Andrea Barthwell
 Corliss Burke
 Joe Downey
 *Teresa Frohock
 John Fromson
 *Christine Hofer
 Marty Watters
 Albin Zezula
 Greg Tobin, *consultant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
 Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Nominating

El Nault, *chairperson*
 Terry Bedient
 Frances Brisbane
 Nancy Haynes
 Roberta Lindeman
 George Martin
 Don Massey
 Pam Reising
 Clayton Vandivort
 Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Public Information

George Martin, *chairperson*,
 *Tom Becherer
 Corliss Burke
 Nancy Haynes
 J. Gary Lutz
 Bill Noonan
 Andrew Ware
 Albin Zezula
 Mary Cumings, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Pam Reising, *chairperson*
 Rick Walker, *secretary*

Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
 Ward Ewing
 First vice-chairperson
 Pam Reising
 Second vice-chairperson
 Michele Grinberg
 Secretary
 El Nault
 Treasurer
 Terry Bedient
 Assistant secretary
 Doug Richardson
 Assistant treasurer
 Donald Meurer
 The new slate of officers
 is given on page 8



*Denotes appointed committee members

**Ward Ewing is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

■ 2013 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

***Ward B. Ewing, D.D.** (P.O. Box 6, Ten Mile, TN 37880) was elected chairman of the board in 2009, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he served as dean and president from 1998 until his retirement in 2010. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. He has been involved as a friend of A.A. since the mid-'70s.

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected Class A trustee and treasurer in May 2008. Currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York, his career has included various executive positions, including hospital chief executive officer. He has served on a dozen nonprofit boards, currently as trustee of the New York Lawyer Assistance Trust, which oversees substance abuse programs for attorneys and judges, and as treasurer of the Federation of State Physical Health Programs. Terry is a Fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He chairs the Finance & Budgetary and Audit Committees and serves on the Nominating and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School and University, Cincinnati, Ohio. Frances is the author of five books and over 60 articles and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to alcoholism and substance abuse prevention and treatment and people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York. Frances serves on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Archives and Nominating Committees.

Corliss R. Burke, B.Ed. (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, director and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training. Corliss serves on the Public Information, International and Literature Committees.

***The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores** (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores is now the Senior Judge on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara County, Santa Maria Division. He was recently reassigned to a trial department after serving for 13 years as the judge presiding over the Drug Court, Mental Health Court, and High Risk DUI dockets. He helped start the first Veteran's Treatment Court in Central California, a calendar that he continues to preside over. Judge Flores serves on the Executive Committee of the Board of Directors of the National Association of Drug Court Professionals, and he is the vice-chair of the Collaborative Justice Advisory Committee for the Judicial Council of California. He was recently awarded the Judicial Officer of the Year by the Chief Probation Officers of

California. Judge Flores chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committee and serves on the International and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

John A. Fromson, M.D. (221 Winslow Rd., Waban, MA 02468) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. He is a graduate of New York Medical College and is a board certified addiction specialist. John is an associate director of postgraduate medical education, Dept. of Psychiatry, Massachusetts General Hospital, and teaches at Harvard Medical School. He is the author of many articles and lectures widely. John serves on the Corrections, Conference, Literature and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Michele Grinberg, J.D. (4111 Staunton Ave., SE, Charleston, WV 25304) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. She is a 1985 graduate of West Virginia University College of Law, where she now teaches a legal writing course as an adjunct instructor. Michele is a practicing attorney with a concentration in health policy and medical staff relations. She is co-editor of *Women and the Law*. Michele serves on the Archives, Compensation, Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Rod Betonney (6553 Elmcrest Dr., #13F, Salt Lake City, UT 84107) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 47 delegate, Rod graduated from the Univ. of Utah with an MSW degree and currently works as a licensed clinical social worker in a substance abuse treatment program. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees and is on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Donald Cusson (520 Joseph-Guay, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 4S9) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 54 delegate Don is active in his district and area and is a retired business man. He chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary, and Audit Committees.

Nancy Haynes (P.O. Box 151, St. Helena, CA 94574) was elected general service trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate, Nancy served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Board. She is president and CEO of a coffee roasting company. Nancy chairs the Archives Committee, serves on the Public Information and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Barbara Kelly (752 Skyline Rd., RR #1, Oakwood, ON K0M 2M0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2011. Barb was a Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Canada and remains active in her area, as well as in community affairs. Now retired, her most recent position was as mayor of Kawartha Lakes. Barb serves on the Conference, Corrections, and International Committees.

Roberta S. Lindeman (3487 Long Drive, Minden, NV 89423), a Panel 47 delegate from Nevada, was elected general service trustee in April 2010, after having served the four previous years as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Roberta brings

*Rotating at the close of the 2013 Conference.

a background of teaching, counseling, and school district administration to the board. She continues active participation in a home group and in local A.A. events. Roberta chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Audit, Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

J. Gary Lutz (2210 13th St., Bethlehem, PA 18020) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2011. A Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania, J. Gary is a university professor of education, specializing in educational research methodology and currently serving as Vice Provost for Institutional Research. He chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Public Information, Compensation and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

***George G. Martin** (209 East Liberty St., Milford, MI 48381) was elected general service trustee in April 2009, having previously served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. World Services Board. An attorney, his law practice primarily involves representation of nonprofit corporations in finance and business transactions. George chairs both the Public Information and Compensation Committees and serves on the Nominating, Archives and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He also is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

***Don Massey** (3928 Uri St., Metairie, LA 70002) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2009. Don was a Panel 55 delegate from Area 27 (Louisiana) and today he is an active A.A. member who also facilitates inventories for groups, districts and other A.A. entities. An attorney, Don has served as an adjunct professor, University of New Orleans and he is an active member of various civic and legal organizations, including the Louisiana Lawyers Assistance Program, of which he is presently chairperson. He chairs the International Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Compensation and Nominating Committees.

***Don Miller** (Cheetah International, Inc., 847 Sherman St., 1st Fl., Denver, CO 80203) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. Don, a Panel 49 delegate, served on the A.A. World Service Board as a nontrustee director, 2003-2006. He is involved in project management and organizational development for new businesses. Don serves on the Conference, Corrections, and Archives Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

***Eleanor (El) W. Nault** (440 Hamilton Parkway, Easley, SC 29642-3041) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2009. A Panel 56 delegate, El remains active not only in her home group, but in many area and district service functions. El's professional background includes city and regional planning; she recently retired as a teacher/administrator of a four-year research university. El chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Conference, International, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees. El is also secretary of the General Service Board.

***Pamela Reising** (31829 Sheridan Dr., Beverly Hills, MI 48025) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2009. A former Panel 45 delegate, Pam is co-facilitator of her area's monthly G.S.R. orientation. Pam's background is in the criminal justice field and she teaches at a state university. She chairs both the Sharing Sessions and the Conference Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees.

Clayton Vandivort (Box 158, 316 S. Kingshighway St., Sikeston, MO 63801) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate from Eastern Missouri, Clayton is

active in his area and region. He is an attorney in private practice. He chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Nominating, Audit and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Andrew Ware (3214 Cummins Way, Missoula, MT 59802) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 57 delegate, Andrew is active in his area and in corrections service. He is a university professor and chair of the Department of Physics and Astronomy. He serves on the Archives, Corrections and Public Information Committees.

Marty Watters (9478 Greenglade Rd., Sidney, BC V8L 3T7) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 59 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Nominating Committee, Marty is active in workshops, inventories and other events around his area. He is the owner of a Landscape/Hardscape Design and Installation business. He serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Literature and International Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2013 Conference

The Hon. Ivan L.R. Lemelle (U.S. District Court, Eastern District of Louisiana, 500 Poydras St., Chambers C-525, New Orleans, LA 70130) was elected Class A trustee in April 2013. A graduate of Loyola University School of Law, New Orleans, Judge Lemelle has an extensive background in both state and federal law. He currently serves as a U.S. District Judge.

David M. Morris, CPA (1060 Park Ave., Apt. #4G, New York, NY 10128) was elected Class A trustee in April 2013. Currently, David is the owner of Morris Consulting, a practice that focuses on providing financial and accounting guidance. He is retired from the position of senior vice president, JPMorgan Chase Bank.

William (Bill) Farnsworth (716 Fifth St. Marietta, OH 45750) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2013. A former Panel 47 delegate, Bill is active in his district with the Corrections committee. His professional background is in law enforcement and he is involved with community projects.

William (Bill) Noonan (1310 Ocean Rd., Spring Lake Heights, NJ 07762) was elected general service trustee in April 2013, after serving as an A.A.W.S. nontrustee director for four years. Bill, a Panel 49 delegate, is an executive in the Financial Risk Management field. Bill's love of general service developed as a result of his involvement with The International Conference of Young People in A.A.

Chet Parker (P.O. Box 541044, Orlando, FL 32854-1044) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2013. A Panel 59 delegate, he is involved in his area's Traditions Workshops. Chet is an attorney who has taught various courses at local institutions.

Robert (Bob) Wilcox (30 Whispering Wind Rd., Westfield, MA 01085) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2013. Bob was a Panel 52 delegate, where he chaired the Public Information Committee. He is president of an Insurance Agency.

Albin Zezula (100 Connecticut Ave., Long Beach, NY 11561) was elected general service trustee in April 2013, after having served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. Albin is an associate publisher with a newspaper publishing company.

A.A. World Services Directors

Roberta Lindeman, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Andrea Barthwell, *director*
 Rod Betonney, *regional trustee*
 Joe Downey, *director*

Phyllis Halliday, *G.S.O. general manager*
 George Martin, *general service trustee*
 Bill Noonan, *director*
 Rick Walker, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Donald Cusson, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 Michele Grinberg, *trustee*

Nancy Haynes, *general service trustee*
 El Nault, *regional trustee*
 Albin Zezula, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, *general manager*
 Doug Richardson, *director of staff services*
 Adrienne Brown
 Mary Cummings
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espallat

Mary Clare Lynch
 Jim Malone
 Tracey Ober
 Clay Rittenhouse
 Eva Sanchez
 Steve Smith
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 Irene Donoso, *La Viña editor*

Jon Witherspoon, *managing editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Julie Anderson, *staff assistant*
 Nadine Baker, *staff assistant*
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish-language editor*
 Sheila Coppin-Thom, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 April Hegner, *senior archivist*
 Branwynne Kennedy, *GV Web editor*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *hotel coordinator/workroom manager*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *archivist*
 Maria Morales, *staff assistant*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Joselin Pichardo, *GV production associate*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Jason Seder, *artist, Conference Report*
 Frank Segui, *finance secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Greg Tobin, *publishing director*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Summer Edition Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nay Williams, *Conference staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Leonard Blumenthal
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 63rd Conference includes Panel 62 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 63 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	63	Craig Miller 8124 Nunn Trace Montgomery, AL 36117
Alaska	2	62	Eden Lovejoy 5828 Katahdin Dr. Anchorage, AK 99502
Arizona	3	62	David (Dave) Murray 6140 E. Joshua Tree Paradise Valley, AZ 85253
Arkansas	4	63	Steve Foster 220 Sibley Trail Searcy, AR 72143
California Southern	5	63	Juan Montiel 868 W. Emory Ct. Upland, CA 91786
Central	93	63	Sharon Gibbs 2330 E. Avenue J-8, #264 Lancaster, CA 93535
Northern Coastal	6	63	Padee McCrery Box 8602 Santa Rosa, CA 95407
Northern Interior	7	62	Janet (Lela) Meinke 5135 Wedgewood Way Rocklin, CA 95765
San Diego/Imperial	8	62	Tom Mooney 1880 Grove Rd. El Cajon, CA 92020
Mid-Southern	9	62	Jeryl Thompson 214 A Palmer St. Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	63	Diane Davis Box 773306 Steamboat, CO 80477
Connecticut	11	63	Rose Sherburne 30 Gladden St., #9 New Britain, CT 06051
Delaware	12	62	Richard (Dick) Humphrey 7 N. Stuyvesant Dr. Wilmington, DE 19809
District of Columbia	13	63	Carmella Crockett 7546 8th St., NW Washington, DC 20012
Florida North	14	63	Marilyn Balliet 6035 E. Tudor St. Inverness, FL 34452
S. Florida/Bahamas/ V.I./Antigua/St. Maarten/ Cayman Islands	15	63	Don Fucik 950 S. Pine Island Rd. Suite A-150 Plantation, FL 33324
Georgia	16	62	Tom Hoban 527 Duke Dr. Marietta, GA 30066
Hawaii	17	63	Ken Koga 1815 Young St., Apt. #1 Honolulu, HI 96826
Idaho	18	62	Brian Morishita 2994 Thayer Bridge Circle Idaho Falls, ID 83402-4660

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	63	Sharon Stevenson Box 542 Bozeman, MT 59771-0542
Chicago	19	63	Mark Mankowski 10830 Sacramento Chicago, IL 60655	Nebraska	41	62	Kit Johnson 10810 Willow Rd. Shelton, NE 68876
Northern	20	62	Richard (Rich) Healless 8618 Regnier Rd. Hebron, IL 60034	Nevada	42	63	Sophie Kenn 286 N. Tumbleweed Rd. Bishop, CA 93514
Southern	21	63	Becky Burden 6 Lakeview Point Bloomington, IL 61701	New Hampshire	43	62	Cheryl Lawson Box 351 Sprinfield, NH 03284
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	63	Bill Reidy 4503 Kingsdale Dr. Valparaiso, IN 46383	Northern	44	63	Linda Kornacki-Kuhns 512 Newark Ave. Piscataway, NJ 08854
Southern	23	62	Gary BraVard 3540 N. Pennsylvania St., Apt. L Indianapolis, IN 46205	Southern	45	62	Janet Smith-Cook 109 Somerset Dr. Willingboro, NJ 08046
Iowa	24	63	Sheryl Figley 12258 255th St. Donahue, IA 52746	New Mexico	46	62	Alan Spencer 448 Pyrite Dr., NE Rio Rancho, NM 87124
Kansas	25	62	Michael (Mike) Hudson 705 W. 8th St. Scott City, KS 67871	New York			
Kentucky	26	62	Lynda Rivers Box 99942 Louisville, KY 40269	Central	47	63	Patty Schaller 221 Avis St. Rochester, NY 14615
Louisiana	27	63	Holly Peterson 4124 Pleasant Dr. Lake Charles, LA 70605	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	62	Keith Domack 385 Dewitt Mills Rd. Kingston, NY 12401
Maine	28	62	Linda Thompson 135 Dana Mill Rd. Woolwich, ME 04579	Southeast	49	63	Linda McGhee 50 East 21st St., #3-F Brooklyn, NY 11226
Maryland	29	62	Robert (Bob) Clegg 6588 Nyasa Bend New Market, MD 21774	Western	50	62	Michael (Mike) Donnelly 342 Grover Cleveland Hwy. Amherst, NY 14226
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	63	Homer Moeller 5147 Brandiles Ln. Winston-Salem, NC 27104
Eastern	30	63	Ken Taylor 121 Chestnut St. Pepperell, MA 01463	North Dakota	52	63	Mike Rogalla 4310 10th Ave. South, #109 Fargo, ND 58103
Western	31	62	Brian O'Shea 110 Roosevelt Ave. Chicopee, MA 01013	Ohio			
Michigan				Central/Southeast	53	63	Dave Cornwell 777 Liverpool Pl. Westerville, OH 43081
Central	32	63	Pauline Newas 2316 Cleveland Ave. Midland, MI 48640	Northeast	54	63	Ola Pearson 4480 Granada Blvd., #22 Cleveland, OH 44128
Southeast	33	63	Dennis Morrow 766 Lakeland Grosse Pointe, MI 48230	Northwest	55	62	Bob Swindaman 1165 Craig Rd. Maumee, OH 43537
Western	34	62	Kenny Kaatz 3234 Miami Ave. Kalamazoo, MI 49048-1219	Southwest	56	62	Mark Everett 517 Cherry Hill Lane Lebanon, OH 45036
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	63	Harold Casey Box 515 Nicoma Park, OK 73066
Northern	35	62	James (Jim) Kath Box 57 Brainerd, MN 56401	Oregon	58	62	Chase Browning 646 Griffin Oaks Dr. Central Point, OR 97502
Southern	36	63	Terry Lindgren 3020 Casco Point Rd. Wayzata, MN 55391	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	62	Doris Sullivan 106 Redbud Dr. Leland, MS 38756	Eastern	59	63	Steve Otto 228 Henley Rd. Wynnewood, PA 19096-3136
Missouri				Western	60	63	Yvette Nelson 528 Dawson Ave., #1 Bellevue, PA 15202
Eastern	38	63	Larry Noonan 2610 Elm Dr. Arnold, MO 63010				
Western	39	63	Dave Hall 2138 Xenia St. Joplin, MO 64801				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	62	Patricia (Pat) Moody 103 Nashua St. Providence, RI 02904
South Carolina	62	62	Cyndi Follrich 10 Rock Springs Dr. Ladys Island, SC 29907
South Dakota	63	62	Chris Doyle 114 E. Texas St. Rapid City, SD 57701
Tennessee	64	62	Jay Decker 600 Lovers Lane Lebanon, TN 37087
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	63	Mo Neal 326 Faircrest Dr. Arlington, TX 76018
<i>Northwest</i>	66	62	Roger Schelling 3804 Fairgreen Court Midland, TX 79707
<i>Southeast</i>	67	63	Patrick Claymore 7997 Kendalia Dr. Houston, TX 77036
<i>Southwest</i>	68	62	Pam Jurica 365 Post Oak Bend Inez, TX 77968
Utah	69	63	Walter Curry 746 Country Club Dr. Stansbury Park, UT 84074
Vermont	70	62	Michael Hansen 2467 Lakeview Dr. North Hero, VT 05474
Virginia	71	63	Scott Gilkerson 7251 Beauregard Ct. Warrenton, VA 20187
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	62	Jeffrey (Jeff) Saunders Box 868 Leavenworth, WA 98826
<i>Western</i>	72	63	Astri Torjussen 2309 No. 193rd St. Shoreline, WA 98133-4137
West Virginia	73	63	Cathy Beckham 24 Spring St. Morgantown, WV 26501
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	62	Marty Laakso 11090 E. Lund Rd. Maple, WI 54854
<i>Southern</i>	75	63	Randy Rogness 1825 N. 166th St. Brookfield, WI 53005
Wyoming	76	62	Gregory (Greg) Boone 7495 Hwy 789 Lander, WY 82520
Puerto Rico	77	62	Oscar Rivera Box 362113 San Juan, PR 00936-2113

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	62	Walter Stadnyczuk 11715-84 Avenue NW Edmonton, AB T6G 0W2
B.C./Yukon	79	63	Carolyn Barnes 16617 79B Ave. Surrey, BC V4N 0J2
Manitoba	80	62	Pamela Vollans-Matthews 520 Wellington Crescent Dauphin, MB R7N 0M3
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	62	Jim MacDonald 59, Sandlewood St. Charlottetown, PEI C1E 0A5
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	63	Marilyn Rodgers 5-8 Munroe Court Truro, NS B2N 6P4
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	63	Mel Caterine 26 Wright Ave. Toronto, ON M6R 1K8
<i>Northeast</i>	84	63	Gail Robinson Box 1006 Little Current, ON P0P 1K0
<i>Northwest</i>	85	63	Ken Baker 3058 Government Rd. Thunder Bay, ON P7G 1V7
<i>Western</i>	86	62	Percy Graves 355 Bethune Dr. North, Unit D Gravenhurst, ON P1P 1B8
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	62	Pierre Couture 1450 Nobel, Suite 20 Boucherville, PQ J4B 5H3
<i>Southeast</i>	88	63	Daniel Blanchard 214 Salaberry Sherbrooke, PQ J1E 2P6
<i>Northeast</i>	89	63	Roger Bédard 572 106 eme Avenue St-Georges-de Champlain, PQ G9T 3K3
<i>Northwest</i>	90	62	Gilles Flynn 116, Lorenz Bourcier Saint-Jérôme, PQ J7Y 4T1
Saskatchewan	91	63	Kim Carswell 5717 2nd Ave. North Regina, SK S4R 5M4

